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PUBLISHED FROM DELHI | KOLKATA | SILIGURI

VOL.21, ISSUE 212 | Saturday, 1 August, 2026 | New Delhi | Pages 14 | Rs 4.00

CITY: PG 4
Vidya Vahini: Wheels of change for Delhi girls

WORLD: PG 9
At least 60,000 entered Ceuta from Morocco, with 34 deaths

FILM: PG 14
Ranbir Kapoor reacts to criticism

Cabinet extends PM-KISAN till 2030-31, clears 4 key schemes

PM says PM-KISAN will strengthen farmers, Khelo India will boost sports

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: In a series of decisions on key flagship programmes, the Union Cabinet on Friday approved the continuation of the PM-KISAN scheme for another five years till 2030-31 with an outlay of over Rs 3.15 lakh crore. It also cleared the Rs 84,084-crore Samudra Manthan National Offshore Exploration Scheme, approved the revamped Khelo India Scheme with an outlay of Rs 36,441 crore, and sanctioned the Rs 5,070-crore Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY).

Under PM-KISAN, launched in February 2019, eligible landholding farmer families receive Rs 6,000 annually in three equal instalments through direct benefit transfer. Around Rs 4.5 lakh crore has been disbursed under the scheme so far.

The decisions were taken at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the Cabinet approved continuation of PM-KISAN from 2026-27 to 2030-31.

"The approval reiterates the government's commitment that the prosperity of farmers forms the foundation of the nation's prosperity. The extension of the scheme will enhance farmers' capacity to invest in agriculture, improve productivity, help reduce agricultural risks and strengthen the rural economy," an official statement said.

The Cabinet also approved the Rs 84,084-crore Samudra Manthan National Offshore Exploration Scheme to partly fund the high cost of oil and gas exploration in deepwater and ultra-deepwater areas, including exploratory drilling and common infrastructure required to bring discoveries into production. Continued on P6

CLOSER LOOK

- PM-KISAN extended till 2030-31; Rs 3.15 lakh crore approved
- Samudra Manthan gets Rs 84,084 crore for offshore oil, gas exploration
- Revamped Khelo India, NSF support receive Rs 36,441 crore
- PM Surya Sarovar Yojana approved with Rs 5,070 crore outlay
- Farmers to continue receiving Rs 6,000 annually under PM-KISAN
- Floating solar scheme targets 5,000 MW capacity with storage
- Government to support deepwater exploration with up to Rs 650 crore per well

Delhi govt to open online applications for Laxmi Yojana today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will launch the online portal for its flagship Delhi Laxmi Yojana on August 1, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta set to inaugurate the platform at the District Magistrate (East) Office in Geeta Colony. The launch will mark the beginning of online applications for the scheme.

During the event, the chief minister will register a few eligible women to formally start the application process. Thereafter, applications from other beneficiaries will be accepted through the portal. The government has said it aims to complete verification of eligible applications in a time-bound manner so that the first instalment can be released by Raksha Bandhan.

Under the scheme, eligible women will receive Rs.2,500 per month as financial assistance. The Delhi government has allocated Rs. 5,110 crore for the programme in the 2026-27 Budget and estimates that it will benefit over 17 lakh women across the national capital. Continued on P6

'GUIDE, DON'T PUNISH'

PM forgives students who abused him

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said he had forgiven the students who allegedly abused him and his late mother during the recent protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar over alleged NEET irregularities, urging society to guide young people instead of seeking punishment. In a video message shared on Instagram late on Friday, Modi described the protesters as "misguided children" and said taking them to court or subjecting them to social harassment would not help them learn from their mistakes.

Referring to the protest, Modi said abusive language was directed not only at him but also at his late mother. "I want to forgive them. People make mistakes, but it is our duty to show our youth the right path," he said, adding that abusive language could never solve any problem.

The Prime Minister said he understood the anger and pain prevailing in society over the incident, including the language allegedly used by some young women, but appealed for restraint. "These are misguided children, and showing them the way is our responsibility. Punishing them, making them run around the courts, or harassing them in society will not change the situation," he said.

Using an analogy, Modi said people do not break their teeth if they accidentally bite their tongue because both belong to the same body. "The children are also ours," he said, urging society not to abandon young people for their mistakes. Continued on P6

Ten killed as building collapses in Bhiwandi

Was declared 'dangerous' in 2020

MPOST BUREAU

THANE: At least ten people died and three were injured after part of a four-storey residential building came down in Bhiwandi, a powerloom town in Maharashtra's Thane district, around 50 kilometres from Mumbai.

The 'B' wing of the Kohinoor Building in the Balaji Nagar locality collapsed around 11:20 pm on Thursday. The rescue effort that followed ran for close to 19 hours, ending around 7 pm on Friday, according to officials from the district disaster management cell.

Teams from the National Disaster Response Force, the Thane Disaster Response Force, and fire brigades from both Thane city and Bhiwandi took part in the search. Four fire engines, two ambulances, a sniffer dog squad and heavy earth-moving equipment were used to comb through the rubble.

Shrikant Pardeshi, Assistant Municipal Commissioner and PRO of the Bhiwandi Nizampur City Municipal Corporation, confirmed the toll of ten dead and three injured. Five victims have been identified so far: Shamim Shaikh (32), Ranjeet Singh (45), Miraj Rasul Shaikh (34), Santosh Kumar Pandey (42) and Shamim Ansari (30).

The civic body had declared the building "dangerous" back in Continued on P6

IB OFFICER MURDER

Court sentences Tahir Hussain, four others to life imprisonment

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Friday handed life imprisonment to former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain and four other men convicted in the killing of Intelligence Bureau staffer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 communal violence in northeast Delhi. Additional Sessions Judge Praveen Singh ruled that the crime did not meet the threshold of the "rarest of rare" category needed to justify a death sentence.

Prosecutors had pushed hard for capital punishment for all five men, arguing they had acted with such brutality that they had descended to the level of animals while attacking Sharma. The judge disagreed, saying the prosecution could not show that Hussain or his co-accused, Nazim, Qasim, Javed and Anas, had a history of violence or a criminal temperament that would make them a continuing danger even behind bars.

Explaining his reasoning, Judge Singh said the final question before imposing death was whether the convicts had any chance of reform. He concluded that the case did not warrant Continued on P6

Tahir Hussain PTI

Modi, UK PM Burnham discuss trade pact, strategic ties in first phone call

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and newly appointed UK Prime Minister Andy Burnham on Friday agreed to deepen the India-UK Comprehensive Strategic Partnership and make full use of the opportunities created by the recently operationalised India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) during their first phone conversation since Burnham took office on July 20.

Modi congratulated Burnham on becoming prime minister and wished him success in his new role. In a social media post after the call, Modi said the two leaders agreed to expand cooperation in technology, innovation, defence, security, clean energy, education and people-to-people exchanges.

"We agreed to work together across sectors such as technology, Continued on P6

'Are there two sets of laws?' CJP questions FIR against woman

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) on Friday criticised the registration of an FIR against a woman accused of using abusive language against Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the July 23 protest at Jantar Mantar, alleging that authorities were applying different standards while dealing with similar incidents involving BJP leaders and members of the party's IT Cell.

The remarks came a day after police booked a Faridabad-based woman on charges including intentional insult, public mischief and defamation following a complaint filed by a Ghaziabad resident. The complaint referred to videos purportedly showing the woman using abusive language against the Prime Minister during the demonstration. A zero FIR was initially registered in Noida on Thursday before being transferred to Parliament Street Police Station in New Delhi, which has Continued on P6

Quick News

CLOSELY MONITORING: INDIA ON TARIFFS ON RUSSIAN OIL

NEW DELHI: India on Friday said it was closely monitoring a US Bill that could let President Donald Trump impose up to 100 per cent tariffs on major buyers of Russian oil and gas, after the Senate passed it 86-12. "Our position is predicated on national priorities," External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. The Bill now goes to the House. See P11

PARL ADJOURNED TILL MONDAY AMID OPPN'S SLOGANEERING

NEW DELHI: Both Houses of Parliament were adjourned till Monday following persistent opposition protests, sloganeering, and uproar over various issues, including protests regarding police action against student demonstrators.

The Lok Sabha cleared the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026, via voice vote despite the ruckus.

Lok Sabha proceedings were initially adjourned till Friday noon as Opposition members raised slogans against the police crackdown on students agitating against the NEET paper leak and other matters. Continued on P6

Below-normal rainfall likely during 2nd half of monsoon

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India is likely to see below-normal rainfall in the second half of the monsoon season, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said in its monthly forecast released on Friday.

Rainfall between August and September is expected to stay under 94 per cent of the Long Period Average (LPA), the weather office said. The LPA is the average rainfall recorded over a region during a set period, calculated over 30 to 50 years. For the country as a whole, the LPA for August and September, based on data from 1971 to 2020, stands at 422.8 mm.

Dr Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, director general of meteorology at the IMD, said most parts of the country are likely to receive below-normal rain during this period. "Below-normal rainfall is very likely over many parts of the Continued on P6

BRIEF REMOVAL OF PM MODI'S FACEBOOK POST

Govt to quiz Meta global team over algorithmic bias and role in maintaining public order

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre will question Meta's global team next week over algorithmic bias, the functioning of its content moderation systems and the platform's role in maintaining public order, following the brief restriction of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Facebook post on action against paper leaks. Government sources said the meeting is not merely about a technical lapse but also concerns national security and platform accountability.

The move follows the government's decision to summon the US-based social media company's senior global executives after a Facebook version of Modi's July 23 post was temporarily restricted before being restored. Meta attributed the incident to a technical glitch involving its AI-powered automated content filters, apologised for the error and said the content had been removed inadvertently. However, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) found the explanation inadequate.

MeitY Secretary S Krishnan said Continued on P6

CONVEYS 'DEEP CONCERN'

Jaishankar urges Iran to avoid attacks on ships

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Friday strongly urged Iran to avoid attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers under any circumstances with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar conveying to his Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi that New Delhi condemns any such strike by any party.

Jaishankar said this during a phone conversation with Araghchi.

"Conveyed our deep concerns at the ongoing hostilities in the region. Strongly urged that attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers be avoided under any circumstances," the external affairs minister said on social media.

"India condemns any such attack by any party."

Jaishankar said he was apprised of Iran's perspective of current developments and discussions which are underway. "India is always supportive of dialogue and diplomacy," he said.

The phone conversation between the two foreign ministers came amid increasing hostilities between Iran and the US. India has been voicing serious Continued on P6

Married daughters cannot be denied compassionate appointment: SC

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has ruled that a government policy limiting compassionate appointments to only divorced or deserted daughters is unconstitutional. A Bench of Justice M M Sundresh and Justice Prasanna B Varale struck down the Bihar Government's condition dated December 10, 2014, while hearing the appeal of a woman whose application had been rejected after her father's death because she was neither divorced nor deserted.

"This court has repeatedly held that any classification differentiating a daughter from a son is, per se, unconstitutional," the bench observed. It added that restricting eligibility only to divorced or deserted daughters "cannot be sustained in the eye of law."

The state had argued that a married daughter is ordinarily expected to leave her parental home, but the judges rejected this reasoning. "There cannot be a presumption in law that, after marriage, a daughter severs her ties with her parental family and resides with husband in her matrimonial home," the Court said.

The case arose from a Patna High Court judgment that upheld the rejection of the appellant's claim. Authorities had relied on two grounds: an objection raised by her maternal uncle and the 2014 policy. Counsel for the appellant pointed out that the uncle had already given a no-objection certificate Continued on P6

SIX INDIAN BOXERS ENTER FINALS

Asmita, Harsh script judo history

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: India enjoyed one of its finest days at the Commonwealth Games on Friday as the country's judokas won their first ever gold medals while its boxers completed a clean sweep of semifinal victories to move within touching distance of multiple titles. Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh became India's first Commonwealth Games judo champions, Yamini Mourya added a silver to complete the nation's best ever campaign in the sport, and Arundhati Choudhary, world champion Jaismine Lamboria, Preeti Pawar, Ankush Panghal, Sakshi Chaudhary and Jadumani Singh all advanced to their respective boxing finals. The performances underlined India's growing strength in combat sports and kept the country's gold hopes alive heading into the final day.

India finished the judo competition with two gold and one silver medal, its best performance since the sport was introduced at the Commonwealth Games in 1990. Continued on P6

Harsh Singh PTI

Asmita Dey PTI

SEEK PARLIAMENT'S ATTENTION

'Mob almost killed my father': Kin of cops hurt in CJP protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Family members of four Delhi Police personnel injured during the July 20 'Sansad Chalo' march called on Parliament to address the injuries suffered by the cops and the trauma endured by their families, saying public discourse focused largely on allegations of police excesses while ignoring "their side" of the violence.

Addressing a press conference at the Constitution Club of India on Friday, the wife of an ACP, the wife of an ASI, and the children of two injured officers recounted anxious hours spent waiting for calls from hospitals, seeing blood-soaked uniforms, and watching social media posts that, they alleged, portrayed only one version of the events.

Among the most emotional accounts was that of Kunjal, a Delhi University student whose father, a sub-inspector, was injured during the clashes. She said her father had served for 15 years as a Marine Commando in the Indian Navy before joining the police and was deployed on the front line near the barricades at Jantar Mantar.

"My father was present at the main protest site. He was on the front line near the barricades where there was a huge crowd. Whenever he returned home after duty, he would tell us that the protest no longer seemed like a student protest and that many anti-social elements had become involved," she said.

She alleged that on July 25, her father was dragged by a mob near the stage at Jantar Mantar and was "almost lynched."

"He remained unconscious at RML Hospital for about four hours. Around 10 pm, his colleagues brought him home. His uniform was completely stained with blood. It was extremely painful for us to see him in that condition," she said.

Family members of police personnel, who were injured during the protest march led by Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), during a press conference, at Constitution Club, on Friday PTI

Kunjal said what followed was equally distressing. "When I opened social media, my father had already been declared a criminal. The next day I learnt that the people who had attacked him were approaching the Supreme Court and filing complaints against police personnel. I felt I should also seek justice for my father. We too have equal rights as citizens, and we hope justice will be done," she said, adding that police families had approached lawyers to present their concerns before the top court.

Behind her, a slideshow displayed photographs of bleeding police personnel alongside figures that, the families claimed, reflected the scale of the violence.

The presentation claimed that over 250 police personnel were injured in the violence, while over 110 barricades, 300 body protectors, 350 helmets, 20 loudhailers, 10 hand-held metal detectors and one X-ray baggage scanner were damaged, with more than 25 government vehicles and private property vandalised.

Another student, Lakshya Singh, son of an injured ACP, said his family has a long history of public service, adding that his father is a recipient of four gallantry awards while his grandfather fought in the 1971 war as part of the Border Security Force (BSF). He said he learnt on July 25 that his father had suffered a serious head injury while on duty. "When I first saw him, his head had been shaved, and there were stitches. I was frightened," he said.

According to Lakshya, his father later told the family that while many students had gathered for the protest, some individuals used the occasion to create chaos.

"He was briefing his colleagues and trying to safeguard senior officers when stone-pelting suddenly started. A stone hit his head," he said.

Lakshya said he was frustrated that online discussions and even debates in Parliament focused only on allegations against the police.

"Whenever I go online, my friends send me reels where only the police are portrayed negatively. My father tells me not to pay attention, but it is frustrating that nobody is talking about the injured police personnel or their families," he said.

Seema, whose husband has served in Delhi Police for 33 years after joining as a constable and now serves as an assistant sub-inspector, said that July 20 began like any other working day. "He left home early in the morning carrying his tiffin. Around 11 am, he called and said there was a huge crowd at Jantar Mantar and protesters were preparing to march towards Parliament. As a police officer's wife, I only told him to take care," she said.

The next call came hours later from LNJP Hospital. "He told me some anti-social elements in the crowd attacked policemen with stones, flower pots, slippers and shoes. Soon after that, his phone battery died. I was terrified. He didn't return home until around 11 pm," she said.

Seema said her husband's protective helmet had been shattered during the violence.

"Had another stone struck his head after the helmet broke, he might not have survived. My soul trembled when I saw him. Since July 20, only one narrative has been discussed -- that police brutally assaulted students. That is only one side. I appeal to Parliament to also discuss what happened to police personnel and their families," she said.

The Gen Z-led protest witnessed clashes at several locations across central Delhi, including Parliament Street, Connaught Place and Jantar Mantar, where protesters and security personnel clashed. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

HIGHLIGHTS

- Among the most emotional accounts was that of Kunjal, a Delhi University student whose father, a sub-inspector, was injured during the clashes
- She said her father had served for 15 years as a Marine Commando in the Indian Navy before joining the police and was deployed on the front line near the barricades
- 'Whenever he returned home after duty, he would tell us that the protest no longer seemed like a student protest...'

Sense of justice, but fight not over: Ankit Sharma's family

NEW DELHI: The verdict brought relief, but not the brother they lost, the family of Intelligence Bureau staffer Ankit Sharma said on Friday after former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain and four others were sentenced to life imprisonment for his murder during the 2020 northeast Delhi riots.

"After almost six years of fighting this case, our family finally feels that we have received a sense of justice," Ankit's brother Ankur Sharma said. Calling it "a very long and painful journey", Ankur said there were times when it felt the legal process would never end, but the family continued to have faith in the judicial system. Friday's verdict, he said, had brought them "some relief" and a feeling that their years of waiting and struggle had not gone in vain.

He added that the family, however, has lived with the grief every single day over the past six years. He said that whenever his brother's case came up on television debates, in newspapers or even in conversations, it reopened wounds that had never really healed. Every discussion reminded them that Ankit was no longer with them. "It was emotionally very difficult for all of us, but we continued to hope that one day justice would be done," he said. Describing the verdict as a "bittersweet moment", Ankur said the judgment had acknowledged the gravity of the crime, but could never make up for the family's loss. "There is relief because the court has delivered a strong verdict. But there is an emptiness that no judgment can ever fill," he said. The pain is especially intense on family occasions. "My brother was born on February 2, 1994. He would have turned 32 this year," Ankur said. Every birthday reminds the family of the life he could have lived, the dreams he could have fulfilled and the moments they have lost forever, he said.

While welcoming the verdict, Ankur said the family's legal battle was not over. "Our fight is still not over," he said. Appealing to higher courts, he said the family hoped the case would be treated as one of the "rarest of rare" and that every person found guilty would receive the same punishment. "Only then will we feel that complete justice has been delivered to my brother and to our family," he said.

Meanwhile, Hussain said he would challenge the verdict. "Insaaf High Court se milega (Justice will come from the High Court)," he said while being escorted out of the courtroom after the sentencing. He further said, "The High Court will give justice; it is not too late."

Earlier, the Delhi Police had sought the death penalty for all five convicts, contending that the offence fell within the "rarest of rare" category. Special Public Prosecutor Madhukar Pandey argued that Sharma was brutally killed and no mercy had been shown to him during the assault. AGENCIES

CM welcomes life sentences

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday welcomed the court's decision sentencing former Aam Aadmi Party councillor Tahir Hussain and five others to life imprisonment in the murder case of Intelligence Bureau staffer Ankit Sharma, and accused the AAP leadership of backing Hussain despite his arrest. In a post on X, Gupta said, "We welcome the decision of the Hon'ble Court to sentence former Aam Aadmi Party councillor Tahir Hussain and five other convicts to life imprisonment in the murder case of the late IB officer Ankit Sharma." MPOST

HC seeks police's stand on Umar Khalid's bail plea in UAPA case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday sought the stand of the city police on a plea by activist Umar Khalid seeking bail in a case under the anti-terror law UAPA on the "larger conspiracy" behind the February 2020 riots in northeast Delhi.

Issuing a notice in the matter, a bench of Justices Prathiba M Singh and Vikas Mahajan asked Delhi Police to file its response within two weeks.

Khalid's counsel said it was the activist's third bail application since his arrest (in September 2020) and that he was also seeking interim bail in the case based on similar relief given to the other co-accused by the Supreme Court.

The bench said it will hear Khalid's plea on August 27, when the bail plea of co-accused Sharjeel Imam is also listed.

Khalid has challenged a trial court's July 4 decision dismissing his bail application.

Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, appearing for Delhi Police, said that the same trial court order also rejected Imam's bail plea, and both cases could be taken up together by the bench.

"Considering the overlapping nature of the matter, issue notice. Let reply be filed in two weeks. (List the matter for) August 27, along with Imam," the bench ordered.

Arrested in September 2020, Khalid has been booked under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) on allegations of being one of the masterminds of the February 2020 riots that left 53 people dead and more than 700 injured.

The violence erupted during protests against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA), 2019, and the National Register of Citizens (NRC).

ANTI-CRIME crackdown: 44 people arrested in N-W Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested 44 people, including three proclaimed offenders, in 34 criminal cases during a 72-hour crackdown in the northwest district, an official said on Friday.

Police also claimed to have traced five missing persons. The drive targeted street crime, organised criminal activities, cyber fraud, illegal liquor trade, gambling and habitual offenders across the district, they said.

Police said the five traced persons included four minors and one person with intellectual disability, all of whom were safely reunited with their families.

"Among the major cases, teams arrested a 28-year-old alleged burglar from Ashok Vihar and recovered stolen gold and silver jewellery from his possession. The accused, identified as Chandan alias Rahul, is a listed bad character with 34 criminal cases," a senior police officer said.

In another case, three men were arrested within eight hours of a robbery reported in the Subhash Place area. Police recovered the complainant's robbed cash, documents and a stolen scooter with a country-made pistol.

A suspected snatcher was also arrested in Mukherjee Nagar, leading to the recovery of five stolen mobile phones and a stolen motorcycle. Police said his involvement was established in 10 snatching and theft cases, while he has a criminal history of 41 cases. The district's cyber team also arrested two men in separate cyber fraud cases. One of them, arrested from West Bengal, is accused of cheating and sextortion through matrimonial websites involving over Rs 14 lakh.

Day before son's birthday, man shot dead outside home in outer Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 37-year-old man was shot dead outside his residence in outer Delhi's Kanjhawala, just a day before his younger son's first birthday, police said on Friday, adding that a possible gang rivalry angle is under probe.

The deceased, Harish Mathur, sustained three to four bullet injuries in the attack by two motorcycle-borne assailants near a school on Karala Road at around 11.15 pm, they said.

He was declared dead at the spot.

Crime and forensic teams examined the scene and collected evidence. Three to four empty cartridges and motorcycle tyre marks were found at the spot, an officer said.

An FIR has been registered and efforts are underway to identify and arrest the assailants, the officer said, adding that CCTV footage is also being checked.

According to the police, the manner in which the attack was carried out suggests it may have been a targeted killing. "All possible angles, including gang rivalry, are being investigated," the officer said.

The victim's wife claimed she had made a video call to her husband shortly before the incident and noticed an unidentified man standing behind him.

She alleged that the man abruptly disconnected the call.

"About 10 minutes later, I was informed that my husband had been shot dead. I suspect the same person was involved. I can identify him," she alleged.

Harish's father said he heard a loud sound outside the house while watching television and rushed out to find his son lying in a pool of blood.

"We have no known enmity with anyone. If he had any dispute elsewhere, he never told us," he said.

The deceased is survived by his wife and two sons. His younger son is set to celebrate his first birthday on Saturday.

Police sources said investigators are also looking into information suggesting the victim was in contact with some criminal elements and may have been called out of his house by an acquaintance before the shooting.

His alleged links with certain gang members and his reported involvement in property dealing are also being verified, the police source said.

No conclusion has been reached and the motive behind the murder will be established only after the investigation progresses, they added.

HONOURING SERVICE

Delhi Police on Friday conferred honorary ranks on 202 personnel on the day of their retirement at a ceremonial pipping ceremony held at the Police Headquarters MPOST

Three held for stealing PWD CCTV recorder

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested three people, including a scrap dealer, for allegedly stealing a CCTV digital video recorder installed by the PWD in northeast Delhi's Seelampur, officials said on Friday.

The police have also recovered the hard disk and cash from the sale of the stolen property, they added.

The theft took place on July 27 at J-Block in Seelampur, following which an e-FIR was registered.

During the investigation, CCTV footage was examined and two men -- Danish Ansari (30) and Arif Khan (27), both residents of Khajuri Khas -- were arrested on Thursday, the police said.

The police also found that Arif had previously worked with the PWD installing CCTV cameras and was familiar with DVRs and hard disk removals, which allegedly enabled him to carry out the theft.

> The police have also recovered the hard disk and cash from the sale of the stolen property

During the interrogation, the accused allegedly disclosed that they had sold the stolen DVR to a scrap dealer in Jahangirpuri.

Acting on the information, the police arrested Aasu (18), who allegedly purchased the stolen property, on the same day.

The stolen hard disk and Rs 48,000 in cash, suspected to be the proceeds from the sale of the DVR, were recovered from the accused, the police said.

Entrepreneur Dr Ritesh Malik acquires bungalow in Delhi's GOLF LINKS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Entrepreneur and investor Dr Ritesh Malik has purchased a bungalow in Golf Links, one of the most sought-after residential localities in Delhi's Lutyens' Bungalow Zone (LBZ), in a transaction facilitated by Sotheby's International Realty.

The acquisition marks Malik's entry into one of the capital's most exclusive neighbourhoods, traditionally home to established business families and diplomats. The purchase also reflects the growing presence of new-age entrepreneurs in the Lutyens' zone, following the success of India's startup ecosystem.

According to a statement, Malik plans to reconstruct the property before moving in, with the redevelopment expected to take around a year.

The statement said the deal builds on Malik's long association with Sotheby's International Realty, which dates back to the period when he was expanding Innov8 Coworking. Real estate also remains a key investment area for his family office, The Mangrove Holdings, which has invested alongside developers, including Max Estates, in projects across Noida and Gurugram.

Golf Links is considered one of the country's most prestigious residential addresses because of its low-density planning, central location, proximity to key government institutions and extensive green cover. The locality is home to several prominent industrial families and has also attracted entrepreneurs and public figures in recent years. A medical doctor by training, Malik founded Innov8 Coworking in 2015. The company expanded to over 60 locations before being acquired by SoftBank-backed OYO. Through The Mangrove Holdings, he has since invested in more than 125 startups across sectors.

DU prof sent into forced retirement for sexual harassment

NEW DELHI: A faculty member of the Delhi University's Department of Political Science has been given compulsory retirement following the recommendations of the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) over an alleged sexual harassment complaint, officials said on Friday.

The recommendations were accepted by the university's Executive Council (EC) at its meeting held on Thursday, an official said.

"Following an ICC recommendation, the professor's penalty was compulsory retirement. The original complaint pertained to a student allegedly being harassed," the official told PTI.

According to the official, the complaint is at least a year old, and the ICC report was cleared and accepted by the EC during Thursday's meeting. PTI

City Briefs

PRIVATE BANK EMPLOYEE AMONG 2 ARRESTED FOR CREDIT CARD FRAUD

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has busted a credit card fraud racket with the arrest of a serving and a former private bank employee, who allegedly misused customer data and internal banking processes to obtain replacement cards and siphon off credit limits, officials said on Friday.

TWO GANG-LINKED SHOOTERS WANTED IN MURDER CASE HELD AFTER ENCOUNTER

NEW DELHI: Two alleged sharpshooters linked to the Himanshu Bhau-Vicky Hadal crime syndicate and wanted in the murder of a 45-year-old man in outer Delhi's Bawana earlier this month, were arrested following an encounter in Rohini, an officer said on Friday.

WOMAN FOUND MURDERED IN JAGATPURI

NEW DELHI: A 50-year-old woman was found murdered at her house in Delhi's Jagatpuri, police said on Friday. A PCR call reporting the murder was received at Jagatpuri police station at 9 pm on Thursday, they said. A police team rushed to the spot and found the woman, Komal, lying dead on the floor of the house. The crime team was called to inspect the scene and collect forensic evidence and the body was shifted to the GTB Hospital mortuary for postmortem.

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Printed and Published by Jaiyendra Kumar Sharma on behalf of Front Row Media Pvt. Ltd. and printed at The Indian Express Pvt. Ltd., A-8, Sector-7, Noida-201 301 (U.P.) and published from First Floor, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002. Editor: Durbar Ganguly. Email: editor@millenniumpost.in, Tel. No. 011-47777500, Kolkata office: Room No 1,15th Floor, Chatterjee International Centre, 33A Jawaharlal Nehru Road, Kolkata 700071 West Bengal, Siliguri Office: Techno India Group Zonal Office G-212, 2nd Floor Office Block - City Centre Matigara District Darjeeling Pin - 734010 Phone- 0353- 2576321

नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

दिल्ली लक्ष्मी योजना

प्रतिमाह

दिल्ली की जरूरतमंद बहनों के लिए
आत्मनिर्भरता की नई शुरुआत

योजना की पात्रता, आवश्यक दस्तावेज़ एवं आवेदन प्रक्रिया की विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए

QR स्कैन करें

DIP/SHABDARTH/DISPLAY/062/26-27

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार

FOR SEAMLESS WELFARE BENEFITS

Soon, one card for every Delhi family

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is working on a Family Card initiative that will create a single verified database for every household in the Capital, a move aimed at streamlining the implementation of welfare schemes and improving beneficiary verification. The proposal is part of the government's broader governance roadmap and is expected to become the primary identity document for families seeking benefits under various state schemes.

According to officials, the Family Card will contain details of every member of a household, including basic personal information, vaccination records and other essential data. By consolidating information on a single platform, the government intends to minimise duplication, simplify eligibility checks and ensure faster delivery of welfare benefits.

The card is expected to play a crucial role in implementing the recently approved Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, under which eligible women will receive Rs 2,500 per month. Since one of the eligibility conditions disqualifies women with more than three living children, officials said the Family Card would help verify family composition before benefits are released.

It is also likely to be integrated with the Delhi Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana, which has replaced the earlier Ladli Scheme. The programme provides financial support for up to two girls in a family through phased deposits of Rs.56,000, which grow to over Rs.1 lakh, along with accrued interest, by the time the beneficiary completes graduation.

> The administration had spent its first year addressing issues inherited from the previous govt
>
> — CM REKHA GUPTA

Additionally, speaking about her government's performance and future priorities, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the administration had spent its first year addressing issues inherited from the previous government.

"We worked on the challenges we got from the previous government. The work that the previous government did in five years, we have done in only one and a quarter years," she said, adding that her Cabinet had held 36 meetings and taken 175 decisions so far.

Officials said the Family Card is envisioned as a common platform that can be linked to multiple welfare programmes in the future, reducing paperwork and enabling departments to access verified household data through a unified system.

Separately, the Delhi government is preparing to introduce the Delhi Land Records Bill, 2026, which proposes a comprehensive digital database of all properties in the Capital. The legislation will pave the way for assigning a unique Property Aadhaar Card to every property after a citywide survey of both rural and urban areas.

The move builds on the implementation of the Centre's SVAMITVA scheme in 30 rural villages, where digital property cards have already been prepared. The government expects the expanded system to create authenticated ownership records and help reduce property-related disputes across Delhi.

Vidya Vahini: Wheels of change for Delhi girls

CM HANDS BICYCLES TO 3,000+ CLASS IX GOVT SCHOOLGIRLS

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday launched the Delhi government's 'Vidya Vahini' scheme, distributing free bicycles to more than 3,000 Class IX girl students from government schools at a programme held at the Sports Complex in East Vinod Nagar. The government said nearly 1.4 lakh girl students studying in Delhi government schools will receive free bicycles in a phased rollout.

Interacting with students, Gupta asked them about their studies, aspirations and future goals. The students presented her with handmade paintings, which she appreciated. Calling the initiative a step towards empowering girls through education, Gupta said, "Vidya Vahini is a celebration of our collective commitment to empowering every daughter." She added that the scheme aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of women-led development and a Viksit Bharat. Announcing the wider rollout, the Chief Minister said, "Around 1,40,000 girl students studying in Delhi government schools will receive free bicycles in a phased manner," adding that the scheme would continue in the coming years to ensure safer and more convenient travel to school, improve attendance, reduce dropouts and ease parents' concerns.

Emphasising the symbolic value of the initiative, Gupta said, "A bicycle is not just a means of transport; it is a symbol of freedom, dignity and self-reliance for our daughters." She described education as the strongest foundation for empowerment and urged students to use the bicycles responsibly while following traffic rules. Education Minister Ashish Sood said the scheme reflects the Delhi government's focus on girls' education under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. "The education, safety and empowerment of girls are the Delhi Government's highest priorities," he said.

Sood said many girls face difficulties in continuing their education after Class IX due to the increased distance to schools and transportation challenges. He said the Vidya Vahini scheme aims to remove these barriers and ensure that education is treated as a means of nation-building by addressing the practical needs of students.

Union Minister of State and Delhi BJP President Harsh Malhotra, Patparganj MLA Ravinder Singh Negi, Director of Education and Sports Nitin Jindal, teachers, parents and students were present at the event.

Relief for Delhi commuters as Barapullah corridor complete

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a major relief to commuters between East and South Delhi, phase III of the signal-free Barapullah elevated corridor is finally complete after a delay of over a decade, and is expected to open for traffic in August, officials said on Friday. The Public Works Department (PWD) of the Delhi government has communicated to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta seeking time for the formal inauguration of the crucial road link in the national capital. This 3.5-kilometre elevated corridor, which has missed several deadlines since construction began in 2015, will connect Sarai Kale Khan in East Delhi with AIIMS in South Delhi.

Officials stated that once the corridor is operational, commuters travelling from Mayur Vihar and nearby areas to Sarai Kale Khan, AIIMS, and South Delhi will benefit from largely signal-free movement. This will significantly reduce travel time and alleviate congestion at major traffic bottlenecks such as NH-24, DND Flyway, Ring Road, and Sarai Kale Khan. Approved in 2014, the project faced multiple delays and substantial cost increases, with the revised projected cost now amounting to Rs 1,635 crore.

Pink ticket facility extended till Aug 15

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has extended the pink ticket facility for women passengers on Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses until August 15, an official order said on Friday.

Previously, the transport department had directed that the 'Pink Saheli' smart card would become mandatory starting in August.

"It has been decided to extend the existing arrangement to facilitate a smooth transition to the smart card-based system. Accordingly, the instructions shall be complied with in all DTC buses with immediate effect," a DTC order said.

Until August 15, conductors will continue to issue pink tickets to women passengers, and these tickets will remain valid for free travel as part of the programme.

"With effect from August 16, pink tickets shall be issued only to those women passengers who have a valid Pink Saheli Smart Card and use the same in the prescribed manner at the time of travel. From August 16 onwards, women passengers who do not possess a valid Pink Card shall not be issued pink tickets and shall be required to purchase normal tickets on payment of the applicable fare for travel," the order further said.

So far, around 17 lakh cards have been distributed across the city, and the government aims to increase these figures by the end of August, after which the card will be made mandatory.

Concerned over the slow adoption of the Pink Saheli card by women commuters, the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) had launched a special drive across its buses advising women to get the cards, officials added.

According to officials, it has been decided to gradually phase out the existing paper-based pink ticket and shift to a smart card-based system for availing the benefit of free bus travel.

"All eligible women under the scheme may obtain the Pink Saheli smart card from the notified centres and counters as per the directions issued by the transport department and DTC from time to time," they said.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Previously, the transport department had directed that the 'Pink Saheli' smart card would become mandatory starting in August
- 'It has been decided to extend the existing arrangement to facilitate a smooth transition to the smart card-based system'
- 'Accordingly, the instructions shall be complied with in all DTC buses with immediate effect'
- Until Aug 15, conductors will continue to issue pink tickets to women passengers, and these tickets will remain valid for free travel as part of the programme

Green drive: One lakh trees planted across Delhi in a day

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Development Authority (DDA) on Friday organised a massive single day plantation drive across Delhi, planting over one lakh native trees and shrubs at 77 locations as part of its large scale ecological restoration programme.

The initiative was among DDA's largest coordinated plantation drives. Lieutenant Governor of Delhi Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu led the drive at Kamla Nehru Ridge, where he planted native saplings along with around 200 participants, including students from St. Stephen's, Hindu, Hans Raj and Maharishi Valmiki colleges, students from Mamta Public School, Vikas Puri and Government Girls Senior Secondary School, Shakti Nagar, morning walkers and around 20 Resident Welfare Association members.

Sandhu directed DDA to make such plantation drives a regular practice and replicate the model across other Ridges in Delhi. Emphasising youth participation, he said such exercises should be driven by and aimed at the youth so that future generations become stakeholders in preserving and restoring ecology. He underlined the responsibility of the present generation to hand over an ecologically rich Delhi to those who come after.

The L-G also directed DDA to play a proactive role in increasing Delhi's green cover and appointed nodal officers for each plantation site to ensure the survival and growth of saplings, with the officers being held accountable.

The Kamla Nehru Ridge plantation included indigenous species such as Dhok, Amaltas, Dhak and Gamhar. Simultaneous drives were held at 76 other locations, including Aravalli Biodiversity Park, Aastha Kunj Park, Sanjay Van, Narela, Paschim Puri, Hauz Khas, Vasant Udyan and Dilshad Garden Deer Park. The drive included Peepal, Neem, Jamun, Arjun, Shisham, Calendar Tecoma, Bougainvillea, Murraya, Hamelia and Chandni. The LG also reviewed hydrological restoration works at the Serpentine Lake and Butterfly Conservatory.

The drive is part of the 70 Lakh Plantation Mission under 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam', under which DDA has been entrusted with planting 23 lakh indigenous saplings, including a target of 1,81,700 trees and shrubs in the Ridge area during the current plantation season.

Dark spots on Kanwar routes being removed: Minister Kapil Mishra

NEW DELHI: Delhi minister Kapil Mishra on Friday said the government has launched a drive to remove dark spots and improve lighting along the Kanwar Yatra routes, while warning commuters to expect traffic disruptions as lakhs of pilgrims pass through the national capital during the annual pilgrimage.

Mishra further said Chief Minister Rekha Gupta held several meetings to review preparations, including lighting, sanitation, toilets, traffic management and facilities at Kanwar camps.

"Under the leadership of the chief minister, a special campaign is being run to eliminate dark spots. District magistrates have been instructed to ensure proper cleanliness and lighting along the Kanwar routes," he said.

He said that liquor and meat shops along Kanwar routes would remain closed during the yatra and that the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) had issued the necessary directions.

The MCD has directed its 12 zones to shut unauthorised meat shops and take action against licensed outlets violating permit conditions along Kanwar routes and near Kanwar camps. It has also asked officials to complete civic arrangements before the yatra, during which 308 Kanwar camps will operate across Delhi from July 30 to August 11.

Mishra mentioned that traffic diversions would be enforced wherever required in coordination with the Delhi Police, Traffic Police and Civil Defence.

"Crores of Kanwar pilgrims pass through Delhi, so there will be some traffic issues. Vehicles will be diverted wherever necessary. Around the time devotees offer jal, there could be delays because of the crowd," he said.

He said that welcome gates were being erected and arrangements for the stay of pilgrims had been made with the help of Kanwar Seva Samitis. PTI

Drone, UAV ban imposed across Delhi ahead of I- Day

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has prohibited the flying of drones, UAVs, hot air balloons, para-gliders and other sub-conventional aerial platforms across the national capital for 15 days ahead of Independence Day celebrations, citing security concerns.

In an order issued on Friday, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar said intelligence inputs indicated that criminal, anti-social elements or terrorists inimical to India could use such aerial platforms to pose a threat to the general public, dignitaries and vital installations.

The order prohibits the operation of para-gliders, para-motors, hang-gliders, unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), unmanned aircraft systems (UASs), microlight aircraft, remotely piloted aircraft, hot air balloons, small-sized powered aircraft, quadcopters and para-jumping from aircraft across the National Capital Territory of Delhi. The restrictions have been imposed under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023, and violation of the order will attract action under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023, the order said.

MCD PLANS CITYWIDE LEAGUES

Game on, Delhi!

VARUN BHANDARI/PTI

NEW DELHI: Thousands of young footballers and cricketers in the national capital who spend their evenings playing sport in school playgrounds and neighbourhood parks could soon find themselves playing in a citywide league.

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is planning to launch its own mini football and cricket leagues for children in the Under-9 and Under-11 age groups, tentatively titled ' Mini League' hoping to nurture talent from the grassroots while giving the city's youngest players a competitive platform of their own. The proposal, which is awaiting administrative approval, envisages the leagues beginning as early as October this year, officials said.

The civic body plans to organise separate football and cricket leagues for boys and girls in the Under-9 and Under-11 categories. Each sport will feature 84 teams, with each of the MCD's 12 zones fielding seven teams.

Officials said one team in each zone will comprise students from MCD schools, while the remaining six teams will come from private schools, sports academies, institutional clubs and neighbourhood teams.

An official notice inviting participation from private teams will be issued after the proposal receives formal approval.

"The idea is to create a structured grassroots competition where children from municipal schools get an opportunity to compete regularly alongside other teams from across the city," an official said.

The initiative is designed around the concept of community sports clubs and seeks to integrate more than 1,500 MCD schools into zonal sporting networks.

Participation for MCD schools, teams and students will be free, with the civic body seeking to remove financial barriers that often prevent children from disadvantaged backgrounds from taking part in organised sport.

Private schools, academies and community teams, however, will participate through a structured registration and management fee. According to officials, the revenue generated from these registrations, along with corporate social responsibility (CSR) partnerships, will be used to meet operational expenses. Any annual surplus is proposed to be invested in upgrading sports infrastructure in identified MCD schools, officials added. The leagues will follow a four-tier structure comprising Diamond, Gold, Silver and Bronze divisions, with promotion and relegation between tiers based on performance.

Officials said a dedicated digital sports management portal will be developed for paperless registrations, age verification, scheduling, live score tracking and automated match statistics. The platform will also create digital athlete profiles to help monitor players' progress over time. The proposal also includes prize money for winning teams, although the amount is yet to be finalised.

NDMC inaugurates AI, AR and VR lab at Navyug School in Sarojini Nagar

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Friday inaugurated an Artificial Intelligence (AI), Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR)-based experiential learning lab at its Navyug School in Sarojini Nagar, aiming to introduce technology-enabled learning for students from Classes six to ten. According to NDMC, the lab has been equipped with eight VR headsets and digital content covering more than 70 CBSE curricular and co-curricular topics. Students will be able to explore subjects such as artificial intelligence, robotics, quantum computing, space science and nanotechnology through interactive modules.

The facility, named Viksit Bharat Anubhavshala, was inaugurated by NDMC Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal.

Chahal, in a statement, said the lab would make learning more interactive and help students understand emerging technologies through immersive experiences. He said the initiative is in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and has been developed in collaboration with edtech firm Homi Lab.

The civic body said the facility will also allow students to take virtual tours of historical monuments, museums and the solar system, conduct virtual science experiments, visualise mathematical concepts and study topics such as human anatomy and ecosystems using 3D simulations. PTI

City Briefs

DELHI RECORDS MAX TEMPERATURE OF 35 DEG C; LIGHT RAIN LIKELY TODAY

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 35 degrees Celsius on Friday, 0.6 degrees above normal, as the India Meteorological Department (IMD) forecast a generally cloudy sky with light rain for Saturday. At the city's main weather station, Safdarjung, the maximum temperature reached 35 degrees Celsius, while Palam recorded 33.5 degrees Celsius, 1.4 degrees below normal. Lodhi Road had a maximum of 33.6 degrees Celsius, 0.6 degrees above normal; Ridge reported 33.4 degrees Celsius, 0.8 degrees below normal; and Ayanagar noted 33.1 degrees Celsius, 1.3 degrees below normal. As for the minimum temperature, it settled at 27.2 degrees Celsius at Safdarjung, 0.1 notch above normal.

BJP LEADER BOOKED FOR ASSAULTING COUPLE OVER GARBAGE DUMPING ROW

GURUGRAM: A residents' welfare association (RWA) office-bearer and his wife were allegedly assaulted with sticks by a local BJP leader and his associates following a dispute over garbage dumping in a housing society here, police said on Friday. The incident occurred late Thursday night in Block H of Ansal Versalia Society in Sector 67. Police said an FIR has been registered against BJP leader Manish Harsana, husband of the councillor of Ward 15, and others. A video of the incident, purportedly showing the assault, surfaced on social media.

LEGISLATION CLEARED WITHOUT A DEBATE

Amid protests: Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 passed in LS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Lok Sabha on Friday passed the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026, amid Opposition protests over the police crackdown on students during the July 20 Parliament march, with the legislation being cleared without a debate.

The Bill was taken up for consideration and passage after the House reassembled at noon with BJP MP Dilip Saikia in the Chair. It was passed by voice vote amid sloganeering by Opposition members, several of whom trooped into the Well demanding the presence of Home Minister Amit Shah in the House.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju expressed displeasure over the Opposition's refusal to participate in the debate, saying the government wanted a discussion on the "important Bill".

Opposition MPs stage a protest in the Lok Sabha during the ongoing Monsoon session of Parliament, in New Delhi, Friday PTI

"It is unfortunate. Please do not repeat this in the future. People who sent you to Parliament will seek answers from you," Rijiju said, urging Opposition members to participate in debates on future legislation instead of creating disruptions.

Saikia also said it was "unfortunate" that the Bill had to be passed without the cooperation of Opposition members.

Soon after its passage, the House was adjourned for the day.

The Bill seeks to amend provisions of the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969, to encourage timely reporting of vital events.

The Bill seeks to make delayed registration of births and deaths more stringent by requiring an order from a judicial magistrate (first class) for registrations made more than two years after the event.

Under the existing law, registrations delayed by more than one year require an order from a district magistrate, sub-divisional magistrate, or an authorised executive magistrate, and the provision will continue to apply for delays of up to two years under the amended law.

The legislation was cleared for introduction by the Union Cabinet on July 20 and proposes further changes to the delayed registration process following amendments made to the parent Act in 2023.

The Bill also updates legal definitions, aligning the term "executive magistrate" with the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, replacing previous references to the 1973 Code of Criminal Procedure.

With the passage of the Bill in Lok Sabha, the government has pushed through another piece of legislation amid disruptions in Parliament during the Monsoon Session.

So far, two Bills -- the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 and the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 -- have cleared both Houses of Parliament in the current session.

The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 now awaits Rajya Sabha approval.

Highlights

- The Bill seeks to amend provisions of the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969, to encourage timely reporting of vital events
- The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 now awaits Rajya Sabha approval

Taslima Nasreen returns to Kolkata after nearly 19 years

Describing the visit as an emotional homecoming

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Exiled Bangladeshi author Taslima Nasreen returned to Kolkata on Friday after nearly 19 years, describing the visit as an emotional homecoming to a city she still considers her own.

Arriving at Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport, Nasreen greeted those waiting to receive her with folded hands and said, "I am feeling very good to be back."

Her return marks her first visit to the city since November 2007, when she left following violent protests over her writings.

On Saturday, she will make her first public appearance at an anti-fundamentalism literary programme at Rabindra Sadan, where she is expected to recite poetry. Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari and noted author Shirshendu Mukhopadhyay are among those expected to attend.

Nasreen also thanked the organisers and the present West Bengal government for facilitating her visit and providing security, while asserting that a writer's freedom should remain a fundamental right irrespective of the ideology of the government in power.

After fleeing Bangladesh in 1994 following death threats over her novel Lajja, Nasreen settled in Kolkata in 2004. She left the city in 2007 after protests over her memoir Dwikhandito.

The BJP has described her return as a reaffirmation of free speech, while previous Left Front and Trinamool Congress governments had maintained that the decision requiring her to leave was taken to preserve public order amid escalating communal tensions.

Takeaways

- Her return marks her first visit to the city since November 2007, when she left following violent protests over her writings
- On Saturday, she will make her first public appearance at an anti-fundamentalism literary programme at Rabindra Sadan
- After fleeing Bangladesh in 1994 following death threats over her novel Lajja, Nasreen settled in Kolkata in 2004

KC Venugopal submits privilege motion notice against Jitendra Singh

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress MP K C Venugopal on Friday submitted a notice to move a privilege motion against Union Minister Jitendra Singh over his statement that "no firing took place" during the recent student protests.

He alleged that Singh deliberately provided incorrect information and misled the House.

In the letter submitted to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, Venugopal said he wants to raise a privilege issue regarding a statement made by Jitendra Singh on the floor of the House on July 29, during a discussion on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026.

Cong MP alleged that Singh deliberately provided incorrect information and misled the House

"While replying in the House, Dr Jitendra Singh categorically stated, 'Secondly, it has been repeatedly clarified that no firing took place at all, tear gas was used; so when no firing took place at all, the question of giving an order does not arise'," he said, giving an English translation of Singh's remarks.

Venugopal, the Congress general secretary in-charge of organisation, contended that this statement stands in direct contradiction to the facts on the ground.

"Contrary to the minister's assertions, firing did occur. The injured person is still under medication, with data available in the public domain. By falsely claiming on the floor of the House that no firing took place, the minister has knowingly and deliberately provided incorrect information to Parliament and misled the House," Venugopal said.

The letter said it is well established that misleading the House constitutes a breach of privilege and contempt of the House. "A minister is expected to verify facts before placing them on record in the supreme legislative body of the country," it said.

Student protest: IYC demands judicial probe in security breach

NEW DELHI: The Indian Youth Congress (IYC) has demanded a judicial inquiry into what it alleges was a deliberate security breach during the July 20 Parliament Street protest, citing the appearance of a truck laden with stones parked outside its office near the heavily cordoned Lutyens' Delhi area.

The IYC president Uday Bhanu Chib claimed the truck, which allegedly met with an accident on July 16 and remained in police custody for four days, mysteriously reappeared at the protest site loaded with projectiles. MPOST

Pappu Yadav stages Ram Temple donation theft skit

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A saffron-clad Independent MP Pappu Yadav along with other Opposition MPs enacted "theft" of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya in Parliament complex on Friday.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and former party chief Rahul Gandhi were part of the protest against the theft of donations, as well as police crackdown against student agitators during their July 20 march to Parliament.

Independent MP Pappu Yadav in saffron attire at Parliament complex, in New Delhi, Friday PTI

Protesting in front of Makar Dwar of Parliament, the lawmakers raised such slogans as 'Amit Shah istifa do', 'Amit Shah sadan mein aao' and 'chadhawa chor, gaddi chorh'.

The MPs kept donation boxes in front of the Makar Dwar steps and Independent MP Rajesh Ranjan, known as Pappu Yadav, dressed in saffron, sat with the boxes.

As part of a skit, enacted by the MPs, including Rahul Gandhi, put money inside the boxes, as Yadav slipped money into his pockets to symbolise the alleged theft at the Ram Temple.

Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Samajwadi Party's Awadhesh Prasad and Dharmendra Yadav, and Jharkhand Mukti Morcha's Mahua Maji, were among the others who participated in the protest.

The INDIA Bloc has said it will corner the government on issues of alleged donation theft and the use of "brutal force" against students during their protests over the NEET paper leak.

SC agrees to dissolve J&K CM Omar's marriage with estranged wife

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday agreed to dissolve the marriage of Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah with his estranged wife Payal Abdullah after taking note of their submissions that they have "embraced freedom".

The apex court took note of the submissions of senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the National Conference leader, that an application has been filed under Article 142 of the Constitution seeking dissolution of marriage as the parties have settled the matter.

"We will make it a part of our order and will dispose of it in terms of that," a bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said.

The bench will pass a formal order.

"Both of them have embraced freedom. It's all settled. (Article) 142 filed. Your lordships may grant divorce," Sibal told the bench.

"When did this application come on record?" the bench asked.

It was informed that the application was filed on July 22.

"All other matters will be withdrawn. It is all set out (in the application)," Sibal said.

The bench was hearing two pleas, including the one filed by Omar Abdullah seeking divorce on the grounds of cruelty.

In July 2024, the apex court had sought response from Payal Abdullah on Omar Abdullah's plea challenging an order of the Delhi High Court.

On December 12, 2023, the high court dismissed Omar Abdullah's plea seeking a divorce, saying there was no merit in his appeal.

The high court upheld the 2016 family court order refusing to grant a decree of divorce to him.

'Well-known personality to attend AAP's Aug 1 town hall against E20 fuel'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor Arvind Kejriwal on Friday said a 'well-known personality' would attend the party's 'National Town Hall Against E20' scheduled to be held in the national capital on Saturday.

In a post on X, Kejriwal said, "Tomorrow, at the 'National Town Hall Against E20', a well-known personality from the country will be with me to listen to people's problems and to take a decision on E20."

He also appealed to people to attend the event and share their views.

Kejriwal had earlier announced that the town hall against E20 would be held at the Constitution Club of India on August 1.

Arvind Kejriwal

Kejriwal also appealed to people to attend the event and share their views

"We are inviting people to join in large numbers on this platform where we will discuss how to create pressure on the central government to withdraw E20 petrol. Experts and people who have faced problems with their vehicles are also invited," he had said.

The AAP had also launched an online petition seeking to make E20 fuel optional, which, according to the party, has received nearly two lakh signatures.

MEA: 2 dozen Indians still working with Russian Army

Efforts are on to secure their release, assures ministry

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: New Delhi has been repeatedly asking Russia to release all Indians serving as support staff, such as cooks and helpers, with Russian military units.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal called upon Indians to stay away from job offers which are "fraught" with risks.

The government's efforts have led to the release of 139 Indian nationals so far, he said.

"We have been following up with the Russian side for the release of the remaining Indian nationals with the Russian army. Our efforts have led to the release of 139 Indian nationals so far," Jaiswal said at his regular media briefing.

"We continue to pursue the release of around two dozen Indian nationals who reportedly joined and still remain with the Russian army," he said.

"We once again caution our people against job offers that are fraught with risks and made by unscrupulous individuals or agencies."

Over 30 Indians have died so far while serving with the Russian military on the frontlines of the conflict in Ukraine.

In a related development, the Supreme Court on Friday directed the Centre to appoint a nodal officer in the external affairs ministry to coordinate with the families of those who have died, gone missing, or suffered injuries while fighting in the Russia-Ukraine war.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was hearing a plea pertaining to Indian nationals recruited into the Russian military after being allegedly duped by travel agents.

The plea seeks return of mortal remains, compensation and a coordinated mechanism for affected families.

Key Points

- Randhir Jaiswal called upon Indians to stay away from job offers which are "fraught" with risks
- Over 30 Indians have died so far while serving with the Russian military on the frontlines of the conflict in Ukraine
- A bench comprising CJI was hearing a plea pertaining to Indian nationals recruited into the Russian military after being allegedly duped by travel agents
- New Delhi: India on Friday said around two dozen Indian nationals are still serving in the Russian Army and efforts are underway to secure their release.

ITC Limited

Extract of Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th June, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		3 Months ended 30.06.2026	Twelve Months ended 31.03.2026	Corresponding 3 Months ended 30.06.2025	3 Months ended 30.06.2026	Twelve Months ended 31.03.2026	Corresponding 3 Months ended 30.06.2025
1	Total Income from Operations	27588.56	84927.29	21731.84	30179.01	92339.13	23811.56
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and Exceptional Items)	4759.41	26951.47	6543.48	5454.97	28325.09	7128.01
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional Items)	4759.41	26767.60	6543.48	5860.85	28033.39	7128.01
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional Items)	3578.82	20286.42	4910.73	4508.79	21018.15	5343.41
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	4021.93	19476.46	5099.56	4874.50	20374.86	5557.46
6	Equity Share Capital	1252.95	1252.95	1251.75	1252.95	1252.95	1251.75
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)		68675.66			71254.35	
8	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 1/- each) (not annualised):						
	1. Basic (₹):	2.86	16.20	3.93	3.51	16.52	4.19
	2. Diluted (₹):	2.86	16.19	3.92	3.51	16.51	4.18

Note:

a) The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statements of Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The unaudited Financial Results and Segment Results were reviewed by the Audit Committee, and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at its meeting held on 31st July, 2026. The complete Statements of Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results are available on the Company's website at https://itcportal.com/investors/quarterly-results.html and on the websites of the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (www.nseindia.com) and BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com). The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below.

b) Sproutlife Foods Private Limited ('Sproutlife') became a subsidiary of the Company with effect from 1st April, 2026, consequent to the Company acquiring the right to nominate majority of Directors on its Board. In accordance with Ind AS 103- Business Combinations, the Group has re-measured its existing interest in Sproutlife at fair value. The gain on remeasurement of ₹ 405.88 crores has been recognised as 'Exceptional Items' in the Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter ended 30th June, 2026.

c) The Limited Review for the Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results, as required under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, has been completed by the Statutory Auditors of the Company, who have issued an unmodified report on the same which has been forwarded to the Stock Exchanges.

Registered Office:
Virginia House, 37 J.L. Nehru Road,
Kolkata 700 071, India
Dated: 31st July, 2026
Place: Kolkata, India

For and on behalf of the Board

Sd/-
Director & Chief Financial Officer
(DIN: 01804345)

Sd/-
Chairman & Managing Director
(DIN: 00280529)

The Financial Results along with the Limited Review Reports have been posted on the Company's website at www.itcportal.com and can be accessed by scanning the QR Code.

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Enduring Value

FMCG | Paperboards & Packaging | Agri Business | Information Technology

L-G, POLITICAL PARTIES CONDEMN TERROR ATTACK

Terrorists target non-local labourers in J&K's Kulgam; 1 killed, another injured

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SRINAGAR: A labourer from Chhattisgarh was killed and another from the same state was injured in a terrorist attack at a brick kiln in Jammu and Kashmir's Kulgam district on Friday, officials said.

The assailants targeted the labourers at the brick kiln in the Kelam area of the south Kashmir district late in the evening.

Officials stated that two labourers were injured in the attack, and one of them succumbed to his injuries before he could be transported to a hospital.

The deceased has been identified as Deepak Ratray (24), and the injured labourer is Bopinder (28), both hailing from Chhattisgarh.

Bopinder was first taken to GMC Anantnag and later referred to SKIMS Hospital in Soura, officials added.

The attack follows closely on the heels of another incident less than ten days ago, in which terrorists shot and killed a police officer in Anantnag town.

Before this, two labourers were killed here in the summer capital of Jammu and Kashmir in 2024.

On February 7, 2024, two non-local workers from Punjab, Amritpal Singh and Rohit Masih, were shot dead by a terrorist in the Shaheed Gunj area of Srinagar.

Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha on Friday condemned the terror attack on non-local labourers in Kulgam district and directed security forces to step up operations to eliminate terrorists.

"I spoke with the DGP, Shri Nalin Prabhat and top security officials following the brutal terrorist attack in Kulgam in which a labourer from Chhattisgarh was killed. I strongly condemn this cowardly act. I have directed our security forces to step up their operations and eliminate the terrorists," the L-G said in a post on X.

He said the J-K Police and security forces have cordoned off the area and launched an operation to bring the perpetrators to justice.

Security personnel stand guard as they keep a vigil at a barricaded road after suspected terrorists opened fire on non-local labourers at a brick kiln, in Kulgam district, Jammu and Kashmir, Friday PTI

Highlights

- The assailants targeted the labourers at the brick kiln in the Kelam area of the south Kashmir district late in the evening
- Officials stated that two labourers were injured in the attack, and one of them succumbed to his injuries before he could be transported to hospital

Asmita, Harsh script judo history

Continued from Page 1

Before Friday, Indian judokas had won medals at every edition but had never claimed a title.

The breakthrough came through 23-year-old Asmita Dey, who became the first Indian judoka to win Commonwealth Games gold after defeating Canada's Heidi Quach in the women's 48kg final. Trailing after conceding an early yuko and a penalty, Asmita fought back to level the contest before scoring the decisive yuko in the golden score period to seal a memorable victory.

Minutes later, Harsh Singh added another chapter to Indian judo history by defeating Australia's experienced Joshua Katz in the men's 60kg final.

Locked in a tactical contest, Harsh produced a decisive waza ari with 41 seconds remaining and defended strongly to overcome the Birmingham Games bronze medallist and multiple Oceania champion. "Hearing the national anthem because of me is very special. I dedicate this medal to my mother," Harsh said after becoming India's first male Commonwealth Games judo champion.

India narrowly missed completing a clean sweep of the judo finals as Yamini Mourya settled for silver in the women's 57kg category after losing to England's Acelya Toprak in a hard-fought golden score contest.

Shraddha Kadubal Chopade and Rohit Basir Majgul, meanwhile, bowed out in their respective repechage bouts. For Asmita, the historic gold carried significance far beyond the medal itself.

The judoka from Belonia in South Tripura dedicated the triumph to her late father, a bicycle mechanic who earned around Rs 300 a day and continued supporting her sporting ambitions despite the family's financial struggles. Living in a modest mud house, the family had little to spare, but her father never allowed money to become a barrier to her career.

"When my father passed away, I thought everything was over because he was the one who always believed in me," Asmita said. Her father died of a brain stroke in December, leaving her devastated and unsure whether to continue competing. It was her coach and later her mother who persuaded her to return to training, reminding her that giving up would mean abandoning the dream they had all shared.

Asmita resumed training at the Sports Authority of India centre in Bhopal, where she rebuilt her confidence with support from coaches and officials.

She said the weeks before the Games were filled with anxiety and sleepless nights.

"I couldn't sleep before the competition. I kept thinking about the fights and telling myself I had to beat everyone," she said.

The sacrifices extended beyond training. She avoided sweets for a long period to maintain her competition weight, resisting the temptation of her favourite 'laung latta' waiting at home. While Indian judo celebrated a historic breakthrough, the country's boxers produced an equally commanding display by winning all six semifinal bouts to assure themselves of at least silver medals.

Arundhati Choudhary produced one of the biggest results of the day, upsetting defending champion Rosie Eccles of Wales 4-0 in the women's 70kg semifinal.

World champion Jaismine Lamboria also advanced comfortably in the women's 57kg category after her Lesotho opponent was stopped in the second round following a third standing count.

Jadumani Singh joined them in the finals with a unanimous 5-0 victory over Namibia's P.P.M. Haoseb in the men's 55kg semifinal. Preeti Pawar continued India's impressive run by outclassing Zambia's Catherine Mwape 5-0 in the women's 54kg semifinal to set up a title clash with Canada's Scarlett Delgado.

The Asian Games bronze medallist from Bhiwani dominated throughout, repeatedly catching Mwape with sharp counter attacks as the Zambian struggled to match her pace and accuracy.

"I executed the plans we made with my coaches and now I will give everything for gold," Preeti said, thanking the Sports Authority of India, the Boxing Federation of India, the Indian Army and JSW Sports for their support.

She also said the demanding schedule and weight management were part of elite boxing and would not distract her from chasing the title. Ankush Panghal completed India's perfect day in the ring with a comprehensive 5-0 victory over Joshua Ofori in the men's 80kg semifinal.

"We analysed the opponent well and boxed from distance to avoid unnecessary risks," Ankush said.

Friday's results guaranteed India at least six silver medals in boxing, with all six finalists now in contention for gold.

From Page 1

PM-KISAN till

The government will provide support of up to Rs 650 crore for each well drilled in deepwater and ultra-deepwater areas.

More than half of the scheme's outlay, Rs 43,200 crore, will be spent over five years through 2031 on deepwater drilling, which involves high costs and significant geological risks.

According to the government, drilling in ultra-deepwater areas with water depths exceeding 1,500 metres costs between USD 100 million (around Rs 950 crore) and USD 250 million (about Rs 2,400 crore) per well, with no guarantee of a commercial discovery.

India's crude oil import dependence has increased from 77 per cent to 88 per cent over the past decade. The country also imports around half of its natural gas requirement.

The Cabinet also approved the revamped Khelo India Scheme and enhanced funding for Assistance to National Sports Federations (NSFs), with a combined outlay of Rs 36,441 crore over the next five years.

Of the total allocation, Rs 29,054 crore has been earmarked for Khelo India, while Rs 7,387 crore will be spent on assistance to NSFs. The allocation for NSF assistance in 2026-27 was Rs 425 crore.

Launched in 2017, Khelo India supports grassroots sports development and currently provides training and nutritional support to nearly 2,800 athletes through government scholarships. The Cabinet also approved the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana with an outlay of Rs 5,070 crore to develop 5,000 MW of floating solar photovoltaic projects with co-located energy storage systems.

Under the scheme, central financial assistance of Rs 1 crore per MW will be provided for eligible floating solar projects after commissioning. An additional Rs 50 lakh will be available for feasibility studies, including bathymetry, hydrography and environmental assessments.

The scheme aims to create 5,000 MW of floating solar capacity with energy storage systems of at least two hours, equivalent to 10,000 MWh. According to the government, all states and Union Territories will benefit from the scheme. India's existing floating solar capacity is about 700 MW, and the programme is intended to utilise reservoirs and industrial ponds while reducing pressure on land resources.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomed the Cabinet's decisions, saying the extension of PM-KISAN would help farmers meet expenses on seeds, fertilisers and other agricultural inputs while improving their economic condition.

He also welcomed the approval of the expanded Khelo India Scheme and the enhanced allocation for National Sports Federations, saying the government remains committed to promoting sports in the country.

PM forgives

Appealing directly to the students, Modi invited them to learn from the episode and contribute to the country's progress. "Come, let us move forward together for the country. Let us learn something new and also learn from our mistakes. I live for you and work for your bright future," he said.

The remarks come amid a wider public debate over the use of abusive and sexist language by a section of Gen Z protesters and the limits of free speech during democratic protests.

Laxmi Yojana

Announcing the launch, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the government had fulfilled one of its major commitments to women. She described the Delhi Laxmi Yojana as "a landmark initiative for women's dignity, financial security and self-reliance" and urged all eligible women to apply through the online portal.

According to the government, the application process has been made fully online to ensure transparency and timely processing of applications. Officials said the digital platform is intended to simplify registration, speed up verification and enable eligible beneficiaries to receive financial assistance without delays. The scheme is one of the Delhi government's flagship welfare initiatives aimed at providing regular financial support to women.

Tahir Hussain

the harshest punishment available under law.

Along with the life term under Section 302 of the Indian Penal Code for murder, Hussain received separate sentences for related offences: six months for violating prohibitory orders, three years for promoting enmity between groups, two years for unlawful assembly, three years for rioting with deadly weapons, and seven years for kidnapping. All sentences will run at the same time. He was also fined a total of over five lakh rupees across the different charges, with jail time to follow if the fines go unpaid.

His four co-convicts received similar life terms for murder, along with the same range of additional sentences and fines between one thousand and ten thousand rupees, also to run concurrently.

The court pointed out that the prosecution had not presented any evidence linking the convicts to prior violent conduct. It also rejected the prosecution's claim that Hussain had used his own house as a base to organise or lead the rioters, noting this allegation was never formally part of the charges against him. Judge Singh treated the lack of formal education among most of the convicts as a factor in their favour. He noted that Qasim, Nazim and Javed could not read or write, while Anas had studied only until the fourth grade, which the court said left them more open to rumours and communal propaganda that spread during the unrest.

Hussain, addressing reporters as he was taken from the courtroom, said, "Insaaf high court se milega," adding that he believed the trial had been unfair and that the higher court would eventually deliver justice. Sharma's family called the years-long trial a painful ordeal but said their trust in the justice system never wavered.

The verdict has reignited political sparring in Delhi. AAP leader Saurabh Bharadwaj distanced the party from Hussain, saying he was expelled soon after the case was filed and accusing him of secretly aiding the BJP. In response, the BJP demanded an apology from AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal, alleging he had shielded Hussain around the time of the riots.

The court had convicted all five men on July 13, finding they were part of an armed mob that attacked and killed Sharma during the riots.

Modi, UK PM Burnham

innovation, defence, security, clean energy, education and people-to-people ties and take the India-UK Comprehensive Strategic Partnership to new heights," Modi said.

He added that both countries would "collaborate closely to fully harness the trade and investment opportunities" offered by the trade agreement for the shared prosperity of their people.

The India-UK trade pact came into force on July 15 after being concluded in July last year following three years of negotiations. It provides zero duty market access for nearly 99 per cent of India's exports to the UK. According to a British government readout, Burnham highlighted the strength of UK-India ties and his intention to build on them through the UK-India Vision 2035 framework and stronger people-to-people links. He also praised the contribution of the Indian community to British society. Modi referred to the historical links between Manchester and Ahmedabad, describing the Gujarat city as the "Manchester of India".

The UK readout said Burnham also reaffirmed his commitment to the UK-India Technology Security Initiative, with both leaders identifying artificial intelligence and other advanced technologies as key areas for future cooperation.

The leaders also discussed the situation in West Asia and agreed to work together towards deescalation and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. They expressed hope of speaking again soon and meeting in person at the earliest opportunity.

CJP questions

jurisdiction over the matter.

In a video message, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke questioned why criminal proceedings had been initiated in the present case while, according to him, no comparable action had been taken against BJP leaders or the party's IT Cell over alleged abusive remarks directed at women. "If you're filing cases over the use of abusive language, then when will cases be filed against the BJP's IT Cell, whose members have been hurling vile abuses at women online for so many years?" Dipke said. Alleging that women have repeatedly faced online abuse, he claimed many individuals associated with the BJP's IT Cell displayed "followed by PM Modi" in their social media profiles while continuing to post offensive content.

Dipke also referred to BJP MP Ramesh Bidhuri's past remarks in Parliament and claimed there was a video showing Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath allegedly using abusive language towards an NRI cameraperson. He argued that if abusive language alone was the basis for criminal prosecution, similar legal action should be taken in all such cases.

"Are there two different sets of laws? One law for the youth and another for the BJP and its leaders?" he asked. While stating that abusive language may be inappropriate, Dipke questioned whether it should invite criminal prosecution. "Using abusive language is not a crime. It may be wrong and inappropriate, but people can be counselled instead of being prosecuted," he said, adding that if such a standard were applied uniformly, the BJP's IT Cell and several party leaders would face the highest number of cases.

Backing Dipke's remarks, CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka shared on X a video that he said was the one referred to by the party founder and wrote, "FIR. FIR. FIR," while demanding similar legal action. Earlier in the day, another CJP spokesperson, Saurav Das, described the FIR as a "misuse of criminal machinery" and alleged that the criminal justice system was being used to harass protesters.

"Profanity does not attract criminal case... The Police can focus their energy towards those with serious criminal cases, not a 25-year-old. Harassment of the young must STOP immediately!" Das wrote on X. Speaking to media, he added that using abusive language had never been treated as a criminal offence in ordinary circumstances and questioned the decision to invoke criminal law in the present case.

Ten killed

September 2020 and asked its owners to submit a structural audit. A reminder notice followed in April 2022. When there was no response, eviction notices went out on June 5 this year, and electricity and water connections were cut. Despite this, the owners went ahead with structural repairs without the corporation's approval.

Officials said a civic team had actually visited the site on July 30, hours before the collapse, and spotted signs that the structure was unstable. About 40 residents and labourers were evacuated at the time, and the contractor was told to halt work, but the warning was ignored. Some residents also chose to stay behind. Municipal officials have asked local police to file a case against the contractor, and Senior Inspector Vikram Mohite of Bhoiwada police said the process was already underway.

One woman who survived described being trapped beneath mud and debris for hours while her parents called out to her nearby. "I too was screaming at the top of my voice, but the debris swallowed my cries," she said, adding that residents had objected to how the repair work was being carried out but were not heeded. Another survivor, who lived on the second floor with her husband and two daughters, said a neighbour's quick decision to let them into his flat as cracks appeared saved their lives. "We have lost everything, our home, our belongings," she said.

President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi both offered condolences. Modi announced compensation of Rs 2 lakh for the families of those killed and Rs 50,000 for the injured. State minister Girish Mahajan, who visited the site, announced a further Rs 5 lakh per deceased family on behalf of the state government, on the directions of Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis. Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde noted that the building had been undergoing repair work when it fell. Authorities have since evacuated residents from buildings next to the collapsed structure as a precaution, and the district administration has been told to arrange temporary shelter and support for them.

Monsoon

country, except some parts of peninsular India, central India, northern parts of northwest India, and east and northeast India, where normal to above-normal rainfall is likely," he said. August alone is also expected to see below-normal rain, again under 94 per cent of the LPA. The August LPA, based on the same 1971-2020 data, is 254.9 mm.

At present, the country has a rainfall deficit of 13 per cent for June and July combined, an improvement from the 35.4 per cent deficit recorded at the end of June. Dr Mohapatra credited this to strong rainfall through July. The month's average rainfall is 280.5 mm, and this year the country recorded 283.3 mm. Two factors drove the July rainfall, officials said. Four low-pressure systems formed over the Bay of Bengal during the month, two of which turned into depressions. The number of days with such systems active also rose sharply, from a typical 13.5 to 24 this year. In addition, the Madden-Julian Oscillation, a system of wind, cloud and pressure that moves along the equator, stayed in a favourable phase for part of the month, pushing more rain-bearing clouds northward into India before turning unfavourable later in July.

July also recorded the highest number of extremely heavy rainfall days, those with more than 204.5 mm, in five years, with 269 such events this year compared to 84 in 2025, 194 in 2024, 205 in 2023 and 129 in 2022. Dr Mohapatra said these events were mostly seen in Odisha, Gujarat and Maharashtra.

Even so, the Southern Peninsula recorded its 10th-lowest July rainfall since 1901, at 152.6 mm, and its highest minimum temperature for the month in the same period, 24.68 degrees Celsius, against a normal of 23.68 degrees Celsius.

Govt to quiz

Meta had "no business" removing content from the Prime Minister's verified account. "I don't think that Meta has any business taking down a post that was duly authorised, and nobody was asking or complaining about it. Their explanation is not satisfactory enough. They are a large company and supposed to have the most advanced technology," he said. Krishnan added that Meta had accepted its mistake and apologised, but the government expected better safeguards from a company of its scale.

Sources said Meta's global delegation, expected in New Delhi around the middle of next week, will be asked to explain how its algorithms function, whether there is any algorithmic bias and how the company's systems affect public order. By calling the company's international leadership rather than only local representatives, the government wants its concerns to reach Meta's highest levels. The post at the centre of the controversy featured Modi's first direct selfie video aimed at young people. In the 175-second message, posted during the 36-day agitation led by the Cockroach Janta Party over alleged irregularities in NEET-UG 2026, he promised strict action against paper leaks, including fast-track courts and new legislation. The video gained more than 303 million views within 24 hours on Instagram, where Modi has over 105 million followers. The Centre later introduced the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, proposing imprisonment of up to 10 years, financial penalties and fast-track courts. The agitation ended on July 25 after Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigned. After the incident, Meta informed the government that posts from the Prime Minister and other prominent accounts would undergo additional oversight with multiple levels of review by senior officials. Government sources, however, said companies that violate Indian laws and rules would face liability where applicable. They also pointed to growing concerns over the impact of social media on society, including studies linking excessive use to adverse cognitive and mental well-being.

Separately, Hyderabad Cyber Crime Police has registered cases against Meta India head Arun Srinivas and certain Facebook and Instagram accounts over allegedly morphed and AI-generated posts targeting the Prime Minister.

Meta will also face questions before the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Communications and Information Technology on August 3. Chaired by BJP MP Nishikant Dubey, the meeting will include representatives from Meta, X, Google, MeitY and the Ministry of Home Affairs to discuss regulation of social media and digital platforms. The company has also recently received a government notice over child sexual exploitative and abuse material in paid Instagram advertisements, while WhatsApp has been questioned over its proposed username feature amid concerns over fraud, phishing, impersonation and digital arrest scams.

Jaishankar

concerns over attacks on commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz.

Minister of State for External Affairs Kirti Vardhan Singh told Rajya Sabha on Thursday that 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers, have been killed and another 75 injured in the West Asia conflict since February. "Since the outbreak of the conflict in the Middle East in 2026, 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers have lost their lives in the Middle East (one in Saudi Arabia; two in Kuwait; eight in Oman; one in Iraq; and four in UAE), and 75 Indians have been injured (32 in UAE; 24 in Oman; four in Qatar; 13 in Kuwait; one in Saudi Arabia; and one in Israel)," Singh said.

He was replying to a question.

"In a separate accident not related to attacks, 12 Indian nationals have lost their lives in Ras Laffan Gas Facility in Qatar," Singh said, referring to an explosion and fire at an energy complex in June.

SC

and argued that the policy discriminated against married daughters, violating Article 14 of the Constitution.

The Supreme Court noted that the appellant had been living with her parental family despite her divorce not being formally recognised in law. It held that authorities could not deny her claim by adopting an "unduly technical approach."

Setting aside the High Court's order, the bench directed the Bihar government to consider the appellant's claim for compassionate appointment on its merits within eight weeks of receiving the judgment.

Parl adjourned

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla said the Opposition members disrupted the House proceedings in a "pre-planned manner".

"Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra is standing to ask a question, but Opposition members are not allowing Question Hour to proceed," he said.

In an apparent reference to suspended TMC MP Kalyan Banerjee, he said some members were roaming in the Parliament House complex in different getups. Birla said such actions lower the dignity of the house. He then adjourned the proceedings till noon.

Banerjee has been protesting against his suspension over use of undignified language against women MPs. He has been hanging photographs of 20 rebel TMC MPs who have joined a lesser-known Nationalist Citizens Party of India.

Separately, Samajwadi Party MPs have been protesting the alleged theft of donations at Ram Temple in Ayodhya. They have been carrying donation boxes and placards at the entrance of the Parliament House.

The Rajya Sabha was also adjourned for the day, shortly after meeting at 11 am, amid sloganeering by Opposition MPs.

As proceedings began and papers were laid on the table of the House, several Opposition members were on their feet demanding that Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge be allowed to speak.

Chairman C P Radhakrishnan slammed the Opposition saying that they were still in "emergency mode".

"You are in Emergency mode till today. You want everybody to listen, but you don't want to listen to anyone. This is dictatorship. You don't want to value democratic values," the Chairman said.

Radhakrishnan later permitted Kharge to speak but ruled that no notices under Rule 267 would be admitted after the Leader of Opposition sought to raise some issues under the provision.

The LoP notice under Rule 267 pertained to the alleged misappropriation of funds and irregularities in land acquisition for the Ayodhya Ram Temple.

Opposition MPs raised slogans slamming the government over paper leaks and also demanded that Home Minister Amit Shah come to the House.

Opposition has been seeking a statement from the Home Minister on the alleged use of force against protesting students on July 20, including use of pellet guns, and has also demanded his resignation over the issue.

The Chairman, however, said, "What does the Home Minister have to do with the Zero Hour?"

Even as the Chairman allowed members to raise their issues listed for the Zero Hour, the Opposition continued to raise slogans, including against the alleged donation theft at the Ram Temple. The Chairman then adjourned the House for the day amid the din.

mp

EDITORIAL

BORDER OF CONSCIENCE

The images from Ceuta, Spain's tiny North African enclave, are a grim reminder that migration crises are never merely about borders. They are about desperation, governance, geopolitics and the failure of the international community to confront the forces that drive people from their homes. In just 24 hours, an estimated 60,000 people crossed from Morocco into Ceuta, overwhelming a city whose permanent population is barely 85,000. At least 41 migrants lost their lives—many drowning in the sea or dying amid the chaos of the crossing—making the episode one of Europe's deadliest border tragedies in recent years. Spanish troops and security forces rushed to restore order as thousands slept in parks, streets and makeshift shelters while authorities struggled to process the unprecedented influx. Thousands have since voluntarily returned to Morocco, yet the humanitarian catastrophe has already exposed the fragility of Europe's migration management system.

Ceuta is not an ordinary frontier. It is one of two Spanish territories located on the African continent, making it both a physical and symbolic gateway to Europe. For decades, migrants from across Africa have viewed Ceuta and neighbouring Melilla as the shortest route to the European Union. The latest surge appears to have been fuelled by a combination of misinformation surrounding a recent Spanish Supreme Court ruling on deportations, aggressive human-smuggling networks and long-standing economic distress across parts of Africa. Spain argues that criminal groups deliberately exploited confusion over the court's decision to persuade thousands that reaching Ceuta would guarantee entry into Europe. Yet misinformation alone cannot explain why tens of thousands were willing to risk death. The deeper reality is that conflict, unemployment, political instability, climate pressures and widening inequality continue to make migration appear less dangerous than staying behind. Every tightening of border controls merely alters the route, rarely the motivation. As long as the structural drivers remain untouched, fences become obstacles rather than solutions.

The crisis also reveals growing fractures within Europe itself. While European Commission leaders have reaffirmed solidarity with Spain and called for close cooperation with Morocco, several political leaders across the continent have seized upon the episode to demand tougher border enforcement, stricter asylum policies and even extraordinary measures affecting Spain's place within the Schengen framework. Such reactions illustrate how migration has become one of Europe's most polarising political issues, often overshadowing humanitarian considerations. Border security is undeniably a sovereign responsibility, and governments cannot allow criminal trafficking networks to exploit legal loopholes or overwhelm public institutions. Equally, however, reducing every migrant to a security threat ignores the human dimension of displacement. The people arriving in Ceuta are not a homogeneous mass; they include families, children and individuals fleeing circumstances that leave them with few alternatives. Europe's challenge is therefore twofold: protecting its borders while upholding the values of human dignity and international protection that it claims define the European project. Either objective pursued in isolation will ultimately fail.

For India and other democracies, the events in Ceuta offer important lessons. Migration is no longer a regional issue but a defining feature of an interconnected world shaped by economic inequality, demographic pressures, armed conflict and climate change. No wall, surveillance system or naval deployment can permanently stop human mobility when desperation becomes stronger than deterrence. At the same time, no nation can sustain open borders without orderly migration systems and effective international cooperation. The answer lies neither in unrestricted movement nor in fortress mentalities, but in comprehensive strategies that combine legal migration pathways, development partnerships, stronger action against trafficking networks and investments that reduce the compulsion to migrate in the first place. The tragedy at Ceuta should not merely provoke another cycle of political blame. It should force governments to recognise that migration is ultimately a symptom of deeper global failures. Unless those failures are addressed collectively, the world's borders will continue to witness scenes where hope collides with fear, and where the cost of policy paralysis is measured in human lives.

Case for Education Federalism

Paper leaks demand more than tougher laws; they require structural reforms that restore accountability, federalism, and state-led educational governance nationwide

DIPANKAR DEY

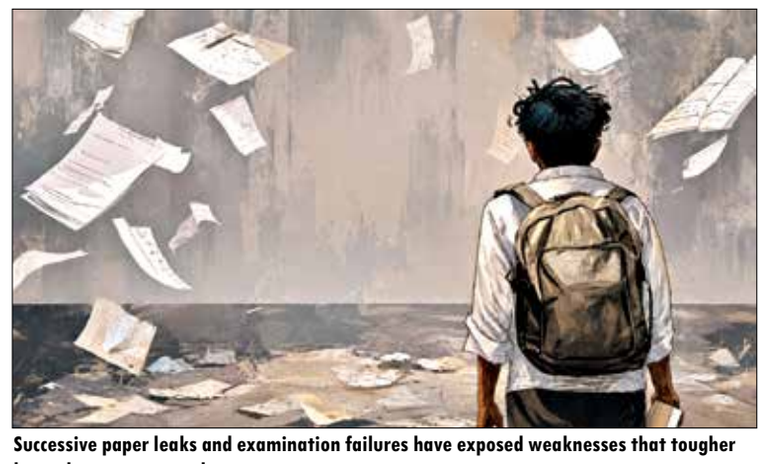
THE WRITER IS A PROFESSOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION WHO PRIMARILY WRITES ON POLITICAL ECONOMY, GLOBAL TRADE, AND SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

On July 29, the Lok Sabha passed the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, by a voice vote after a limited discussion. The Bill was hurriedly introduced by the BJP-led government after Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign on July 25 under prolonged student agitation, steered by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), against the repeated failure of the Union government in conducting national-level examinations, which led to several students taking their own lives. Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday (July 26, 2026) announced the constitution of a high-powered task force, to be headed by former UIDAI chairman Nandan Nilekani, to recommend steps to make the country's examination system leak-proof and technology-driven.

It may be recalled that, in 2024, the Modi government constituted a similar high-powered committee headed by Dr K. Radhakrishnan, former chairman of ISRO, following the NEET-UG paper leak. The government also cancelled the UGC-NET examination after it was held, while the CSIR-NET and NEET-PG examinations were postponed. In that year, the Union government enacted the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, to provide a comprehensive legal framework to curb unfair means in public examinations conducted by major recruitment agencies, including the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), Staff Selection Commission (SSC), Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs), Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS), and the National Testing Agency (NTA) for higher education admissions. A repeated question paper leak in 2026 proves beyond doubt that the Union government has failed to prevent unfair means in examinations. Experts are of the opinion that the Indian education system suffers from a structural problem. The rot runs far deeper. Treating these incidents as isolated anomalies is to mistake a symptom for the disease.

> Reforming examinations without reforming educational governance addresses the consequence, not the cause

In 1966, when education was a State subject, the Kothari Commission recommended that public expenditure on education should reach 6% of GDP. Six decades later, after education was moved to the Concurrent List, India spends between 2.9% and 3.5% of GDP on education—a figure that speaks of neglect and national indifference towards education. Since 1976, education has been shifted from the State List to the Concurrent List. Under the Concurrent List, both the Union and state governments can enact laws on subjects listed under it. The major fallout of this divided responsibility for education is that the states bear roughly 75% to 85% of educational expenditure, yet central authorities such as the UGC, NTA, AICTE, and NMC increasingly dictate policy, standardised testing, and institutional governance. This leads to political tension between the Union government and opposition-led state governments, while students and the education system suffer.



Successive paper leaks and examination failures have exposed weaknesses that tougher laws alone cannot resolve

In a significant move during the recent student protests against the NEET paper leak, Tamil Nadu's ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) has revived a long-standing debate on whether education should be part of the State List or the Concurrent List of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution. In a statement following the protests at New Delhi's Jantar Mantar demanding Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, the TVK emphasised that education must be transferred back from the Concurrent List to the State List. This would grant states full authority over education policy, including medical education. As an interim measure, if an immediate transfer faces legal hurdles, the party has proposed creating a "Special Concurrent List" to empower state governments with enhanced decision-making powers until a full constitutional amendment is achieved.

The Seventh Schedule of the Indian Constitution contains three lists: the Union List, the State List, and the Concurrent List. The Union government has exclusive powers to make laws on subjects in the Union List, while state governments can make laws on subjects in the State List. Both the Union and state governments can enact laws on subjects listed under the Concurrent List. India, being a vast and diverse country, demands a decentralised education policy. Accordingly, the Constitution of India, which came into effect on January 26, 1950, made education a State subject by placing it in the State List. However, the Indira Gandhi government moved education to the Concurrent List through the 42nd Constitutional Amendment during the Emergency in 1976, paving the way for national policies like NEET to be introduced by the Union government.

Barring a few institutions, such as (a) Banaras Hindu University, Aligarh Muslim University, Delhi University, and other institutions of national importance; (b) institutions for scientific or technical education wholly or partly financed by the Government of India and declared by an Act of Parliament to be institutions of national importance; and (c) Union agencies and institutions for professional, vocational, or technical training, including the training of police officers and the promotion of special studies and research, most academic institutions are run by the state governments. A NITI Aayog policy report (February 2025) reveals that the 495 State Public Universities (SPUs) and their over 46,000 affiliated institutions account for 81% of the total student enrolment and hence play a vital role in ensuring access to higher education across the length and breadth of India. SPUs serve as regional hubs for higher education, catering to over 32.5 million students across India. Over the last seven decades, the nationwide growth and expansion of SPUs have been primarily driven by the need to increase access to affordable higher education, particularly in remote and underserved regions. This has been essential in meeting the rising demand for higher education and addressing regional imbalances in educational access, observes NITI Aayog.

Now, it is being argued that when the states bear the major responsibility for imparting primary, middle, and higher education to their citizens, state governments should be allowed to manage this vital sector on their own. Hence, education should be brought back to the State List from the Concurrent List. In that case, the states will be more accountable for educational outcomes, potentially leading to better governance and management. States will be able to develop policies tailored to their unique cultural, linguistic, and socio-economic contexts. For instance, Kerala's high literacy rates are attributed to state-specific policies. Moreover, progressive states will get an opportunity to experiment with and implement innovative educational models without central constraints, as seen in Tamil Nadu's ICT integration in schools.

Unlike China, most advanced economies, such as the United States, Germany, and the United Kingdom, follow decentralised systems of education. As India and China follow two different political systems of governance, one should not compare India's NTA-run tests with the Chinese Gaokao, or the National College Entrance Examination, where every year on June 7 and 8, nearly nine million students take the examination, which is the sole determining factor for university admission. The imperial education and examination system in China is estimated to have been founded as early as the Han Dynasty (206 BCE to 220 CE). One of the longest legacies of this imperial education tradition is the famous Gaokao. Education in Germany is primarily the responsibility of the individual German states (Länder), with the federal government playing only a minor role. The federal government of the United States has limited authority over education, and education policy is designed to support the education systems of state and local governments. The US federal government is responsible for ensuring that state education laws and school practices comply with the Constitution of the United States. This includes protecting the constitutional rights of students, ensuring equal access to education, and governing the role of religion in schools.

The Government of India Act, 1935, created a federal structure by placing education under the Provincial List. However, the very first article of the Indian Constitution, Article 1(1), unequivocally declares: "India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States." While India possesses all the fundamental features of a federation, the term "Union of States" in Article 1(1) signifies certain distinctions. Thus, legal scholars have often described India's constitutional structure as "quasi-federal" or sui generis (unique in its characteristics). Since the 1970s, following the 42nd Constitutional Amendment, even this "quasi-federal" structure has gradually been replaced by a more centralised framework. The recent chaos in conducting national-level examinations by the National Testing Agency (NTA) is an outcome of this process. Reform of the education system should begin with remodelling its basic governance structure, using the Government of India Act, 1935, as the benchmark.

Views expressed are personal

Learning to Think Beyond AI

CBSE's AI curriculum marks a policy shift, but classrooms must nurture critical thinking, ethical judgment, and independent learning alongside technology; writes **Nisha Nair & Samanvi Narang**

In April this year, the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) introduced 'Computational Thinking and Understanding AI' (CT&AI) as a mandatory part of the curriculum for students of Classes 3–8, making India one of the few countries in the world to introduce AI at the foundational level. The idea is to provide essential training to teachers, enabling them to inculcate CT&AI in their respective subjects and foster an ethical approach to using AI among learners.

This is an important step that recognises that learners are being increasingly influenced and shaped by AI interfaces, irrespective of educational institutions' readiness to acknowledge or adopt them. Hence, moving towards a policy-led intervention in incorporating AI into the school curriculum is important to update and enhance pedagogical practices and student learning. As early as 2019, CBSE had introduced AI as an optional subject for students of Classes 9–11.

> In the age of AI, teaching is not about competing with machines. It is about preserving the 'human' in learners

AI tools like ChatGPT, Gemini, and other domain-specific assistants have entered classrooms and study circles across the globe. The reality, however, is that students are way ahead. A 2024 study found that, in India, over 80% of students are using AI tools unethically. Further, it found that 46.9% of students use AI in coursework, 39% for assessments, while 7% completely rely on AI. Given this, it is important to ensure that young learners are not blindly embracing AI but are also equipped to actively navigate its risks and rewards. Especially for many first-generation learners, these tools provide a type of support that most educational systems are still working to provide. The result is a fascinating paradox of accessibility. While AI may have the potential to enable learning for a wider audience, it is still mostly available to the digitally educated.

The question to ask, then, is: If students start to depend on AI for tasks such as summarising lectures and solving problems, will they still learn to think independently and critically?

Although AI has the potential to be inclusive, the opposite would be true without the efforts of educational institutions. There are pros and cons to using AI in education. Undoubtedly, AI can provide personalised learning for students and reduce grading pressure for teachers, while creating scope for designing advanced tasks and classroom activities. There are also concerns about students losing their ability to think for themselves and work with peers.

Artificial intelligence is rapidly becoming a classroom companion, reshaping how students learn and teachers teach

The bigger worry is that students will start to outsource parts of the critical process that they are supposed to engage in themselves. For many, the most valuable learning experiences come from revising and improving an incomplete argument or working through and understanding opposing views. These experiences represent the most beneficial struggles. AI is designed to remove obstacles and struggles. The concern is that education will start to value correct answers more than the process of learning. For this reason, the challenge for educators is more a challenge to the imagination than a technology-based one: to preserve spaces in learning where students think for themselves, ask questions on their own, and arrive at answers independently before turning to AI and after using it.

On the other hand, a 2026 Stanford study reveals that AI tools specifically built for education help build independent thinking and reasoning. They can promote stronger and more efficient teaching practices. The study recognises AI's potential to improve equity in education. In doing so, it is imperative to balance the use of AI tools in a manner that ensures teachers are trained to help students understand the impacts of AI while also supporting their mental well-being.

The right tools allow the use of AI and, more importantly, the use of AI for good. A much-overlooked skill that falls into the former category is prompt engineering. It is definitely more than just asking questions of AI; rather, it is about developing the ability to ask thought-provoking, complex, and morally sound questions. It is crucial to teach learners the discipline of AI before and after its use. It is equally vital to help them figure out how to answer the questions they ask AI and to realise that AI has limitations and that they should not necessarily accept everything it produces as the ultimate answer.

How do educators facilitate this kind of learning? Responsible assignments that encourage collaborative reflection offer a good start. An example would be an instructor assigning students a project in which both AI-generated content and human research are utilised. Students would then be tasked with comparing the processes followed, as well as the outcomes of each. Other examples of this type of assignment could include smaller groups using AI to generate a base set of ideas, followed by a class discussion to critically assess the ideas generated, as well as their reliability and overall quality. Using AI responsibly allows students to focus on the core, higher-level skills of education.

Discussions on policy have begun to focus on teaching students to use AI while considering plagiarism, privacy, integrity, and other responsible-use issues. While teaching the ethical use of AI is important, it is not enough. Students need to realise that AI outputs are not constructed without bias. AI outputs are influenced by people, training data, culture, and the framing of different institutions. Because of this, AI has the capacity to reinforce systems of thought, shape knowledge, and perpetuate various biases.

Education should focus on encouraging students to think critically about AI rather than merely teaching them how to use it. Students need to understand the design of AI systems, the data that influences AI outputs, and who is included or excluded in their design. Now, more than ever, it is important to think critically about the AI systems that are used to communicate and frame the information we are expected to accept as knowledge. Rather than using technology without reflection, students should become active users who evaluate the systems that communicate with and influence them, thereby shaping their understanding of reality.

While it would be safe to say that CBSE's recent measures are well-timed, the policy will only be effective if it addresses the core challenges faced by institutions, such as insufficient high-speed internet, inadequate funding, and varying levels of digital literacy. AI is changing education, and we can change our definition of teaching. It is easy for technology to take over, but we need to create spaces for human judgment. We need to remember the importance of empathy, and, especially in teaching, we have to keep learners thinking. In the age of AI, teaching is not about competing with machines. It is about preserving the 'human' in learners.

Views expressed are personal

MONSOON FURY

Flood toll in Assam reaches 82, over 1.9L people still affected

MPOST BUREAU

GUWAHATI: The toll in Assam floods rose to 82 as two more persons died, even as the number of affected people decreased to 1.92 lakh, an official bulletin said on Friday.

The Assam Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA) bulletin said one of the two fatalities due to the deluge was reported from Nazira revenue circle of Sivasagar district, while the other was from Sonari in Charaideo.

With these fresh fatalities, the toll in this year's floods reached 82, it said, adding that no person was recorded as missing.

The five districts of Sivasagar, Golaghat, Jorhat, Nagaon and Charaideo continued to reel under the deluge, with 17 revenue circles and 379 villages remaining affected.

The number of affected people was at 1,92,799, with Charaideo remaining the worst-hit as 77,456 people were hit by the deluge, followed by Sivasagar (63,492) and Jorhat (34,067), the bulletin said.

The flood situation has improved since Thursday, when more than two lakh people in eight districts were affected.

A total of 54 relief camps were operational, sheltering 12,994 displaced people. Another 26 relief distribution centres were open, catering to 5,384 people, the flood bulletin said.

Relief operations continued to be carried out by different agencies, including NDRF and SDRF. A crop area of 15,430 hectares remained submerged in the state, the bulletin said.

Labourers carry out reconstruction work at the breached embankment of the Bhogdoi River at Malow Ali Da-Gaon in Jorhat district, Assam, Tuesday PTI

KEY POINTS

- The state govt has announced a six-month moratorium on repaying all types of loans availed by flood-affected people
- The five districts of Sivasagar, Golaghat, Jorhat, Nagaon and Charaideo continued to reel under the deluge, with 17 revenue circles and 379 villages remaining affected
- The flood situation has improved since Thursday, when more than two lakh people in eight districts were affected

Damage to houses, roads and other infrastructure was also reported from the affected districts, it added.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said a special meeting of the State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC), attended by representatives from the RBI, NABARD, SBI and all other commercial banks, decided on a relief scheme for the customers who availed loans in Sivasagar, Charaideo, Jorhat and Golaghat districts.

"The SLBC decided that a moratorium of six months will be offered to all flood-affected people in these districts," he added. Sarma further said that the tenure of loans availed by all flood-affected people can be extended from one year up to seven years in all banks, depending on the type of debt.

He also said the state government placed its demand for a support package before the Inter-Ministerial Central Team (IMCT), which concluded its four-day tour of flood-devastated districts in Upper Assam on Wednesday.

Sarma said the state government also demanded recognition of the Upper Assam floods as an "atypical, high-intensity, rapid-onset event" with flexible norms for damage assessment and assistance.

India calls for global scrutiny over Pak's 'ruthless' crackdown in PoJK

Around 40 killed in crackdown by security forces in PoJK since July 27

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Friday called upon the international community to scrutinise Islamabad's "ruthless" use of force against peaceful protesters in Pakistan-Occupied-Jammu and Kashmir (PoJK) and hold it accountable for the "atrocities".

Around 40 people were reportedly killed in the crackdown by the security forces in PoJK since July 27 amid local-body elections in the region.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the Pakistani establishment continued to "unleash ruthless force" against peaceful civilians in PoJK.

The PoJK has been witnessing massive protests since last month over inflated living costs, alleged administrative apathy and political discrimination and atrocities against minorities.

INSIGHT

- MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the Pakistani establishment continued to 'unleash ruthless force' against peaceful civilians in PoJK
- The PoJK has been witnessing massive protests since last month over inflated living costs, alleged administrative apathy and political discrimination and atrocities against minorities

The Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) has been leading the protests.

"This crackdown has resulted in the tragic death of over 40 civilians and serious injuries to many," Jaiswal said at a regular media briefing.

"Its absolute disdain for the innocent people of PoJK was laid bare when the defence minister branded the protesting civilians as enemies.

"Adding to this, the Special Assistant to the prime minister on political affairs, openly admitted that the very 'mujahideen' that Pakistani establishment trained, armed and sent to bleed India have now turned their guns inward, weaponising themselves against the state," he added.

Jaiswal said the "so-called" elections stand as a "humiliating rejection" of the Pakistani establishment. "Facing a violent regime, the people have requested international organisations for an independent investigation into the unlawful killings," he said.

"We urge that the international community should scrutinise Pakistan's actions and hold it accountable for its atrocities," he added.

Meanwhile, the BJP in Jammu and Kashmir, accusing Pakistan of targeting civilians, urged the international community and political parties to speak out against the alleged atrocities.

UP farmer sells 4 Miyazaki mangoes for Rs 2.11 lakh

SAHARANPUR: A farmer from Uttar Pradesh's Saharanpur has set a domestic agricultural record by selling four rare Japanese Miyazaki mangoes, weighing one kilogram, for Rs 2.11 lakh.

Sandeep Chaudhary of Tharoli village sold the premium fruit to Surat-based businessman Praveen Gupta, originally from Haridwar, who purchased it as a gift for his 80-year-old ailing mother. The mangoes were originally valued at Rs 3.5 lakh, but Chaudhary reduced the price after learning the purpose of the purchase. He said he started cultivating Miyazaki mangoes with just two saplings despite being mocked and now has 40 trees. Miyazaki is regarded as one of the world's costliest mango varieties. MPOST

Saini targets Punjab CM Mann over 'unfulfilled' poll promises

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday launched a sharp attack on the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government in Punjab, asking Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann to disclose how many of the party's pre-poll promises had been fulfilled with only about four months left before the next Assembly elections in the state.

Addressing a function organised in Sanaur to mark the 87th martyrdom day of Shaheed Udham Singh, Saini said the people of Punjab had a right to know the status of the AAP government's electoral commitments. Referring to a speaker's claim that only 30 per cent of the promises had been fulfilled, he questioned whether the Mann government would be able to deliver on the remaining commitments within the limited time left.

Taking a swipe at the AAP government, Saini said development is driven not by slogans but by intent and commitment. He also targeted the Punjab government over alleged irregularities in the recruitment of excise inspectors, calling it a grave injustice to deserving youth.

Drawing a comparison with the BJP government's performance in Haryana, Saini said the party had made 217 "Sankalps" during the 2024 Assembly elections, of which 70 had already been fulfilled within one-and-a-half years. The remaining 147 promises, he added, would also be implemented soon.

Highlighting the BJP-led Centre's development agenda, Saini said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, India was achieving rapid progress while preserving its rich cultural heritage. He said the Haryana government was working with the same vision and had launched several welfare initiatives for farmers, women and youth.

Paying tribute to Shaheed Udham Singh, Saini said the legendary revolutionary dedicated his life to the nation and avenged the 1919 Jallianwala Bagh massacre by assassinating Michael O'Dwyer in London in 1940. Urging Punjabis to draw inspiration from Udham Singh's determination, he said a united Punjab could transform the state's future.

Earlier in the day, Saini also paid floral tributes to the martyr at his official residence in Chandigarh.

CBI raids 10 premises in ₹105-cr bank 'fraud'

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Friday conducted searches at 10 locations across Andhra Pradesh and Telangana in connection with an alleged bank fraud of Rs 105.44 crore involving NCS Sugars Ltd, its directors and other public servants.

The case was registered by the CBI's Bank Securities and Fraud Branch in Bengaluru on a complaint filed by Punjab National Bank, Chennai. The accused have been booked on charges of criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust, misappropriation of property and forgery.

According to the CBI, the accused allegedly submitted forged documents to the bank to obtain credit facilities. It was found that the funds availed by the company "were not used for business purposes but were allegedly diverted and misappropriated, resulting in a wrongful loss of Rs 105.44 crore to the bank".

As part of the probe, CBI teams carried out searches at the company's factory, registered office and the residences of its directors in Hyderabad, Vizianagaram and Kakinada. During the raids, investigators recovered incriminating documents, electronic devices and other materials considered relevant to the case.

The agency said it is examining the seized evidence to trace the flow of the allegedly misappropriated funds, establish the extent of the alleged criminal conspiracy and determine the role of each accused. The investigation is continuing, and further action will be taken based on the evidence collected, the CBI added. MPOST

Hindi writer Kailash Chandra Pant passes away

FILE PIC

BHOPAL: Noted Hindi writer Kailash Chandra Pant died here on Friday following cardiac arrest, family members said. Pant (90), a Padma Shri awardee and former director of Hindi Bhavan, Bhopal, was unwell for some time.

His last rites will be performed at Bhadbhada Vishram Ghat here on Saturday, said his brother Chandrashekhar Pant.

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav condoled Pant's death in a post on X.

He remained actively associated with the Madhya Pradesh Rashtrabhasha Prachar Samiti for a long time and his contribution to the promotion of Hindi would always be remembered, Yadav said.

Pant, whose family hailed from Khantoli village in Uttarakhand's Bageshwar district, was born on April 26, 1936, in Mhow near Indore.

He served as a lecturer at the Union Theological Seminary in Indore before becoming principal of the Panchayat Raj Training Centre in Bhopal. He also edited literary journals, including Shiksha Pradeep, Jandharma and Durgami Ahwan.

Besides heading the Hindi Bhavan in Bhopal, he held key positions in several literary and cultural organisations, including the Bharat Krishak Samaj, Rashtrabhasha Prachar Samiti and Madhya Bharat Hindi Sahitya Samiti. His notable works include "Kaun Kiska Aadmi", "Dhundh Ke Aar-Paar", "Shabd Ka Vichar-Path" and "Shailesh Matiyani: Srijan Yatra".

He was conferred the Padma Shri earlier this year for his contribution to Hindi literature. He was also the recipient of the Sahitya Bhushan Samman, Nirala Sahitya Samman, Sahitya Shiromani Samman and Sanskriti Gaurav Samman. MPOST

Ram Temple standardises priests' dress code

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has fully implemented a mandatory dress code for all priests serving at the Ram Temple complex, bringing even temporary priests posted at the six subsidiary temples along the parikrama and the Sheshavatar Temple under a uniform code.

From Guru Purnima onwards, all 13 temporary priests have been required to wear the Trust-prescribed attire—a yellow pitambari chaubandi, dhoti and safa—while performing religious rituals. The Trust has provided the official uniforms to all of them, completing the rollout of a common dress code for every priest serving within the temple complex.

The prescribed attire was already being worn by four senior priests and 18 priests who had undergone a year-long training programme conducted by the Trust before being assigned duties at the Ram Lalla and Ram Parivar temples. Each priest has been issued two sets of uniforms for summer and two for winter. The chaubandi carries the Trust's maroon-coloured emblem on the left side. Under the new arrangement, priests will arrive at the temple in their regular clothes and change into the prescribed attire inside the premises before beginning their duties. Separate storage facilities have been created for their personal belongings. Temple authorities said the uniform would help devotees and staff easily identify priests across the sprawling temple complex.

TAKEAWAYS

- From Guru Purnima onwards, all 13 temporary priests have been required to wear the Trust-prescribed attire—a yellow pitambari chaubandi, dhoti and safa
- The prescribed attire was already being worn by four senior priests and 18 priests who had undergone a year-long training programme

The dress code was first introduced on July 1, 2024, but was not implemented uniformly during the initial months.

The then chief priest, the late Acharya Satyendra Das, had expressed reservations over the move and was later exempted because of his health. Following his demise, the Trust has made the dress code mandatory for all priests without exception.

Priests serving at the Ram Lalla and Ram Parivar temples begin their daily duties at 4 am, conducting rituals from the deity's awakening to the nightly shayan ceremony. These include Madhuparka, Bal Bhog, Mangala Aarti, abhishek and shringar at scheduled intervals. Priests at the six parikrama temples and the Sheshavatar Temple report at 6 am to perform morning rituals before the temple opens to devotees at 7 am.

Meanwhile, the Trust clarified that no air-conditioning system has been installed inside the sanctum sanctorum as the temple has been built in the traditional North Indian Nagara architectural style, which relies on natural ventilation. During peak summer, tower air conditioners or coolers are used whenever necessary for the comfort of the Ram Lalla idol.

The temple is also preparing to unveil an enhanced night-time appearance with a new façade lighting system.

AAP govt committed to fulfilling freedom fighters' dreams: Mann

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Friday said the AAP government is firmly committed to fulfilling the dreams of the freedom fighters who made supreme sacrifices for the nation.

During a state-level function in Sunam to commemorate the 87th martyrdom day of Shaheed Udham Singh, Mann said the legendary revolutionary's unparalleled patriotism and supreme sacrifice would continue to inspire generations to serve the nation selflessly and the nation would forever remain indebted to the iconic martyr.

Earlier, the chief minister paid floral tributes and laid a wreath at the memorial in honour of Shaheed Udham Singh.

Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann addresses a gathering on the 87th Martyrdom Day of freedom fighter Udham Singh at Sunam PTI

Mann also posted on X to pay tribute to Shaheed Udham Singh.

"On the martyrdom day of the great revolutionary Shaheed Udham Singh Ji, who avenged the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, I pay my humble tributes to him. His unparalleled sacrifice for the honour and dignity of the nation will forever remain a great source of inspiration for all of us."

Addressing the gathering, Mann said Shaheed Udham Singh made the supreme sacrifice for the freedom of our country. It was a matter of immense pride and satisfaction for him to be part of the solemn occasion to pay tribute to the iconic martyr, he added.

He said India's freedom struggle witnessed countless sacrifices by brave sons and daughters of the nation who laid down their lives to free the country and pave the way for an egalitarian society committed to the welfare of the weaker and underprivileged sections.

SC: Cryptic bail orders need not be revisited

NEW DELHI: Cryptic bail orders need not be revisited as the liberty of a person does not depend on the inaccuracy of a court, but rather hinges on the prosecution's case, the Supreme Court said on Friday.

The observations of the top court came while rejecting an appeal of the Uttarakhand government against the grant of bail by the Nainital High Court to Abdul Malik, an accused in the February 2024 Banbhoolpura violence case. On February 8, 2024, during a demolition of a mosque, a large crowd allegedly pelted stones at security personnel and set government and private vehicles on fire. They also allegedly torched a police station and hurled petrol bombs at the police. It was alleged that a conspiracy was hatched at Malik's residence.

Seeking cancellation of bail, senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, said that the HC passed a cryptic bail order without giving reasons. "Even cryptic bail orders do not need to be revisited," Justice Bagchi said. MPOST

Ex-COAS General VN Sharma passes away

NEW DELHI: Former Chief of the Army Staff General Vishwa Nath Sharma (retd), who led the Indian Army from 1988 to 1990 and had a distinguished military career spanning four decades, passed away on Friday at the age of 96, the Indian Army said. He was remembered as an exemplary soldier whose leadership, professionalism and unwavering commitment to the nation left a lasting legacy.

The Indian Army, led by Chief of Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth, expressed profound grief over his demise. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh also paid tribute, describing General Sharma as "a distinguished military leader" who served the nation with "unwavering dedication, courage and honour."

Born on June 4, 1930, General Sharma hailed from Dadh village in Himachal Pradesh's Kangra district, a region known for its strong military tradition. The younger brother of Major Som Nath Sharma, Independent India's first Param Vir Chakra awardee, he carried forward his family's remarkable legacy of service to the armed forces.

Educated at Sherwood College, Nainital, and the Rashtriya Indian Military College, Dehradun, he joined the Indian Military Academy and was commissioned into the 16 Light Cavalry on June 4, 1950.

General Sharma saw action as a major during the 1965 Indo-Pak war in the Lahore sector and later held several key operational, command and instructional appointments. He commanded a Mountain Brigade in an insurgency-affected area, an Armoured Brigade in the Rajasthan desert, a Mountain Division and later a Corps in the western sector. He was awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM) in 1977 and the Param Vishisht Seva Medal (PVSM) for distinguished service before taking over as the 14th Chief of the Army Staff in 1988.

Himachal Pradesh Governor Kavinder Gupta described his death as the end of an era, saying the state had lost one of its finest soldier-statesmen. He noted that despite decades of national service, General Sharma remained deeply connected to his ancestral village and had recently travelled from Dadh to his residence in Delhi's Defence Colony. MPOST

'OWNERS MUST BE HELD ACCOUNTABLE'

SC orders compensation mechanism for road mishaps due to stray animals

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Taking note of accidents due to stray animals on roads, the Supreme Court on Friday directed the Centre and the state governments to develop a mechanism for payment of compensation in such accidents.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kotiswar Singh issued a slew of directions and said owners of these animals should be held responsible and ensure that they return to their specified dwellings at the end of each day.

"All states that have enacted their own laws pertaining to cattle should take steps to ensure complete and immediate implementation thereof in letter and spirit. Necessary amendments may be carried out or rules promulgated, as is deemed fit by the competent authority, to develop a mechanism for payment of compensation in accidents caused as a result of bovine/cattle, in both categories of cases, i.e., pedestrian or vehicular," the bench said.

KEY POINTS

- A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kotiswar Singh issued a slew of directions and said owners of these animals should be held responsible
- All states that have enacted their own laws pertaining to cattle should take steps to ensure complete and immediate implementation thereof in letter and spirit
- The direction came while hearing an appeal filed by a woman challenging an order of the Punjab and Haryana HC which set aside Rs 29.32 lakh compensation to her

REPRESENTATIVE PIC

While directing that tagging of all animals be mandated, the top court said this furthers the ability to keep track of them, ensuring their long-term health service, linking to veterinary check-ups and vaccinations.

"The reality of animals being let go after they cease to serve a useful, economic purpose cannot be denied. The owners choosing to make such a decision should be held responsible and ensure safe transfer of such animals to the shelters run by the appropriate authority.

"The authorities at such shelters should issue a receipt acknowledging such transfer and cause the details of such animal to be entered/ altered in the database of tagging," the bench said.

The apex court said that in order to ensure that the tagging, digitisation of records and smooth running of these shelters is duly undertaken, the authorities may depute a particular officer in every corporation/ department who shall be the nodal officer for such purpose.

The direction came while hearing an appeal filed by a woman challenging an order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court which set aside Rs 29.32 lakh compensation to her.

The woman's husband was hit by a stray bull while walking on the road and sustained a head injury leading to his death. After his death, the woman filed a petition before the high court seeking adequate compensation. The single-judge bench assessed and awarded compensation by applying the principles governing the grant of compensation under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 on the basis of the income of the deceased/ claimants, age and other relevant factors.

However, the division bench quashed the order of the single-judge bench solely on the ground that disputed questions of fact could not have been adjudicated under Article 226 jurisdiction.

SPANISH PM PEDRO SANCHEZ CONDEMNED THE BREACH OF BORDER

At least 60,000 entered Ceuta from Morocco, with 34 deaths

CEUTA: Some 60,000 migrants have entered Spain's Ceuta from Morocco in the past 24 hours, Ceuta's president says. That is equivalent to 70 per cent of the city's regular population.

At least 34 migrants have died in the process.

"The situation that Ceuta is going through is absolutely unsustainable," said Juan Jesús Vivas on Friday.

The border crisis boiled over Thursday and continued on Friday with security forces clashing with migrants on the Moroccan side of the border.

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez condemned the breach of the border on Friday speaking in Ceuta, describing the events as "a violation of Spain's territorial integrity."

The Spanish leader cast blame on human smugglers, saying they "deceive so many young people, and ultimately lead many of them to their deaths — whether in the ocean or, as in this case, at Spain's border in the autonomous city of Ceuta."

Live footage of the border showed hundreds of migrants gathered on a hill overlooking Ceuta being dispersed with tear gas by Moroccan forces, while others continued to swim to the Spanish territory.

At the same time, large groups of migrants walked back from Ceuta toward Morocco to return home.

Migrants cross from Morocco into the Spanish enclave of Ceuta AP/PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

» The security forces clashed with migrants on the Moroccan side of the border

» large groups of migrants walked back from Ceuta toward Morocco to return home

» Ahmed Karim, a 33-year old Moroccan, said he had crossed into Ceuta because of the lack of jobs in his country

Rachid Sbihi, who leads a local workers association representing Civil Guard officers, called the situation a "serious humanitarian crisis," saying thousands of migrants, including unaccompanied children, were left sleeping in parks and on sidewalks, while others roamed the streets aimlessly.

"People are still entering. The reinforcements, including Spanish military troops, that have arrived are only helping the injured and other humanitarian efforts," he said. "It's chaotic." Among the 18 who died, many drowned, Sbihi said, but some were also killed in a stampede to cross the breakwater fence at Tarajal beach, an urban beach near a border checkpoint with Morocco.

Ahmed Karim, a 33-year old Moroccan, said he had crossed into Ceuta because of the lack of jobs in his country.

"Many people want to go to Europe, America, but they don't have the opportunity," Karim said.

On Friday morning, the waters near the border fence were littered with buoys, shoes and other belongings left behind. AGENCIES

Hamas says will disarm if Israel halts strikes, withdraws from Gaza

CAIRO: Hamas said Friday that it will begin disarming as part of a deal announced by US President Donald Trump that also requires Israel to end its strikes and withdraw from Gaza.

It marks a potential breakthrough in ending the war, but implementation faces major challenges.

Hamas also said that laying down its heavy weapons, which would come later in the process, was contingent on the creation of a Palestinian state, something Israel's current government adamantly rejects.

Israel has not officially commented on the deal, which is part of a US-brokered ceasefire announced last October.

That agreement called for Hamas to disarm and hand over power to an independent Palestinian administration.

Israel was to withdraw, and an International Stabilisation Force was to deploy.

But progress stalled, with Israel saying everything hinged on Hamas disarming, and Hamas accusing Israel of violating the agreement by continuing to carry out regular strikes on Gaza.

Disarming would represent a sea change for Hamas, whose founding charter calls for armed resistance against Israel, and which sees its arsenal, including rockets, anti-tank missiles and explosives, as lying at the heart of its identity.

Israel, meanwhile, appears unlikely to pull back significant forces or make other concessions ahead of its October elections.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu faces a tough reelection battle, with opponents accusing him of failing to prevent the October 7, 2023, attack that triggered the war.

Neil Quilliam, a Middle East expert at London's Chatham House think tank, said expectations are low that Hamas will actually disarm or that Israel will withdraw from Gaza. AGENCIES

Smoke rises following an Israeli military strike in Gaza City AP/PTI

Key Points

» Israel was to withdraw, and an International Stabilisation Force was to deploy

» Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu faces a tough reelection battle

ISRAEL HAS NOT OFFICIALLY COMMENTED ON THE DEAL

Discarded SpaceX rocket to crash into the moon next week

CAPE CANAVERAL: A drifting SpaceX rocket is on a collision course with the moon after launching a pair of lunar landers more than a year ago.

The rocket's upper stage will unintentionally slam into the moon on Wednesday, carving out a crater and sending up a plume of dust and rubble that scientists — and skygazers — are eager to observe.

Space tracking expert Bill Gray predicts an impact of 5,400 mph (8,700 kph) — seven times the speed of sound — near Einstein Crater on the moon's sunlit western limb. With the action unfolding in the wee hours, the eastern portions of the US and Canada, and much of South America should have the best views.

While scientists are not too concerned about this particular piece of space junk, it highlights the growing threat as more and more items cram into orbit.

"Things are getting crowded up there," said Gray, who plans to view the aftermath from New Brunswick, Canada.

It was never SpaceX's intent to hit the moon. But space experts said the crash could have been avoided if the upper stage had been nudged into orbit around the sun.

It will be the second dead rocket known to crash into the moon accidentally. A Chinese rocket segment dug out a pair of craters on the lunar far side in 2022.

Lucky for astronomers, the upcoming smashup will occur on the moon's near side, packing the equivalent energy of three tons of TNT.

The impact flash, lasting less than a second, will probably be too dim to see, according to experts. But the stream of ejected material could stretch for several miles (kilometres) into space and remain visible to telescopes for tens of minutes.

"The gravity on the moon is low and there is no wind to blow the dust away," said Los Alamos National Laboratory's Benjamin Fernando, who's encouraging observations by professionals and amateurs alike.

"Part of the reason for our interest in this event is to figure out how much of a hazard debris impacts pose to future astronauts," he added in an email. Fernando anticipates an impact crater nearly 90 feet across and 16 feet deep (27 metres across and 5 metres deep), too small to see from Earth but visible to spacecraft. AGENCIES

Renowned climber Purja among 6 missing in Pakistan avalanche

At least four bodies were recovered so far

ISLAMABAD/KATHMANDU: Nepal's veteran mountaineer Nirmal Purja was among six climbers missing after an avalanche struck an expedition on Pakistan's Broad Peak, where rescuers recovered four bodies and continued search operations despite adverse weather on Friday.

Broad Peak (8,051 metres), located in the Karakoram range near K2, is the world's 12th-highest mountain and is considered one of the most challenging peaks to climb.

The avalanche struck the mountain at an altitude of around 7,000 metres Thursday, sweeping away the 10-member climbing team that had begun its summit push, according to the Alpine Club of Pakistan (ACP).

The climbers -- six from Nepal, one Pakistani, one Omani, one American and one Chinese -- went missing at around 9 am on Thursday following the avalanche.

ACP President Major General Irfan Arshad said four bodies were recovered during the rescue operation on Friday. He identified two of the deceased as Oman's Nadhira Ahmed Abdullah Al Harthy and Nepal's Pur Bahadur Gurung. The identities of the other two bodies are yet to be officially confirmed.

Two Pakistan Army Aviation helicopters were engaged in the search and rescue operation.

Nepal's Foreign Ministry said it is closely monitoring the situation, The Kathmandu Post reported. In a statement, the ministry said the Nepali Embassy in Islamabad is coordinating with the local authorities, including the Alpine Club of Pakistan, to support the swift and safe search and rescue of all climbers affected by the avalanche.

It added that the Pakistani authorities have assured Nepal they will mobilise all available resources to carry out the search and rescue operation as quickly as possible, the Post said.

Besides Purja and Gurung, the other Nepalese climbers are Kili Pemba Sherpa, Nima Sherpa, Nawang Thindu Sherpa and Gyalu Sherpa.

The other missing climbers are Sohail Sakhi of Pakistan, Wang Zhong of China and Mallory Geis of the United States.

Officials in Pakistan said search and rescue operations are underway, but bad weather has severely affected efforts, with helicopters facing operational constraints in the mountainous terrain. AGENCIES

Nepal's veteran mountaineer Nirmal Purja

Myanmar's Prez outlines policy road map, criticises ASEAN peace plan

BANGKOK: The head of Myanmar's military-backed government on Friday marked his government's first 100 days in office with a speech defending his record and outlining a five-year road map for his administration, which faces ongoing conflict and international criticism.

President Min Aung Hlaing, the former army chief who had originally seized power in 2021 from a civilian government, was sworn in as president in April following an election that critics said was designed to entrench the military's grip on power.

Addressing more than 900 lawmakers, officials and military representatives at Parliament in the capital, Naypyitaw, he said his government had laid "important foundations" since taking office by pursuing two priorities — restoring peace and stability and promoting national development.

Min Aung Hlaing said he would spend two years accelerating efforts to build a modern and developed nation based on democracy and a federal system, followed by another three years carrying out build-up at full speed.

He also said special elections would be held in 2027 in constituencies across 102 townships that were unable to vote during the three-phase election held late last year because of armed conflict.

He said the government would continue implementing the military's conscription law while strengthening the armed forces and police as they fight pro democracy activists and ethnic minority rebels throughout much of the country.

He noted that his administration had invited armed groups fighting the military to lay down their weapons and had held talks with 13 ethnic armed groups.

At the same time, Min Aung Hlaing criticised a five-point consensus reached by Southeast Asian leaders in 2021 to end Myanmar's civil strife, saying it had been issued without the agreement of all member states and that the regional bloc had discriminated against Myanmar. AGENCIES

World Briefs

PAKISTAN WITNESSED OVER 3,000 TERROR INCIDENTS THIS YEAR: ARMY

ISLAMABAD: Over 3,000 terrorism-related incidents took place in Pakistan this year, resulting in the deaths of 800 people, including security personnel, a top army general said on Friday. The Inter-Services Public Relations Director-General Lt Gen Ahmed Sharif Chaudhry also said that 2,084 terrorists were killed during the period. "As many as 3,145 terrorism incidents occurred in Pakistan in 2026 -- 1,971 were reported from Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, 1,148 from Balochistan and 26 from other parts of the country," he said while addressing a press conference in Islamabad. During the period under review, an average of 10 terrorists were killed every day, he said.

FIRST US REFUELLING AIRCRAFT ARRIVE AT AIR BASE IN BULGARIA

SOFIA: The first two US military aircraft intended to provide support for operations in the Middle East arrived Friday at an air base in southeastern Bulgaria, drawing a complaint from Iran as Bulgarian residents have also been protesting the deployment. The Trump administration has faced pushback from some European allies over the use of air bases in support of its war with Iran. But lawmakers in Bulgaria voted earlier in July to allow the deployment of up to eight US KC-135 refuelling aircraft, as well as 250 personnel with personal weapons and ammunition and airfield equipment, at Bezmer Air Base.

As heat, dry conditions fan wildfires in France, volunteers fan out to help

Hundreds of thousands forced from their homes

LANTON: With his watering can and bucket, Jean-Francois Pauner meanders from one small fire to the next along a forest floor, dousing small flareups of wildfires that have swept through a swath of southwestern France.

"This is the first fire I'm experiencing real-time, and I can tell you it's vicious," said Pauner, 64.

"It's underground, it comes out at any moment, and no matter how much we try to extinguish it, re-extinguish it, re-extinguish it, it keeps restarting all the time."

"It's like a steamroller that's constantly, constantly rolling," said Pauner, wearing shorts, boots and sunglasses on a string around his neck on a road through cultivated pine trees, as the ground smoldered in pockets.

Pauner, who has a residence in nearby Lanton, is among the untold numbers of volunteers who have mobilized to support firefighters battling the biggest wildfires in years in France.

Firefighters work to extinguish a fire in the forest near Blagon, during wildfires in France AP/PTI

"I'm protecting my forest, and my home," he said, after pouring out his watering can into a smoking ditch as if watering a garden, then huffing in the heat on Thursday.

The wildfires blazing through cultivated forests on an Atlantic coast also known for towering sand dunes and tourist resorts have devastated 42,000 hectares west of Bordeaux, driving nearly a quarter-million people out of their homes and vacation sites. AGENCIES

M.P. POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED
OFFICE OF THE Addl. C.E. (P&W), SHREE SINGAJI THERMAL POWER PROJECT,
Dongalia Distt. Khandwa (M.P.) E-mail ID : sepnw.sstpp1@gmail.com,
No. 515-1700/SSTPP/MPPGCL/P&W/3589 Dated : 31.07.2026

Tender Particulars/Tender Number	Estimated Cost (Rs.) (including GST)	Tender Cost & EMD in Rs.	Last Date and Time for Closing of Online Submission
"Work Contract of day to day routine maintenance of HT/LT motors, Hydrogen cylinders transportation, lift operation & minor maintenance & breakdown maintenance of HT motors as per scope of work of PH-1,2X600 MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia." (T-2026_MPPGC_516354_1)	Rs. 93,58,242/- (Including G.S.T.)	2000/- & 1,87,200/-	24.08.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs.
Work contract for complete repairing of rotary breaker tyre of RB-03 and RB-04 along with repairing/ refurbishment of bearing wheel assembly (main support wheel) and thrust wheel and repairing/ reconditioning of longitudinal beam of rotary breaker for 2x600 MW, CHP, PH-I, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_505704_1)	Rs. 86,77,956/- (Including G.S.T.)	2000/- & 1,73,600/-	17.08.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs.

For extension & other details, the bidders are requested to please visit e-portal of GoMP at www.mptenders.gov.in
M.P. Madhyam/127292/2026 // SAVE ELECTRICITY // SE (P&W)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice
OPEN TENDER NOTICE NO. MC-PATNA-QWS-26-27
The Divisional Railway Manager, E.C. Railway. Danapur is inviting online open tender (on (IREPS Portal) for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered/ working with Railway/Irrigation/CPWD/ MES or any other public sector undertaking for under mentioned works:- **1. Name of work with its location :** Comprehensive Maintenance Contract (CMC) of quick watering installed at Patna Jn for period of three years. **2. Approx cost of the work:** Rs. 63,30,000/- (Rupees Sixty three lakh thirty thousand only), **3. Earnest Money to be deposited:** Rs. 1,26,600/- (Rupees One lakh twenty six thousand six hundred Only). **4. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender:** Date & Time for submission of tender - 20.08.2026 up to 12:00 hrs on www.ireps.gov.in Date & Time of opening of tender 20.08.2026 at 12:30 hrs on www.ireps.gov.in, **5. Website particulars & Notice Board location where complete details of tender, corrigendum (if any) can be seen etc.:** The tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in
Divisional Railway Manager (Mech), E. C. Railway, Danapur.
PR/0647/DNR/MECH/T/26-27/40

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!
IMPORTANT INFORMATION
EXTENSION OF PERIODICITY OF SUMMER SPECIAL TRAINS
This is notified for the information of rail passengers that Railways have decided to extend the periodicity of the run of following Summer Special Trains as under:-

Train No.	From	To	Frequency	Earlier Notified Up-to	Extended Up-to	Trips
02563	Barauni Jn.	New Delhi	Daily	31.07.2026	31.08.2026	31
02564	New Delhi	Barauni Jn.	Daily	01.08.2026	01.09.2026	31
02569	Darbhanga	New Delhi	Daily	31.07.2026	31.08.2026	31
02570	New Delhi	Darbhanga	Daily	01.08.2026	01.09.2026	31
03639	Dhanbad	Shakur Basti	Mon, Fri	31.07.2026	31.08.2026	09
03640	Shakur Basti	Dhanbad	Tue, Sat	01.08.2026	01.09.2026	09
05579	Purnia Court	Anand Vihar (T.)	Fri, Sun	31.07.2026	30.08.2026	09
05580	Anand Vihar (T.)	Purnia Court	Sun, Tue	02.08.2026	01.09.2026	09
05575	Saharsa	Anand Vihar (T.)	Tuesday	28.07.2026	25.08.2026	04
05576	Anand Vihar (T.)	Saharsa	Thursday	30.07.2026	27.08.2026	04

Note : Rest other instructions will hold good.
For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in
2653/26 RailMadad Helpline No. 139 Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in Download RailMadad app.
Please join us on NORTHERN RAILWAY Always at your service Visit us at : www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Peerless Group crosses ₹1K cr revenue mark in fiscal 2025-26

Managing Director Jayanta Roy said Peerless Hospital now has 1,016 beds, making it largest 'Swadeshi' healthcare chain in eastern India

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Peerless Group has crossed the Rs 1,000 crore revenue mark in FY26. The Kolkata-headquartered business conglomerate has also expanded its hospital network to more than 1,000 beds across Kolkata, Guwahati and Barasat.

Announcing these achievements at the centrally located Peerless Hotel in Kolkata on Friday, Managing Director Jayanta Roy said Peerless Hospital now has 1,016 licensed beds, making it the largest 'Swadeshi' healthcare chain in eastern India.

Roy said the 94-year-old company, which embarked on a transformation journey in 2022, faced a challenging FY26 but continued to move forward.

"The group's revenue reached Rs 1,013 crore in FY26, crossing the Rs 1,000 crore milestone envisioned at the start of the transformation journey. The revenue was Rs 530 crore in FY22," Roy said.

He added that by FY26, the group had invested Rs 900 crore out of the nearly Rs 1,300 crore committed towards hospitals and real estate projects.

"If we want to grow, we will have to invest. And if we have to invest, we have to navigate interest and depreciation costs. Our view is that the sooner we invest, the better. There is also a change in the climate with Bengal's economic resurgence under the vision of Viksit Bangla 2047," he said.

Before the transformation phase (FY14–FY19), the group's revenue grew at an annual rate of 4 per cent, while profits declined by 11 per cent. Since 2022, revenue has grown at 18 per cent, while profits have increased by 16 per cent annually.

"In FY25, the group's revenue was Rs 800 crore. So, we believe we have managed to grow quite well," said Director Supriyo Sinha.

Meanwhile, the group has launched a new hospital unit in Kolkata, SRIOS. Its hospital network now comprises 1,016 licensed beds, up from around 400 a few years ago, spread across Kolkata (666 beds), Guwahati (250) and Barasat (100). The number of OPD rooms has also increased from 46 to 108.

Roy also announced that construction of Trayam, the group's mixed-use development in New Town, Kolkata, is progressing at full pace, with 41 of the 71 residential units already sold.

Sinha said Peerless Hotels has more than doubled its revenue since FY22, from Rs 39 crore to Rs 89 crore.

He expects the hospitality business to grow by 10-11 per cent in the next financial year, while the healthcare segment is projected to expand by 14-15 per cent.

In FY26, the group's hospital business generated Rs 440 crore in revenue, with the Kolkata unit alone contributing Rs 420 crore.

The group aims to raise hospital revenue to Rs 500 crore in the next financial year.

Roy said the group's social initiatives remain equally important.

Chairman Partha Sarathi Bhattacharya mentioned that the Peerless Skill Academy increased its cumulative student enrolment from 7,567 to 22,290.

Looking ahead, Roy said the focus will be on consolidating existing operations and completing the planned investments. The group is also looking forward to the new industrial policy that the West Bengal government is expected to unveil in August.

'The group's revenue reached Rs 1,013 crore in FY26, crossing the Rs 1,000 crore milestone envisioned at the start of the transformation journey. The revenue was Rs 530 crore in FY22,' Roy said

HIGHLIGHTS

- 'By FY26, the group had invested Rs 900 crore out of the nearly Rs 1,300 crore committed towards hospitals and real estate projects'
- 'If we want to grow, we will have to invest. And if we have to invest, we have to navigate interest and depreciation costs,' Jayanta Roy said
- 'In FY25, the group's revenue was Rs 800 crore. So, we believe we have managed to grow quite well,' said Director Supriyo Sinha

GAIL's standalone PAT jumps to ₹4,292 crore in FY27 June quarter

GAIL's standalone revenue from operations stood at Rs 38,982 cr in Q1 FY27, against Rs 34,797 cr in Q4 FY26

NEW DELHI: GAIL (India) Ltd on Friday reported a strong financial performance for the first quarter of FY27, with standalone Profit After Tax (PAT) rising to Rs 4,292 crore compared with Rs 1,262 crore in the previous quarter, supported by robust transmission and liquid hydrocarbon operations.

The company's standalone revenue from operations stood at Rs 38,982 crore in Q1 FY27, compared with Rs 34,797 crore in Q4 FY26. Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) increased to Rs 6,948 crore from Rs 2,175 crore in the previous quarter. Standalone Profit Before Tax (PBT) stood at Rs 5,773 crore, compared with Rs 1,577 crore in Q4 FY26.

On a consolidated basis, GAIL reported revenue from operations of Rs 41,350 crore in Q1 FY27, compared with Rs 35,705 crore in the previous quarter. Consolidated EBITDA stood at Rs 7,573 crore, up from Rs 2,703 crore in Q4 FY26, while PBT increased to Rs 6,268 crore from Rs 1,966 crore. Consolidated PAT, excluding minority interest, stood at Rs 4,665 crore, compared with Rs 1,485 crore in Q4 FY26.

GAIL said the quarter reflected resilience in natural gas transmission and liquid hydrocarbon operations, although geopolitical disruptions impacted gas marketing and polymer volumes.

During Q1 FY27, the company recorded capital expenditure of Rs 6,176 crore against an annual planned capex of around Rs 11,500 crore, in line with its long-term growth strategy.

Operationally, natural gas transmission volume increased to 122.36 MMSCMD from 118.99 MMSCMD in Q4 FY26, while gas marketing volume declined to 93.82 MMSCMD from 101.88 MMSCMD. Liquid hydrocarbon (LHC) production rose to 232 TMT from 194 TMT, whereas polymer production fell to 51 TMT from 153 TMT. LPG transmission stood at 1,077 TMT compared with 1,114 TMT in the previous quarter.

GAIL Chairman & MD Deepak Gupta said the company managed volatility caused by the West Asia crisis through portfolio flexibility and spot sourcing while continuing to support customer requirements and India's energy security.

He further said GAIL has received PNGRB authorisation for three LPG pipelines — Jhansi-Sitarganj, Cherlapalli-Nagpur and Shikrapur-Hubli-Goa — with a combined length of over 1,800 km and an estimated investment of around Rs. 6,700 crore over three years. He also informed that Konkan LNG Limited (KLL) has become a wholly owned subsidiary of GAIL pursuant to an NCLT order. MPOST

On a consolidated basis, GAIL's PAT, excluding minority interest, stood at Rs 4,665 crore against Rs 1,485 crore in Q4 FY26

SC stays Delhi HC order declaring NSE 'public authority' under RTI

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday stayed a Delhi High Court order that declared the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) a 'public authority' under the RTI Act.

A bench comprising Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta agreed to hear NSE's petition challenging the High Court verdict and sought responses from the Central Information Commission and other parties. The matter has been posted for hearing after four weeks.

The NSE had challenged the July 1 order of a Delhi High Court division bench, which upheld a 2010 judgment of a single judge declaring the exchange a public authority under Section 2(h) of the RTI Act.

Under the RTI Act, citizens can seek information from entities classified as public authorities. The High Court had held that a body owned, controlled or substantially financed by the government qualifies as a public authority.

The division bench observed that NSE was controlled by the appropriate government and upheld the earlier ruling. The stock exchange had earlier challenged an order of the Central Information Commission, arguing that it did not fall under the definition of a public authority under the RTI Act. AGENCIES

SEBI clears settlement of all pending cases against NSE for ₹1,491.21 crore

MUMBAI: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has approved in principle the settlement of all pending regulatory proceedings against the National Stock Exchange (NSE) for a total settlement amount at Rs 1,491.21 crore, removing a major regulatory hurdle for the exchange's long-awaited initial public offering (IPO).

According to an NSE disclosure, the market regulator has approved the settlement of all outstanding matters, including the co-location and dark fibre cases, subject to the exchange complying with the settlement terms.

The exchange said SEBI has demanded a cash payment of Rs 714.74 crore in addition to adjusting Rs 776.47 crore already deposited by NSE towards the total settlement amount of Rs 1,491.21 crore.

NSE said it has already made provisions for the entire settlement amount in its financial statements for the year ended March 31, 2026. However, the actual cash outflow towards the settlement will be Rs 714.74 crore.

NSE filing says, "The financial impact for the settlement amount of Rs 1,491.211 crore has already been provided for in the Financial year ended March 31, 2026. However, the cash outflow towards the settlement will be Rs. 714.74 crore. There is no other material adverse impact on the day-to-day operations of the Company."

The settlement covers long-pending regulatory proceedings related to the co-location case, which involved allegations that certain brokers received preferential access to the exchange's trading systems, and the separate dark fibre matter concerning alleged preferential network access for select trading firms.

The exchange said that once SEBI issues the settlement order, the cases pending before the Supreme Court will be withdrawn.

The development is expected to pave the way for NSE's proposed IPO, which has remained pending for several years due to unresolved regulatory issues.

NSE IPO is expected to be one of the biggest IPO in recent years with wider interest from investors. ANI

'SEBI has approved the settlement of all outstanding matters, including co-location & dark fibre cases'

ITC revenue from operations rises 27.64% to ₹29,523.3 crore in June quarter of FY27

NEW DELHI: Diversified conglomerate ITC Ltd on Friday reported a 27.64 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated revenue from operations to Rs 29,523.3 crore in the first quarter of FY27 compared to Rs 23,129.35 crore a year ago, driven by strong sales across businesses despite geopolitical uncertainties and cost pressures.

Revenue from the sale of products rose 27.82 per cent to Rs 29,409.82 crore during the April-June quarter, while total consolidated income, including other income, grew 26.74 per cent to Rs 30,179.01 crore.

However, consolidated net profit declined 15.6 per cent to Rs 4,508.79 crore from Rs 5,343.41 crore in the year-ago quarter, mainly due to a sharp increase in expenses. Total expenses surged 48 per cent year-on-year to Rs 24,809.95 crore.

Commenting on the quarter, ITC said the operating environment remained challenging due to the ongoing conflict in West Asia, which triggered sharp volatility in crude oil and crude-linked product prices, besides disrupting global trade and supply chains.

The company said its group companies delivered a robust performance, led by ITC Infotech, Surya Nepal, Sproutlife Foods and ITC Hotels.

On the demand outlook, ITC said consumption remained resilient in both rural and urban markets during the quarter, although imported inflation continues to be a key near-term risk.

The company also flagged concerns over a significant monsoon deficit and lower Kharif sowing compared with the same period last year. It said spatial and temporal variations in rainfall, prolonged geopolitical tensions in West Asia and the emergence of El Niño conditions, which could weaken monsoons and intensify heatwaves, may weigh on economic growth, inflation and the current account balance.

Despite these challenges, ITC said India's macroeconomic fundamentals remain strong, supported by sustained public capital expenditure, stable monetary conditions, banking and liquidity measures to support credit growth, and policy initiatives aimed at attracting foreign capital, reducing foreign exchange volatility and strengthening investment activity.

Shares of ITC Ltd ended 1.51 per cent lower at Rs 280.95 on the BSE on Friday. AGENCIES

The company's total consolidated income, including other income, grew 26.74 per cent to Rs 30,179.01 crore

India extending social security benefits to 101 crore citizens, says Mansukh Mandaviya

NEW DELHI: India's social protection systems now cover about 101 crore people, or 68.8 per cent of the population, Union Labour & Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya said on Friday, adding that the achievement was acknowledged by the International Labour Organization (ILO) at the BRICS Labour Ministers' meeting last week.

Speaking at the FICCI-AIOE 4th Global Industrial Relations Summit, organised by the All India Organisation of Employers (AIOE) in association with FICCI and the ILO, Mandaviya said employment generated per percentage point of GDP growth has increased from 0.1 per cent 12 years ago to 1.15 per cent in the latest data, reflecting a sharp improvement in employment elasticity.

He attributed the progress to a collaborative industrial relations framework involving industry, government, trade unions and workers, and credited employers and trade unions for supporting the implementation of the four labour codes.

The minister also said reforms in the Employees' State Insurance Corporation were on the anvil, including empanelling well-run private hospitals under the scheme. He added that the EPFO has shifted to fully digital claims and automatic account transfers through a single Universal Account Number (UAN), while UPI-based withdrawals are under consideration.

Michiko Miyamoto, Director of the ILO DWT for South Asia and Country Office for India, congratulated India on crossing one billion people covered under at least one social protection benefit. She called for greater investment in human capital, AI literacy, continuous reskilling and higher female workforce participation.

AIOE President Jasbir Singh said industrial relations must drive productivity and competitiveness, while FICCI Director General Jyoti Vij highlighted the impact of technology, demographics and geopolitics on the future of work. MPOST

Goa showcases sustainable infra vision at national conference

NEW DELHI: The Goa State Infrastructure Development Corporation (GSIDC) organised the National Conference on Goan Architecture & Sustainability at The Leela Palace, Chanakyapuri, bringing together policymakers, architects, urban planners, sustainability experts, industry leaders & international representatives to discuss sustainable development and heritage-led growth.

The conference was inaugurated by Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant, Union Tourism and Culture Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, Rajya Sabha MP Sadanand Shet Tanavade and other dignitaries.

Addressing the gathering, Sawant said Goa remains committed to building resilient, inclusive and sustainable infrastructure while preserving its rich architectural heritage. He said the conference provided a platform for experts to exchange ideas on climate-resilient, heritage-sensitive solutions & stressed the need to balance development with environmental responsibility and cultural identity.

The event featured four panel discussions on Goan architecture & contextual design, heritage conservation, energy-efficient green buildings & climate-smart construction materials. Speakers represented organisations including TERI, the Charles Correa Foundation, INTACH, GRIHA Council, the World Bank, IFC, the Centre for Science & Environment, Auroville Earth Institute, the European Union, the Royal Danish Embassy and the Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands.

An exhibition of GoVAN products highlighted Goa's local innovation, craftsmanship & entrepreneurship. The conference concluded with a valedictory session outlining key recommendations, followed by a networking event for government officials, industry leaders, architects, researchers & policymakers. The conference reinforced Goa's vision of becoming a leader in sustainable infrastructure, heritage conservation & climate-resilient urban development. MPOST

Basant Garg, CMD PSPCL/PSTCL reviews Badbar grid upgrade plans

BARNALA: Basant Garg, IAS, CMD, PSPCL/PSTCL, along with Er. Punardeep Brar, Director (Generation), PSPCL, visited the 66 KV Grid Sub Station, Badbar, during his visit to Guru Hargobind Thermal Plant, Lehra Mohabbat, to review power supply arrangements for agricultural and domestic consumers.

The review was attended by Er. RK Mittal, Chief Engineer/DS South, Er. Sanjiv Garg, SE, Protection & Maintenance, Patiala, Er. Vikas Singla, XEN City Division, Barnala, Er. Deepinder Partap, XEN, P&M, Barnala.

Officials informed the CMD that the Badbar grid, commissioned in 2009, was initially equipped with a 12.5 MVA power transformer and is supplied through a 12-km-long 66 KV single-circuit line from the 220 KV Dhanaula Sub Station, currently operating at around 60% loading.

The substation caters to four Non-AP feeders supplying electricity to Badbar, Bhure, Kubbe, Bhaini Mehraj and nearby areas, besides nine agriculture feeders supporting the farming sector.

With increasing demand, an additional 12.5 MVA transformer was commissioned in 2015. Both transformers are currently operating at around 80% loading. Officials informed that a proposal to augment Transformer No. 1 from 12.5 MVA to 20 MVA is under active consideration to enhance reliability and meet future requirements. Garg reviewed the operational status and augmentation plans of the grid and appreciated the efforts of field officers in maintaining reliable power supply. He stressed timely completion of upgrade works. MPOST

Apple posts record June quarter revenue of $109.4 bn

It flagged biz risks in next few quarters due to rising memory chip prices, supply constraints

NEW DELHI: Tech giant Apple has posted record June quarter revenue of $109.4 billion, up 16 per cent on a year-on-year basis, supported by double-digit growth in most emerging markets including India, but flagged business risks in the next few quarters due to rising memory chip prices and supply constraints, according to a top company official.

While Americas continues to be the biggest contributor in Apple's revenue, the company recorded the highest growth rate of 22.42 per cent in Greater China, followed by Europe 22.4 per cent and Rest of Asia Pacific 15.6 per cent.

"We achieved June quarter revenue records in every geographic segment. We were pleased to see strength across the board with June quarter records in the US, Latin America, Western Europe, India, China mainland, Japan, and Southeast Asia.

"We also achieved June quarter revenue records in both developed and emerging markets and saw double-digit growth in most emerging markets," Apple CEO Tim Cook said in the last earnings call as the company's top executive.

John Ternus is scheduled to take over as CEO on September 1, 2026.

The company's gross margin was 50.1 per cent, including a favourable impact of approximately 2 percentage points from tariff refunds.

iPhone sales during the reported quarter increased by 21.7 per cent to $54.25 billion from $44.58 billion a year ago. Mac sales grew 28.66 per cent to $10.35 billion from around $8 billion, and the wearables, home and accessories segment grew by 6.46 per cent to $7.88 billion from $7.4 billion.

Apple CFO Kevan Parekh said Apple grew in both developed and emerging markets, with strong double-digit growth in markets like Latin America, India, and Southeast Asia. PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- The company recorded the highest growth rate of 22.42 per cent in Greater China, followed by Europe 22.4 per cent and Rest of Asia Pacific 15.6 per cent
- iPhone sales during the quarter rose 21.7% to $54.25 billion from $44.58 billion a year ago. Mac sales grew 28.66% to $10.35 billion from around $8 billion

Cabinet clears ₹5,070 cr scheme to promote floating solar projects

Under the PM-SSY Central Financial Assistance of Rs 1 crore per MW will be provided for eligible projects after successful commissioning

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Friday approved a dedicated scheme of Rs 5,070 crore to push development of floating solar projects along with storage set-ups in the country, aiming for a new capacity of around 5,000 MW.

Under the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY), approved by the Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Central Financial Assistance (CFA) of Rs 1 crore per MW will be provided for eligible floating solar photovoltaic projects after successful commissioning, an official statement said.

In addition, CFA of Rs 50 lakh will be given for undertaking feasibility studies, including bathymetry and hydrography assessments, environmental studies, and other preparatory activities.

The PM-SSY aims to develop 5,000 megawatts of floating solar photovoltaic projects with co-located energy storage systems having a minimum capacity of two hours, i.e., 10,000 MWh, the statement said.

The projects will be sanctioned during FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31, with disbursement of financial support continuing up to FY 2032-33.

In addition, CFA of Rs 50 lakh will be given for undertaking feasibility studies, including bathymetry and hydrography assessments, environmental studies, and other preparatory activities

All states and union territories (UTs) will benefit through this scheme. The scheme would enhance the floating solar PV capacity in the country by 5,000 MW, which is presently around 700 MW only. These projects would provide an opportunity to gainfully utilise existing reservoirs & industrial ponds, and eliminate competition for scarce land resources.

The integration of an energy storage system will help strengthen grid reliability. The scheme would help reduce around 10 million tonnes of CO_2 emissions annually. It would help generate approximately 16,000-17,000 full-time equivalent employment opportunities across the project value chain.

In a social media post, Minister for New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) Pralhad Joshi said that the Union Cabinet has approved the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY), ushering in a new era of clean energy by harnessing the untapped potential of India's reservoirs and water bodies.

"With a target of 5,000 MW of Floating Solar PV capacity, 10,000 MWh of Energy Storage Systems and an expected investment of Rs 28,500 crore, the scheme will strengthen India's energy security, accelerate the clean energy transition and power the journey towards a self-reliant, sustainable #ViksitBharat," he said.

He said the scheme has the potential to unlock 102 GW of floating solar capacity.

The statement said that the scheme would also promote domestic manufacturing of flotation systems as well as the entire value chain of the projects, like PV cells, modules, energy storage systems, etc., and support the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat.

PM Surya Sarovar Yojana will also help contribute to renewable energy capacity addition, support the achievement of national energy and climate objectives, and facilitate optimal utilisation of water resources while advancing the vision of Viksit Bharat.

MNRE Secretary Santosh Sarangi had earlier said that the ministry is looking at a scheme which will encourage the states to go for much larger-scale floating solar projects, which till now have not reached their desired potential. Under floating solar projects, solar panel systems are installed on water bodies, and they are more energy-efficient than land-based systems due to the cooling effect of water.

HIGHLIGHTS

- PM-SSY aims to develop 5K MW of floating solar photovoltaic projects with co-located energy storage systems having a minimum capacity of two hours
- Projects will be sanctioned during FY27 to FY31, with disbursement of financial support continuing up to FY33
- Scheme would boost floating solar PV capacity by 5,000 MW, which is presently around 700 MW only

AMID WEST ASIA CONFLICT

Govt advises RERA to give 4-mnth extension to real estate projects

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Union Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry on Friday issued an advisory asking all state Real Estate Regulatory Authorities (RERAs) to grant a four-month extension in the registration and completion timelines of eligible real estate projects affected by disruptions arising from the ongoing conflict in West Asia.

The ministry, in an advisory issued to all regulatory authorities, said the prevailing situation in West Asia has adversely affected global supply chains, resulting in a shortage of construction materials, thereby impacting the timely construction of the real estate projects.

It said the ministry had received several representations from stakeholders in the real estate sector seeking relief in view of the disruptions affecting timely completion of projects.

Referring to an Office Memorandum issued by the Department of Expenditure under the Ministry of Finance on April 29, the advisory noted that the ongoing West Asia situation has been treated as "war" for invocation of the Force Majeure clause.

Section 6 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 provides for extension of registration of a real estate project on account of Force Majeure, which, inter

alia, includes "war" affecting the regular development of a real estate project.

Further, under Section 7(3) of RERA, the Authority may, instead of revoking the registration, permit it to remain in force subject to such terms and conditions as it considers appropriate in the interest of the allottees, it said.

In view of the Force Majeure conditions arising from the conflict, the ministry has advised regulatory authorities to issue suitable orders extending the registration and corresponding completion timelines of registered real estate projects by four months.

The relief would apply to projects whose original, revised or already extended completion date falls on or after February 28, 2026.

In order to avoid the need for submission of separate applications for extension of registration of individual real estate projects and issuance of separate orders thereon, state RERAs may issue a common order or direction in this regard.

The National Real Estate Development Council (NAREDCO) welcomed the advisory about the extension of registration of real estate projects under the Force Majeure provisions of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016.

The advisory comes in response to the impact of the ongoing situation in West Asia, which has disrupted global supply chains, led to shortages of construction materials and affected the timely execution of real estate projects, NAREDCO said in a statement.

Welcoming the advisory, Parveen Jain, President, NAREDCO, said, "NAREDCO sincerely welcomes the timely and pragmatic advisory issued by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

"The ongoing geopolitical situation in West Asia has significantly impacted the availability and cost of construction materials, resulting in unavoidable delays in project execution. The Ministry's recognition of these extraordinary circumstances under the Force Majeure provisions of RERA is a balanced and much-needed step for the real estate sector."

He said that NAREDCO has requested all state RERAs to implement the ministry's advisory in letter and spirit, adding that timely extension of project registration and completion timelines will provide much-needed relief to developers facing circumstances beyond their control due to the ongoing war-related disruptions.

Rupee rises 7 paise to 95.43 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee stayed in positive territory on Friday, gaining 7 paise to settle at 95.43 against the US dollar, tracking sustained foreign capital inflows and support from the Reserve Bank.

However, higher global crude oil prices and a stronger greenback capped sharper gains in the local unit, while elevated tensions in West Asia kept markets on edge, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.40 and traded in the range of 95.25-95.46 during the session. It eventually settled at 95.43, up 7 paise from its previous close.

The rupee surged 26 paise to close at 95.50 against the US dollar on Thursday, rising for the fifth straight session.

"We expect the rupee to trade with a slight positive bias on a soft dollar and dovish Fed. Positive global markets and improved foreign inflows may also support the rupee. However, renewed geopolitical tensions between the US and Iran may cap sharp upside," Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan. USD-INR spot price is expected to trade in a range of Rs 95 to Rs 95.60, he said.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading up 0.28 per cent at 100.14.

Brent crude futures, the global oil benchmark, were trading up 0.42 per cent at $89.40 per barrel. PTI

India's foreign exchange reserves rise $6.12 billion to $682.35 billion

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves jumped $6.118 billion to $682.354 billion during the week ended July 24, the Reserve Bank said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had increased $1.08 billion to $676.237 billion.

The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of $728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the Middle East conflict which led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has also made multiple public appeals starting May 11 to countrymen to conserve forex by cutting down on foreign travel, limiting fuel use and refraining from gold buys for a year.

For the week ended July 24, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased $4.873 billion to $555.929 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in foreign exchange reserves.

The Reserve Bank of India and the government had launched a series of measures to attract more forex flows into the country last month, including the FCNR(B) measure.

The country has so far received $32 billion under the schemes, as per reports.

Value of gold reserves increased $1.308 billion to $103.058 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were down $53 million at $18.617 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) was also down $11 million to $4.75 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the Reserve Bank's data. PTI

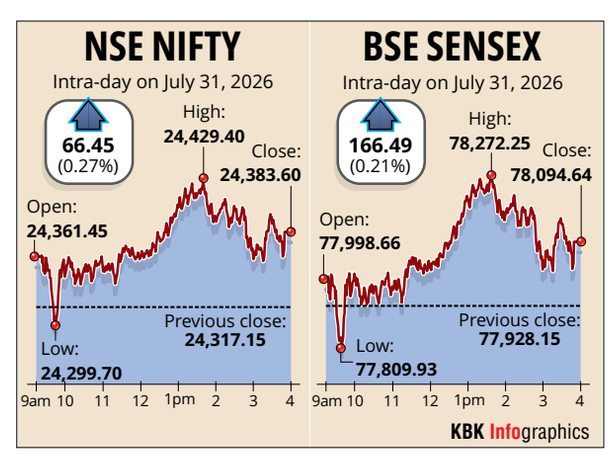
Markets extend rally to 3rd day, tracking sharp rally in Bajaj Finance & foreign fund inflows

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty rose for the third consecutive day on Friday to close at a more than three-week high, tracking a sharp rally in Bajaj Finance & foreign fund inflows.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 166.49 points, or 0.21 per cent, to settle at over three-week high of 78,094.64 with 16 of its constituents closing higher and 14 with losses.

The 50-share NSE Nifty gained 66.45 points, or 0.27 per cent, to end at a three-week high of 24,383.60.

From the Sensex pack, Bajaj Finance jumped 8.11 per cent after the firm on Thursday reported a 28 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated profit after tax (PAT) to Rs 6,081 crore for the June quarter of FY27, driven by growth in core



income and improvement in asset quality.

Bajaj Finserv, Mahindra & Mahindra, Adani Ports, Tata Steel, Reliance Industries, Bharat Electronics and Titan were also among the winners.

TCS, Eternal, Infosys, ITC and InterGlobe Aviation were among the major laggards.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 3,623.51 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

The domestic IT index witnessed profit booking following its recent rally, he added.

The BSE MidCap Select index climbed 0.66 per cent and SmallCap Select index went up by 0.48 per cent.

Among sectors, Auto jumped 1.99 per cent, followed by Capital Goods (1.78 per cent), Power (1.26 per cent), Oil & Gas (1.01 per cent), Telecommunication (0.83 per cent), Utilities (0.67 per cent) and Services (0.66 per cent).

IT tanked 1.39 per cent, Focused IT dropped 1.21 per cent, FMCG (0.90 per cent), Hospitals (0.78 per cent) and Private Banks index (0.20 per cent).

A total of 2,568 stocks advanced, while 1,653 declined and 204 remained unchanged on the BSE. PTI

Closely monitoring: India on US bill seeking up to 100 % tariffs on buyers of Russian oil

NEW DELHI: Days after the US Senate cleared a new bill that would authorise President Donald Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on India, China and other major buyers of Russian oil and gas, New Delhi on Friday said it was closely monitoring the situation.

The bill will now be taken up by the House of Representatives for deliberation.

"On energy security, our position has been clarified and very well articulated on several occasions. It is something which is predicated on our national priorities and on securing the energy needs of our 1.4 billion people through diversified sources, which includes the US," External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

Apart from China and India, the other top purchasers of Russian crude oil are Slovakia, Hungary and Azerbaijan

He was responding to a question on the US Senate clearing the bill by 86-12 vote.

"We remain engaged with relevant stakeholders in the US at various levels on this particular matter," Jaiswal said.

The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 would impose primary and secondary sanctions against Russia and actors supporting its war in Ukraine.

The sanctions target Russian officials, oligarchs, their family members, foreign persons and Russian banks and financial institutions, as well as the Russian Shadow Fleet.

The legislation allows the president to impose targeted tariffs on imported goods from countries that buy the vast majority of Russian oil or gas and enable Russian sanctions evasion.

Section 113 of the bill specifically targets the five countries that purchase the largest volumes of Russian fuel or facilitate sanctions evasion through shadow fleets, threatening them with additional 100 per cent tariffs.

Apart from China and India, the other top purchasers of Russian crude oil are Slovakia, Hungary and Azerbaijan.

The bill calls for the US Trade Representative to reassess the top five purchasers every 180 days, to adjust tariff rates based on changes in purchasing behaviour. PTI

IOC Q1 revenue from operations rises 26% to ₹2.75 lakh crore

NEW DELHI: Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) on Friday reported a 26 per cent year-on-year increase in revenue from operations to Rs 2.75 lakh crore in the first quarter of FY27, even as the state-owned fuel retailer posted a standalone net loss of Rs 2,661.37 crore due to pressure from holding fuel prices amid rising costs.

The company had reported a standalone profit of Rs 5,688.60 crore in the April-June quarter of the previous fiscal and earnings of Rs 11,377.51 crore in the January-March quarter.

IOC Chairman A S Sahney said efficiency gains, improved refinery margins and strong operational performance helped

the company contain losses arising from maintaining petrol, diesel and LPG prices despite a surge in global crude prices following the West Asia conflict.

IOC achieved its highest-ever first-quarter crude throughput of 19.165 million tonnes and recorded its lowest-ever quarterly fuel and loss at 8.04 per cent, compared with 8.5 per cent earlier. The company also reported record quarterly sales of petrol at 4.5 million tonnes and diesel at 10.866 million tonnes, while natural gas sales volume increased 11 per cent.

Sahney said crude supplies remained stable despite disruptions from the West Asia conflict, with IOC sourcing from alternative markets including West Africa, South America, Brazil and Venezuela. Russian crude accounted for around 48 per cent of IOC's refinery feedstock. For LPG supplies, the company diversified sourcing by procuring products from countries such as Algeria and Azerbaijan to address disruptions. MPOST

Fiscal deficit touches 18% of full-year target in Q1

NEW DELHI: The central government's fiscal deficit stood at 18.2 per cent of the full-year target at the end of June, according to data released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA) on Friday.

The deficit was at 17.9 per cent of Budget Estimates (BE) of 2025-26 in the first three months of the previous financial year.

In absolute terms, the fiscal deficit, or gap between the government's expenditure and revenue, was Rs 3,07,833 crore in the April-June period of the 2026-27 fiscal year.

The Centre has set a fiscal deficit target of 4.3 per cent of the GDP or Rs 16.96 lakh crore in the current fiscal.

According to the CGA, the Centre's net tax revenue was Rs 6.36 lakh crore, or 22.2 per cent of the corresponding BE 2026-27 of total receipts, up to June 2026.

In the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, the net tax revenue was at 19 per cent of that year's Budget Estimates.

The data on monthly accounts showed that the total expenditure during the first quarter was at Rs 13.57 lakh crore, or 25.4 per cent of BE. In the year-ago period, it was at 24.1 per cent of BE. PTI

Cabinet approves revised land policy for port-dependent industries

The revised policy allows existing captive users to develop additional berths, jetties, terminals or single buoy moorings for enhanced captive requirements, with concession periods of up to 30 years for govt entities

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Friday approved a revised policy for the award of waterfront and associated land to Port Dependent Industries (PDIs) at major ports, aiming to provide long-term certainty to investors, facilitate capacity expansion and improve ease of doing business.

The revised policy allows existing captive users to develop additional berths, jetties, terminals or single buoy moorings (SBMs) for enhanced captive requirements, with concession periods of up to 30 years for government entities. It also addresses changes arising from evolving business and regulatory conditions.

Minister for Ports, Shipping & Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal said the policy creates a predictable, transparent and investor-friendly framework for port-led industrial growth.

According to an official statement, major port authorities will be able to renew or extend concession agreements of existing PDIs for up to 30 years without inviting fresh bids. Renewals will be based on either the prevailing market rate or the indexed revenue payable under the existing concession agreement, whichever is higher, ensuring protection of port revenues.

The policy also introduces a structured mechanism for capacity expansion. Major port authorities will undertake price discovery through competitive bidding while giving the existing concessionaire the Right of First Refusal (RoFR) to match the highest bid. Participation will be limited to eligible PDIs handling the same cargo profile.

To prevent misuse, the concession period for any additional berth or terminal developed under the expansion proposal will remain co-terminus with the maximum permissible concession period of the existing facility.

For the first time, the policy provides a framework for allotting waterfront and associated land to eligible government organisations without competitive bidding, subject to availability and prescribed safeguards. AGENCIES

CLOSER LOOK

- It also addresses changes arising from evolving business and regulatory conditions
- Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal said the policy creates a predictable, transparent and investor-friendly framework for port-led industrial growth

WITH DOMINATING WINS AT COMMONWEALTH GAMES

Boxing: Arundhati, Jaismine, Preeti, Ankush through to finals

GLASGOW: Arundhati Choudhary stunned defending champion Rosie Eccles of Wales in a split decision in women's 70kg class, while world champion Jaismine Lamboria (women's 57kg), Preeti Pawar (women's 54kg), Ankush Panghal (men's 80kg) and Jadumani Singh (men's 55kg) also sailed into the Commonwealth Games final as Indian boxers produced a dominant display here on Friday. Arundhati beat her Wales opponent 4-0 in a messy and ill-tempered women's 70kg category semifinal as the Indian held on to her good show in the first two rounds, forcing Rosie to receive a standing count during that time.

Jaismine was so dominant in her 57kg semifinal bout that she won in a Referee Stops Contest (RSC) decision after the Lesotho boxer received her third standing count in the closing seconds of the second round. Jadumani Singh also entered the men's 55kg final after beating P. P. M. Haoseb of Namibia in a unanimous 5-0 decision in the semifinals.

Meanwhile, Preeti outpunched Zambia's Catherine Mwape 5-0 while Ankush beat aside Joshua Ofori by a similar margin.

The 22-year-old from Bhiwani, Preeti, who is an Asian Games bronze medallist, powered to a 5-0 win to set up a clash with Canada's Scarlett Delgado, who defeated England's Lauren Mackie 4-1 in her semifinal bout.

The Indian outpaced Mwape for most of the bout, cleverly drawing her in for effective counter-attacks with her left straight being particularly effective.

"I am very happy that I have managed to do what I prepared for. I have to give my best tomorrow (Saturday) for the gold medal. I never take my opponents lightly, and always prepare in detail with my coaches. I am happy that I am able to implement those plans," Preeti told PTI after her win. Mwape struggled to connect throughout and was beaten almost every time Preeti launched her combination strikes. The Zambian's struggles were evident from the three counts she faced in the first two rounds. Such was Preeti's dominance that all five judges marked 10-8 in her favour in the second round.

With the bout out of her grasp, Mwape spent the last three minutes evading the pounding from Preeti, who sailed through without having to work too hard.

Ankush was equally dominant against Ofori, who resorted to repeated clinching after being comprehensively outboxed in the opening two rounds. Although the Canadian launched an all-out attack in the beginning of the second round, the Indian soaked up the pressure with ease before countering with crisp combinations to seal a one-sided 5-0 verdict. AGENCIES

Jaismine Lamboria

Arundhati Choudhary

Ankush Panghal

Preeti Pawar

Highlights

- Arundhati beat her Wales opponent 4-0
- Jadumani Singh also entered the men's 55kg final after beating P. P. M. Haoseb of Namibia
- Such was Preeti's dominance that all five judges marked 10-8 in her favour in 2nd round

Seema Kaliramna wins bronze

The PhD aspirant wins in discus throw

Seema Kaliramna

S.KANNAN

GLASGOW: You can well call her the Super Mom. Seema Kaliramna, the 27-year-old bespectacled mother showed that she is no bunny with the discus in her hand. On a chilly Thursday night at the Scotstoun arena here, the Phd student, who hails from Bhiwani, Haryana, turned on the heat.

She came up with a best-effort of 58.65 metres to win a bronze medal at the Commonwealth Games. Not many had expected a medal from Seema, who has been plying her trade as a hard grind for over 15 years.

The recent events in her life have been eventful, post-partum. She was battling arthritis as well and to conquer the pain barrier was not easy. Putting performance over pain, she was in the field in cold conditions with a single-minded focus. After the more famous men had failed in the shot-put competition, Seema came into her own. As she turned and hurled the discus to a distance of 58.65 metres, it was the best she could manage. The giant scoreboard flashed bronze, and the audience broke into applause. This kind of energy in the arena is not something Seema is used to often. She soaked it in, thought about her kid back home in India and then smiled. Her knees wrapped in protective cover, she came and addressed the media, happily.

"It was no easy, the weather conditions. I was expecting to go over 60 metres, but the challenge was the cold," said Seema. "I'm feeling really good, and emotional as well. I competed in the Asian Championships in 2025, and during that time, I didn't have the experience of how to compete in international competitions, how to keep myself calm, so I've benefited a lot from that competition. Today, I didn't do my personal best, but in my mind, I just wanted to do well," said Seema.

"I am used to warm weather in India. And then we went to the camp in Spala, so that we could acclimatise. Of course, it was colder here. I keep striving and could have gone for silver had it not been for the conditions. Since the next Commonwealth Games will be hosted in India, the young athletes will get a lot of support there and I hope to benefit from it," added Seema.

On her next plan, she said she wanted to do well in the Asian Games to be held in Nagoya, Japan. "I want to give my personal best there and win a medal," said Seema.

She rued the fact she does not have a job, as she is over 25 now.

"I am thankful for all the support the Athletics Federation of India, the Sports Authority of India gives us. Thanks to the JSW, I could bring my husband here, he is my coach," added Seema.

> On her next plan, she said she wanted to do well in the Asian Games to be held in Nagoya

Commonwealth TT: Manush, Harmeet advance

NEW DELHI: Top seed Manush Shah and fellow title contender Harmeet Desai led the charge as Indian paddlers dominated the individual events at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships, with a majority of home players advancing to the pre-quarterfinals in the men's and women's singles here on Friday.

As many as 11 of the 14 Indians in the round of 32 progressed with Manush overcoming a stiff opening-game challenge from Australia's Chulong Nie before winning 8-11, 11-9, 11-7, 11-7, 11-4. Harmeet also recovered after dropping the first game to Australia's Xuqi Lin, winning 9-11, 11-8, 11-9, 11-6, 11-4.

Manav Thakkar advanced comfortably with a straight-games win over Maldives' Akhyar Ahmed Khalid, while Sanil Shetty, Jas Modi, Payas Jain and Akash Pal also secured their places in the last 16 with convincing performances.

Among the all-Indian contests, H. Jehob outclassed Mudit Dani in straight games. Ankur Bhattacharjee fought back from a game down to beat Divyansh Srivastava, while SFR Snehit recovered after losing the opening game to defeat Raegan Albuquerque in six games.

Ronit Bhanja survived a tense finish against Singapore's Ellsworth Le, clinching the fifth game 15-13.

In the women's singles, top-seeded Australian Yangzi Liu lived up to expectations with a commanding straight-games win over Malaysia's Karen Lyne Anak Dick, advancing to the pre-quarterfinals.

India's biggest scare came from Commonwealth Games medallist Sreeja Akula, who was pushed to seven games by Australia's Jiamuwa Wu before prevailing 6-11, 12-10, 11-8, 11-4, 7-11, 10-12, 11-2.

Swastika Ghosh, Anusha Kutumbale, Syndrela Das, Taneesha Kotecha, Nithya Shree Mani, Sayali Wani, Sutirtha Mukherjee, Divyanshi Bhowmick and Yashaswini Ghorpade also advanced with convincing victories, keeping India's medal hopes on track.

However, the hosts faced a few setbacks. AGENCIES

Bumrah clears fitness test; To play in Sri Lanka series

SHILLONG: Shillong Lajong FC started their Durand Cup campaign with an impressive 2-0 win over Nongkseh Sports and Cultural Club in the Shillong derby here on Friday.

Everbrightson Sana (70') and Tremiki Lamurong (86') scored the decisive goals for the side from Shillong.

Nongkseh showed no signs of being overawed by their more fancied opponents as the Meghalaya State League champions pressed high from the outset and dominated the early midfield exchanges.

The Upper Shillong-based side also created the first chance of the match when Sheen Stevenson Sohktung capitalised on a defensive lapse and unleashed a left-footed strike from the edge of the penalty area. His effort beat the goalkeeper but crashed against the crossbar and bounced away to safety.

Shillong Lajong gradually grew into the contest and began to dictate proceedings in midfield, with Lamlallian Vaiphei and Gladdy Kharbuli orchestrating play from the centre of the park.

The Red Dragons looked dangerous on the counter-attack, a hallmark of their playing style, while also threatening from set-piece situations.

However, they lacked the decisive final ball allowing the Nongkseh defence to remain resolute and their goalkeeper relatively untroubled throughout the first half.

Everbrightson Sana scuffed his effort after finding space inside the box at the end of a well worked move from the midfield.

New signing Jota also saw his shot go wide of the post in the final moments of the first half after being setup by Phrangki Buam as both sides went into the half tied on 0-0. AGENCIES

BSES BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE Date: 01.08.2026

Sealed tenders under two Bid System (Un-priced & Priced) are invited for following jobs from all bidders.

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/ FK/PR/MS/1376	RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF POLYCARBONATE METER SEAL	2.40 Crores	4,80,000/-	22.08.2026 15:30 HRS	22.08.2026 16:00 HRS
CMC/BR/26-27/ FK/PR/MS/1377	RATE CONTRACT FOR 1PHASE & 3 PHASE BUS BAR IN BRPL	4.60 Crores	9,20,000/-	22.08.2026 15:30 HRS	22.08.2026 16:30 HRS
CMC/BR/26-27/ FK/PR/RJ/1378	RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION OF NITROGEN INJECTION FIRE PROTECTION SYSTEM(NIFPS) IN BRPL	1.64 Crores	3,28,000/-	22.08.2026 15:30 HRS	22.08.2026 16:45 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document : ₹ 1180/-
For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents etc. please visit our website **www.bsesdelhi.com**
Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

Government of Jharkhand
Urban Development and Housing Department
Directorate of Municipal Administration
Telephone.: 0651-2401955, 2401182(Fax), Email: director.ma.goj@gmail.com

Tender Notice No. 01/2026 Ranchi Date-31/07/2026
Request for Proposal (RFP)
For Empanelment of Agency(s) for Implementation of Animal Birth Control (ABC) Programme in Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) of Jharkhand
Directorate of Municipal Administration
Urban Development & Housing Department, Government of Jharkhand
1st Floor, JUPMI Building, Beside HEC Administrative Office, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004
Telephone: 0651-2401955
Email: director.ma.goj@gmail.com
Website: https://udhd.jharkhand.gov.in

The Directorate of Municipal Administration, Urban Development & Housing Department, Government of Jharkhand invites proposals from eligible agencies/firms for empanelment for implementation of the Animal Birth Control (ABC) Programme in Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) of Jharkhand.

Interested bidders may download the complete RFP document from the Department's website: **https://udhd.jharkhand.gov.in.**

Schedule of Bidding Process

Sl. No.	Particulars	Details
1.	Mode of Submission	Hard copy submission only at the Office of the Directorate of Municipal Administration, UD&HD, GoJ, Ranchi
2.	Last Date & Time for Submission of Technical Proposal	**21/08/2026 up to 05:00 PM**
3.	Date & Time of Pre-Bid Meeting	**11/08/2026 at 12:30 PM**
4.	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Proposals	**25/08/2026 at 03:30 PM**
5.	Empanelment Method	Quality Based Selection (QBS)

Important Instructions

1. The proposal shall be submitted in sealed covers as prescribed in the RFP document along with all supporting documents, Tender Processing Fee, Bid Security, Power of Attorney, Affidavit and Declaration regarding Non-Blacklisting.
2. A non-refundable Tender Processing Fee of ₹15,000/- (Rupees Fifteen Thousand only) and refundable Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of ₹1,50,000/- (One Lakh Fifty Thousand only) shall accompany the proposal.
3. Evaluation of proposals shall be carried out under the Quality Based Selection (QBS) methodology as detailed in the RFP document.
4. Corrigenda, amendments and clarifications, if any, shall be published only on the Department's website. Bidders are advised to regularly visit the website for updates.
5. Late submissions shall not be entertained under any circumstances.
6. The Directorate of Municipal Administration, UD&HD, GoJ reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals, cancel or modify the bidding process, or amend the terms and conditions of the RFP at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.
7. The Department shall not be liable for any cost incurred by bidders in the preparation and submission of proposals.

Sd/- Director
Directorate of Municipal Administration
Urban Development & Housing Department
Government of Jharkhand

PR 386377 (Urban Development and Housing)26-27*D

Jamshedpur FC pull out of ISL after missing AIFF fee deadline

NEW DELHI: Jamshedpur FC on Friday announced pulling out of the Indian Super League (ISL), just hours after missing the deadline for payment of participation fee for the upcoming season, beginning September 4.

Earlier in the month, the All India Football Federation (AIFF) had set July 20 deadline for payment of Rs 1.1 crore by the clubs in two instalments as administrative fees. The deadline was extended till Friday evening. The club said it will not be participating in the ISL from 2026-27 season onwards. The 2026-27 ISL is scheduled to start on September 4.

According to sources, the club's board of directors have decided to wind up the first team as of now.

Inter Kashi club of Varanasi, which apparently did not pay before the initial July 20 deadline, has also made the payment. That means that all the remaining 13 clubs have paid the participation fee.

"Inter Kashi have made the payment and we will take a call on Saturday whether we will go ahead with 13 clubs or not," a top AIFF official told PTI.

In the statement, Jamshedpur FC, which was founded in 2017, said that it will work to promote and develop the game at the grassroots level.

"Jamshedpur Football Club would like to confirm that it will not be participating in ISL from 2026-27 season onwards," it said on 'X'. "JFSPL remains committed, in other capacities, to the continued growth and development of football in India. We will continue in our endeavour to promote and develop the game of football, including at the grassroots level. "We will continue to identify and develop young football talent across India to create a strong pathway for young players from grassroots to national and international football."

On July 8, the AIFF and ISL sides reached a landmark agreement, allowing the clubs to run a full-fledged top-tier competition of the country for at least two years.

The AIFF handed over the commercial rights of the ISL to the clubs for four years. But there is an option for the clubs to exit it unilaterally after two years.

The 2025-26 edition of the ISL was delayed and curtailed to just 13 matches per club played in a single leg for just over three months after the Master Rights Agreement between the AIFF and its then commercial partners FSDL ended December last. AGENCIES

The 2026-27 ISL is scheduled to start on September 4

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.- PRYJ-Sig-203-2026-27 Date: 27.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs. The details of the Tender is as under:-**

Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-203-2026-27 | **Approx. Cost of work (₹):** 12452752.68/-
Name of work: Sectional Signalling Maintenance Contract in section of SSE/Sig/RRI/GMC for period of Twenty Four Months.
Bid Security (₹): 249100/- | **Completion Period:** 24 Months
Date of Opening of tender: 24.08.2026
Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on **www.ireps.gov.in**
Time date & place of opening of tender: Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at **12.30 hours.**

1736/26(K)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

WEIGHTLIFTING

Son of a tailor, Punjab's Lovepreet wins silver with CWG 'snatch' record

India's Lovepreet Singh reacts after setting a new game record in the men's +110kg Weightlifting Final in Glasgow AP/PTI

GLASGOW: India's Lovepreet Singh shattered the Commonwealth Games snatch record and came agonisingly close to gold before finishing just a kilogram behind New Zealand's David Andrew Liti to claim silver in the men's +110kg weightlifting competition here on Thursday.

The 28-year-old totalled 388kg (176kg in snatch and 212kg in clean and jerk), was pipped by Liti, who clinched gold with 389kg (166kg+223kg) after a Games record lift in clean and jerk.

England's Andrew Griffith claimed bronze with a distant 356kg (165kg+191kg).

A bronze medallist at the previous edition, Lovepreet went one better this time, ending India's run of three medal-less weightlifting events and capping a successful campaign for the contingent, which finished with eight medals -- one gold, six silver and one bronze.

Hailing from Bal Sikander village in Punjab's border district of Amritsar, Lovepreet comes from a humble family. His father is a tailor, while his grandfather earned a living selling vegetables.

> The Punjab lifter was in sublime touch in the snatch, opening with a comfortable 168kg before effortlessly raising bar to 173kg

Encouraged by his family to pursue sport instead of the family profession, he took up weightlifting at the age of 13 at the DAV Ground and has since emerged as one of India's leading heavyweight lifters.

"I thought I would win gold after snatch but it was up to god. Little disappointed that I couldn't lift in my final attempt in clean and jerk, I have lifted more in training," Lovepreet said after his silver-winning effort.

The Punjab lifter was in sublime touch in the snatch, opening with a comfortable 168kg before effortlessly raising the bar to 173kg.

He then smashed the Games record with a flawless 176kg in his third attempt, taking a commanding 10kg lead into the clean and jerk. AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pappu Kumar, S/o: Nand Lal, R/o: H.No. WZ-412, Naraina Village, Near Mata Mandir, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 88/2023, U/s: 3 DPDP Act, Police Station Kamla Market, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pappu Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pappu Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pappu Kumar** of **Police Station Kamla Market, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Neetu Sharma
ACJM-01, Central, Room No. 366,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9671/CD/2026

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No. : TRD-KGP-W-2026-27-06RT, dated 30.07.2026. e-Tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD/Kharagpur-721301 for & on behalf of the President of India for the following work before 15.00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. **Description of works :** Replacement of composite insulator by porcelain insulator over Kharagpur Division (Phase-II). **Tender value :** ₹ 2,65,60,840/-. **EMD :** ₹ 5,31,200/- **Cost of tender document :** Nil. **Completion Period :** 18 (Eighteen) months. **Date of Submission :** Upto 15.00 hrs. of 24.08.2026. **Date of Opening:** 24.08.2026. Interested Tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details, description, specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **Note:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-550)**

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Annu
Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class, Charkhi Dadri
ASHWANI KUMAR ADOPTED S/O AJIT SINGH
Vs.
GENERAL PUBLIC
CNR No. HRCD02-001063-2026
Next Date:-29-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: GENERAL PUBLIC

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **29-09-2026 at 10:00 a.m.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district = Bhiwani**

Sd/-Ms. Annu
Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class
Dated 31.07-2026 Charkhi Dadri

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010
LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 17-07-2026, one person namely Mohd. Rafiq S/O Abdul Bani Rather caste Kashmiri R/O Dabbi Lohai Tehsil Lohai Malhar District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Malhar stating therein that on 16-07-2026 his daughter namely Shahnaz Bano, age 17 years went to bring water from dhok nearby house at about 1930 hrs and did not return home till date. The complainant and other family members made best efforts to search the girl but all in vain. On this, a case FIR No. 17/2026 U/S 137(2) BNS has been registered at Police Station Malhar and investigation of the case has been entrusted to PSI Mohd. Iqbal No. GEC-245790.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing girl, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

Description Roll:-

- •Name Shahnaz Bano
- •Husband Mohd. Rafiq caste Kashmiri
- •Permanent Address Dabbi Lohai
- •Present Address Dabbi Lohai
- •Tehsil Lohai Malhar
- •Police Station Malhar
- •Age 17 years
- •Height 5 feet 04 inch
- •Complexion Wheatish
- •Built Normal
- •Face Oval
- •Eyes Black
- •Attire Yellow Colour Salwar Kameez
- •Languages known Kashmiri/ Hindi

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. SHO P/S Malhar – 9186316023

Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua

DIP No:DIP/J-7040/26

The South Indian Bank Ltd

Regional Office- Delhi,
3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21/1, Pusa Road,Karol Bagh, New Delhi -110005, **Phone-** 011 4233 1664/011 4512 8661
email-ro1008@sib.co.in.

Ref: DEL/CRD/SAR/27/2026-27 **Date: 30-07-2026**

E - AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

1. **M/s. Shri Gangadas Textile Industries Limited,** 7098 Shop no. 1, Jain Market,Guru Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi- 110 031,Also at: F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 010,Also at: Ground & Frist Floor, Property no. 465,Near Sabzi Mandi, Jheel Khuranja,Delhi 110 051
2. **M/S GG Fabrics under proprietorship of Mr. Nitin Dawar** at F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana Punjab-l4l 010
3. **Mr. Pankaj Ahuja** 4181, 04 Duragpuri Haibowal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab- 141 001
4. **Mrs. Hema Ahuja** 4181, 04 Duragpuri Haibowal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 001
5. **Mr. Rakesh Kumar** 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051
6. **Mr. Suresh Kumar** 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051
7. **Mr. Vinay Dawar** House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012
8. **Mr.Nitin Dawar**, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana,Punjab 141 012(Personal guarantor and legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar).
9. **Mrs.Shivani Kochar,** 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051,also at, House No.267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana,Punjab 141012.(Legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar)
10. **Mrs.Savita Dawar,** House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana,Punjab 141012,also at,House 504,Block GX,BRS Nagar Extension,Opposite Verka Milk Plant,Ferozpur Road,Ludhiana-141012,also at 74/2,Ram Nagar Extension,Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower/ guarantor/ Legal heirs that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), the Physical Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 18-08-2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs.16,92,38,143.26/- (Rupees Sixteen Crore Ninety Two Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand One Hundred Forty Three and Twenty Six Paisa Only) as on 18-02-2026, with future interest, costs and expenses etc. thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), from the above mentioned Borrower(s) and guarantor(s).

Item No.1	
Name of Property Owner	Late Mr.Ramesh Kumar(Now represented by legal heirs Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar,Mr.Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar
Description of property	All that Part and Parcel of Freehold Residential Property admeasuring 50 square yards out of area measuring 100 sq. yrds. out of total area measuring 218 sq. yrds. out of Khasra no. 464/362 along with Residential Buildings constructed upon it bearing no. MPL 783/18-A/5 (old), New No. IX/7172 along with all other constructions, improvements, Easementary Rights existing and appurtenant thereon situated at Gaur Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Village Seelampur, Illaqa Shahdara, Delhi 110 031 owned by Late Ramesh Kumar Dawar (since expired and represented by his legal heirs; Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar,Mr.Nitin Dawar and Mrs.Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar more particularly described under Sale Deed No. 1287 dated 09-05-1989 at SRO –IV, New Delhi/ Delhi and Will dated 02-06-1997 bounded on North by Common Passage, South by Other's property, East by Common wall & Shop No.7 and west by common wall and shop No.5
Reserve Price(item No.1)	Rs. 1,44,50,000/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Four Lakh Fifty Thousand Only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)(item No.1)	Rs.14,45,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakhs Forty-Five Thousand Only) EMD shall be deposited on or before 17.08.2026 till 02.00 PM
Bid Increment amount Item No.1	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only)
Date and time of E-auction Item No.1	18.08.2026 from 11:00 AM to 11:30 AM (with 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)
Encumbrances known to the Bank (Item No.1)	Nil/ Encumbrances from 01.01.2018 to 22.11.2022

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd, (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www. southindianbank.com. Details also available at https://bankauctions.in.

For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd on 9818-772-322 / 7309-655-552 / 9007-046-006 (contact number).

Sd/- AUTHORISED OFFICER

NORTHERN RAILWAY

e-OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

No: - 128-W/280/Tender Notice/26-27/W-I (NIT-34-39) **Dated: 31.07.2026**

Name of work with location cost of work and Earnest Money	**1. SFDE** - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/ P.Way/SFDE section under ADEN/PNP. **Approx Cost:** Rs.74,99,982.24, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 1,50,000.00
	2. KUN - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/P.Way/KUN section under ADEN/KUN **Approx. Cost :** Rs. 1,49,99,855.10, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 3,00,000.00
	3. KKDE - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/P.Way/KKDE section under ADEN/KUN. **Approx Cost:** Rs. 1,49,99,963.01, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 3,00,000.00
	4. SNP - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/P.Way/SNP section under ADEN/PNP. **Approx Cost:** Rs. 1,49,99,758.62, **Earnest Money**: Rs. 3,00,000.00
	5. PNP - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/P.Way/PNP section under ADEN/PNP. **Approx Cost:** Rs.1,49,99,474.05, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 3,00,000.00
	6. KLE - Annual zone for maintenance of track work in the section of SSE/P.Way/KLE section under ADEN/KUN. **Approx Cost:** 74,99,484.59, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 1,50,000.00
Completion period	**S.N. 1 to 6 :** 12 Months
Date and time of submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15.00 hrs on 25.08.2026 opening of e-tender at 15.00 hrs on 25.08.2026
Website particulars, published-tender, notice location etc complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e **www.ireps.gov.in**
Similar nature of work	SN-1 to 6 : Any type of track work.

2645/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

NIT. No.: 08 (A,B) / 26-27/ WE

Name of Work with its location: (A) Renovation and Upgradation of Toilets/ Washrooms of the Board's Office at COFMOW on the 1st, 3rd, and 4th Floors, Including Repair of Structure etc. in the section of SSE/W/RB under ADEN/E-III. **(B)** Improvement to golf course at Rail Eco Park in the S/o SSE/Hort./SPM under ADEN/Hort./NDLS

Approx. cost of work: (A) Rs. 2,51,67,764.62, **(B)** Rs. 1,87,87,358.66

EMD amount: (A) Rs. 5,03,400.00, **(B)** Rs. 3,75,800.00

Completion period of work: (A) 09 Months, **(B)** Rs. 12 Months

Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Closing date of tender on 21.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased ect.: Above tender available on website i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in**

No. 128-W/269/O.E.T/NIT No. 08 (A,B)/26-27/WE/ Dated: 28.07.2026 **2661/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER GENERATION CO. LTD.

(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)

No. 03-03/ TN-184 / 1244 **Raipur, Dtd 30/ 07 /2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE NO. TN-184/2026-27

Online bids are invited for Supply/ work as mentioned below:-

S. No.	Tender no. /RFx no.	Description	Submission Date & time
1.	DW-235/26-27 8100053023 (With RLA)	Round the year Maintenance (RYM) of Fans & Air Heaters of 2x250 MW, DSPM TPS, Korba East.	24.08.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
2.	DW-236/26-27 8100053353 (Without RLA)	Deployment of Paramedical Staff at Occupational Health Center (OHC), DSPM TPS, CSPGCL,. Korba East.	24.08.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs

For details please visit our website **https://cspc.co.in** or e-bidding portal:– **https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal**

samvad 48609/1

SAVE ELECTRICITY **EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR(S&P:GEN) CSPGCL:RAIPUR**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vinod, S/o Banwari Lal, R/o 128/10, Harijan Basti, Ishwar Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 502/20, U/s 33/58 D.Ex.Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vinod** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vinod** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinod** accused of **FIR No. 502/20, U/s 33/58 D.Ex.Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.09.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North
Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10614/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohit @ Deepak, S/o Tarachand, R/o H.No. 228, Gali No. 2, Mata Gali, Mandawali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 574/2022, U/s 380 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rohit @ Deepak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rohit @ Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rohit @ Deepak** accused of **FIR No. 574/2022, U/s 380 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.09.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, East District
Room No. 16, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10518/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi, S/o Satish Kumar, R/o 1452, Block-A, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 1724/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ravi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ravi** accused of **CC No. 1724/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.11.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Amardeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, North
Room No. 117, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10582/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Dhani, W/o:** Prem @ Premu **R/o:** D-122, JJ Colony, Sawada Gherva, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 392/25, U/S: 318(4)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Geeta Colony, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Dhani,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Dhani,** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Dhani,** of **FIR No. 392/25, U/S: 318(4)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Geeta Colony, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Prema Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (East)
Karkardooma Court, New Delhi

DP/10607/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Irshad, S/o:** Aayub Khan, **R/o:** Plot No. 309-312, Ground Floor, First Floor, Kakrola Dairy, Dwarka, New Delhi-110078 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No. 1260/2024, U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, P.S.: Dwarka North, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Irshad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Irshad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Irshad** accused of offence in case **CT No. 1260/2024, U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act, P.S.: Dwarka North, New Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Harleen Singh
Additional District & Sessions Judge
Special Court (Electricity)
Room No. 609, Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/10592/DW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/
(84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused namely **Mohammad Ziyaul Haq Rahmani @ Rahman S/o Sh. Azizur Rahman Rehmani R/o G-304, Aditya Mega City Indrapuram Gaziabad UP-201010** has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 116/2019, U/s 420/406/467/ 468/471/34 IPC, PS: Barakhamba Road, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohammad Ziyaul Haq Rahmani @ Rahman** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohammad Ziyaul Haq Rahmani @ Rahman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Mohammad Ziyaul Haq Rahmani @ Rahman of FIR No. 116/2019, U/s 420/406/467/468/471/34 IPC, PS: Barakhamba Road, New Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.08.2026.**

By order
Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No.13,
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/10586/NDD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-204-2026-27 **Dated:** 27.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs.**

The details of the Tender is as under:-

S. No.: 1	**Tender No.:** PRYJ-Sig-204-2026-27
Name of Work: Sectional Telecom Maintenance Contract for 24 months in the section of Sr. DSTE/Kanpur.	
Approx. Cost of Work : ₹ 13597781.18	**Bid Security :** ₹ 272000/-
Completion Period : 24 Months	**Date of Opening of Tender : 24.08.2026**

(2) Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on **www.ireps.gov.in.**
(3) Time, Date & Place of opening of Tender: Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at **12.30 hours.** **1737/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, सिमडेगा

Email Id- rdsd.simdega@rediffmail.com

शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या RDD/SD/SIMDEGA/02/2026-27, पी०आर० (PR) सं० PR. No. 386125 Simdega (2026-27)_D द्वारा प्रकाशित सूचना में निम्न रूप से आंशिक संशोधन किया जाता है:–

क्र० 2. वेबसाईट में प्रकाशन की तिथि
–दिनांक 07.08.2026 को अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक

क्र० 3. ई० निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय
–दिनांक 17.08.2026 से 29.08.2026 अपराहन 03:00 बजे तक

क्र० 5. ई० निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय
–दिनांक 31.08.2026 पूर्वाहन 11:00 बजे

शेष कंडिकाएँ यथावत् रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,
सिमडेगा

PR 386361 Simdega(26-27)#D

The South Indian Bank Ltd

Regional Office-Delhi, 3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21/1, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi -110005
Phone-011 4233 1664/011 4512 8661
Email-ro1008@sib.co.in.

E - AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Borrower

1. Mr Sivasankaran V @ Sivasankaran Vellakkadu, S/o Kunchunni V, (Proprietor of M/s Lakshmi Tools and Equipments),
253, Rajender Nagar Industrial Estate, Gali No 6, Mohan Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh 201007 **Also at**, E-16/U G-1, E Block, Dilshad Colony, East Delhi, Delhi-110095

Guarantor

2. Mrs Sobana C C @ Sobana Choyikutty, W/o Mr Sivasankaran V @ Sivasankaran Vellakkadu E-16/U G-1,E Block, Dilshad Colony, East Delhi, Delhi-110095

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower and guarantor that the below described immovable property mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Vivek Vihar-New Delhi (Secured Creditor), the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 18.08.2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs. 23,60,216.00/- (Rupees Twenty-Three Lakhs Sixty Thousand Two Hundred and Sixteen Only) as on 14.06.2026 with regard to the CCOL limit with future interest, costs and expenses etc. thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Vivek Vihar-New Delhi (Secured Creditor), from the above-mentioned borrower/guarantor.

Name of Property Owner	Mr Sivasankaran V @ Sivasankaran Vellakkadu and Mrs Sobana C C
Description of property	All that part and parcel of one Residential freehold built up flat bearing No E-16/UG-1 on upper Ground Floor (E Block) upto ceiling level only, area super covered 500 sq ft approx.under LIG category being part of free hold built up property bearing no E-16 area measuring 200 Sq Yds part of Khasra No 1076/5/2/492 situated at Dilshad Extn No 1,now known as Dilshad Colony, Jhilmil Tahirpur Village,Shahdara,Delhi and owned by Mr Sivasankaran V @ Sivasankaran Vellakkadu and Mrs Sobana C C; morefully described in Sale Deed No. 1815/2004 dated 28.05.2004 (registered on 29.05.2004) of Sub Registrar Office – IV A, Delhi and bounded on: North : Service Lane South : Road East : Road West : Plot No E-17
Reserve Price	Rs. 24,25,000/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakhs Twenty Five Thousand Only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs.2,42,500/- (Rupees Two Lakhs Forty Two Thousand Five Hundred Only) (EMD shall be deposited on or before 17.08.2026 by 02:00 PM)
Bid Increment amount	Rs 25,000/-
Date and time of E-auction	18.08.2026 from 11:00 AM to 11:30 AM (with 5-minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)
Encumbrances known to the Bank	Nil/ Encumbrances from 01.01.2016 to 15.05.2026

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www. southindianbank.com. Details also available at https://bankauctions.in

For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd at Branch Vivek Vihar-New Delhi (9625665631) at D-215, Vivek Vihar, New Delhi-110095 during working hours.

Place: Delhi **Sd/- Authorised Officer**

Office of the Executive Engineer, R.C.D, Road Division, Garhwa

CORRIGENDUM

In partial modification of e-Tender Reference No.- RCD/GARHWA/688/2026-27 Date:-29.07.2026 [PR 386303 Road(26-27).D under Road Division, Garhwa may be read as follows :-

Name of Work	**Construction of H.L. bridge over Birha River at 14th km of Bhandaria-Bargarh-Tehri road for the year of 2026-27 under R.C.D. Road Division,Garhwa**	
Corrigendum Title	Correction in Bid Security	
Corrigendum Detail	**Please read following changed.**	
	Bid Security*	Read as Rs. **4,10,000.00** (Rupees Four Lac Ten Thousand) only in place of Rs. 41,00,000.00 in Column No. 2b.

PR 386384 Road(26-27)#D

Executive Engineer
R.C.D,Road Division,Garhwa

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Parveen
Civil Judge (Senior Division) ,Charkhi Dadri
Aadrash Kumari w/o Suresh Kumar
Vs.
General Public
CS/58/2026
CNR No. HRCD02-000085-2026
Next Date:-14-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: General Public :-
Charkhi Dadri

The plaintiff **Aadrash Kumari** has filed the present suit for declaration that she is entitled to inherit the estate of Sh Suresh Kumar S/o Dalip Singh and all other kind of benefits, if any one having objection should appear in person or through counsel **on 14.09.2026 at 10:00 a.m.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district = Bhiwani**

Sd/-Sh. Parveen
Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Dated 30.07-2026 Charkhi Dadri

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE **(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)**

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL)** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.** for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Sanju/ Neetu/ NOI-HL-001030/ Noida	Ground Floor -2 Built Up on Plot No. A-29 Area Measuring 42.5 Sq. Yards Out of Khasra No. 208. Situated At Sankar Vihar Village Sadullabad Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad. Boundaries:- East- Rasta 20 Feet Wide, West- Service Lane 8 Feet Wide, North- Plot No. A 30, Storage, South- Plot No. A 28	11-Nov-2025/ Rs. 10,62,723/- Rupees Ten Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty Three Only.	28.07. 2026
2.	Arun Kumar Singh/ Kanhaiya Gautam/ DEL-HL-000701/ Delhi	Residential Mig Flat Bearing No. GF-02 on Ground Floor (Back Side) Without Roof Rights Having Covered Area Measuring 700 Sq Ft (65.03 Sq Mtrs) Situated in The Residential Colony Known As Dlf Ankur Vihar, Built on Plot No. C-10/18 In The Area of Village Sadulabad, Pargana, Tehsil and Dist- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh	11-Nov-2025/ Rs. 20,60,412/- Rupees Twenty Lakh Sixty Thousand Four Hundred Twelve Only.	28.07. 2026

Date: August 01, 2026
Place: Ghaziabad

Sd/- Authorized Officer
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Name of Work and its location	**96-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27** Replacement of overhead network by underground cables and improvement/upgradation of power supply network at DKZ.
Approx. cost of the works in	₹ 14821054.00/-
Address of the Office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 296400.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	21.08.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	21.08.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	**www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi**

2639/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-C-2026-184

Description of work : Mobile Flash butt welding in AIT-KONCH section for CTR work under ADEN/CNB sub-division.

Approx Cost : 25073595.00 **Earnest Money. :** 501500.00

Date of closing Tender : 20/08/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter. : 09 Months

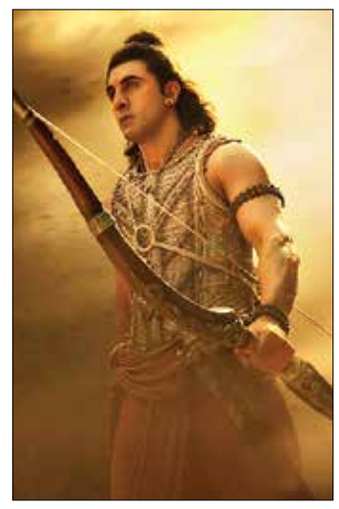
- Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **20.08.2026**
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **1740/26 (AS)**

North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | @ CPRONCR

NITESH TIWARI'S 'RAMAYANA' CASTING

Ranbir Kapoor reacts to criticism

'All the people have their own interpretation of Lord Ram,' he says



After months of anticipation, the trailer of Nitesh Tiwari's 'Ramayana: Part 1' has finally been unveiled. The ambitious mythological epic has received mixed online responses. While many viewers have applauded its scale and visual grandeur, others have raised concerns over certain aspects of the film, with Ranbir Kapoor's casting as Lord Rama emerging as one of the biggest talking points.

A section of social media users believes the actor is not the ideal choice for the role, prompting widespread discussion following the trailer's release.

Ranbir recently responded to the criticism while promoting 'Ramayana' at San Diego Comic-Con alongside director Nitesh Tiwari, producer Namit Malhotra and co-star Yash. Speaking to 'Review Nation', the actor admitted that his first reaction to being offered the role was one of self-doubt, as he questioned whether he was worthy of portraying such a revered figure.

> The actor admitted that his first reaction to being offered the role was one of self-doubt

"The first question that popped into my head was, 'Am I worthy? Am I the right person and why am I being gifted this responsibility not to play Lord Rama but represent him?' But very soon you understand the value, the responsibility and the noble intention of the filmmakers to present the story, which has been relevant for 4,000 years. It's deeply ingrained in our subconscious. So, I don't think there's any right actor to play Lord Rama," he said.

Ranbir said that because every devotee has their own understanding and image of Lord Rama, no single actor can meet everyone's expectations. In his view, what truly matters is the performer's sincerity, belief and respect for the character's journey.

"All the people who have watched 'Ramayana', they all have their own interpretation of Lord Ram. There is no fixed face to it. Many people will probably feel like I am the wrong casting. Some people will say I am the right casting. But the honest truth is that the right casting for Ram would be any actor who has the right intentions and who has belief and faith in the journey of Lord Ram," he shared. AGENCIES

'The script was the biggest plus'

Jimmy Sheirgill reveals why Netflix's 'Operation Safed Sagar' was a special project

Jimmy Sheirgill, who is awaiting the release of his upcoming streaming series 'Operation Safed Sagar', said that he didn't choose the series; rather, the series chose him as a vehicle to tell the story.

The series is based on the eponymous combined arms operation by the Indian Air Force, supporting elements of the Indian Army during the 1999 Kargil war that was aimed at flushing out regular and irregular troops of the Pakistani Army from vacated Indian Positions in the Kargil sector along the Line of Control. It was the first large-scale use of airpower in the Jammu and Kashmir region since the Indo-Pakistani War of 1971.

> The series is based on the eponymous combined-arms operation by the Indian Air Force

The actor spoke with IANS along with his co-actors from the series Siddharth, Arnav Bhasin and Mihir Ahuja. Talking about the series, he told IANS, "I think when there are such projects, they choose us. We feel that our responsibility is to work hard with the characters we are given. The team is good. Creators are good and the actors are hardworking. We don't even know how long it takes because we shoot extensively. It's not something that is in chunks. Like we were talking about the cockpit. The whole setup of the cockpit took almost a month to prepare. After that, our shooting started. So, there were such gaps," said Jimmy.

When asked what appealed to the artiste in him about the series, he said, "I think the first thing was the script. You like the concept of the script. After that, when you are writing for your character, you try to put yourself into that situation and see what you are doing in it. And also, the director is very important. He was on it. That was a big plus point because I knew him for a long time. We were supposed to do a film together, which we didn't have in the script."

"I think at some point, hopefully, we were in it. So, it gives you confidence that the script is good. I don't think 'Netflix' has done this before. That was also a big plus point," he added. AGENCIES

MISSING NICOLAS CAGE'S MOVIE

Producer sues OTT streamer Netflix for $105 million

A movie producer is seeking 105 million dollars in damages from 'Netflix' after he said a copy of his unreleased Nicolas Cage movie was stolen from the streaming service's studios in Hollywood.

Attorneys for producer Simon Afram said in a lawsuit filed on Wednesday in California that the filmmakers had delivered an unencrypted master copy of the World War II drama 'Fortitude' to 'Netflix' in June at the company's request. Afram invested more than 45 million dollars in the production, which took seven years to complete and he was in the process of trying to sell the movie to Netflix or another distributor.

Nine days later, the plaintiffs were informed via a 'Netflix' email that 'someone stole a good amount of drives from our desks this past week', including the one containing 'Fortitude', the lawsuit said.

The producers argue that the film's value has been 'destroyed' because distributors are unlikely to buy a film that could appear on piracy sites. They said 'Netflix' should have better secured the hard drive. "It is not fathomable that a sophisticated buyer would invest tens of millions of dollars to acquire the film - and tens of millions more to market it - while facing the constant risk that it could appear online to be viewed widely for free at any time," the lawsuit said. The lawsuit has asked for at least $105 dollars million in damages.

In a statement, Netflix said it 'disputes any claim that it bears the risk of loss for a film delivered without the proper industry-standard safeguards'.

'While we do not own the rights to 'Fortitude', we take content security seriously and have taken extra measures to support the filmmaker and his team', including investigating the theft and monitoring piracy sites for unauthorised distribution of the film, the company said.

'Netflix' also said it had declined to share information from the investigation with Afram's attorneys 'given their hostile attempts to extort money from 'Netflix' over this situation rather than work with us in good faith'. AGENCIES

'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' surpasses 'Pathaan' & 'Kantara Chapter 1'

Proving that Spider-Man is a superhero not just on screen but also at the box office, director Destin Daniel Cretton's 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day', starring Tom Holland and Zendaya in the lead roles, registered a thunderous opening in India, grossing over Rs 72 crore. In fact, the movie has outperformed Siddharth Anand's Shah Rukh Khan-Deepika Padukone starrer 'Pathaan' (2023) and Aditya Dhar's Ranveer Singh-led 'Dhurandhar' (2025) on its debut day.

Moreover, 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' also recorded the highest opening day collection for a Hollywood movie in India, thus scripting history. On Thursday, July 30, the superhero film grossed Rs 72.44 crore in India, according to industry tracker 'Sacnilk'.

During the day, the film recorded an India net collection of Rs 60.60 crore. Thus, it surpassed the previous records set by the Russo brothers' 2019 epic 'Avengers: Endgame' (Rs 65 crore gross; Rs 53.60 crore nett) and James Cameron's 2022 film 'Avatar: The Way of Water' (Rs 48.75 crore gross; Rs 40.30 crore nett).

'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' also fared better than 'Pathaan' and 'Kantara Chapter 1', which grossed Rs 67.19 crore and Rs 73.29 crore, respectively, on their opening days. Ranbir Kapoor-starrer 'Animal' earned Rs 76.10 crore in India on opening day. It must be noted that the MCU film didn't have any block bookings. AGENCIES

> The Tom Holland-starrer also recorded the highest opening-day collection for a Hollywood movie in India, thus scripting history

Kim Minha to host BIFF's opening ceremony

Busan International Film Festival announced 'Pachinko' star Kim Minha, a rising South Korean star, as the host of this year's opening ceremony.

Minha made her debut in 2016 and has built a distinctive body of work across films and television over the years.

> BIFF selected the 'Pachinko' star in recognition of the depth and emotional precision she brings to every role

She gained international fame with her portrayal of young Sunja in the globally acclaimed 'Apple TV' series 'Pachinko', a popular novel by author Min Jin Lee.

After earning applause for her portrayal of young Sunja, Minha has also starred in popular K-dramas such as 'Light Shop', 'Way Back Love' and 'Typhoon Family'.

BIFF selected Kim Minha in recognition of the depth and emotional precision she brings to every role, as well as her growing presence as a new-generation star. PTI

'Anupamaa' made me a star: Rupali Ganguly

The popular TV star never saw herself as a star despite a long career

Popular television star Rupali Ganguly said she never saw herself as a star despite a long career and hit shows like 'Sarabhai vs Sarabhai', 'Parvarrish' and 'Kkavyanjali' but 'Anupamaa' - with its unprecedented popularity - changed the way people perceived her.

Ganguly, whose other popular shows include 'Baa Bahoo Aur Baby' and 'Adaalat', plays the titular character of a middle-class homemaker who embarks on a journey of self-discovery and empowerment. The 'Star Plus' show has been a major hit since it debuted in 2020.

"I was never a star before 'Anupamaa'. I was just an actor until then, but people realised that I was doing my work well; that's about it. Even when 'Sarabhai vs Sarabhai' was telecast, it had low TRPs and that show became big later. Suddenly, after 'Anupamaa', people realised that I was fantastic in 'Sarabhai…'. So, 'Anupamaa' has been the catalyst. Even in award functions, I was made to sit behind, but today if I'm sitting in the front row, it is because of 'Anupamaa'," the actor told PTI in an interview.

The actress, 49, attributed the popularity of the show, made by Rajan Shahi and Deepa Shahi under their banner, Director's 'Kut Productions', to its relatable storytelling and its focus on homemakers, who are often overlooked. "I've stayed at home for over six years; I know we are important for our family. In the show, we are talking about the housewives. We are the voice for the voiceless," the actress said, adding that the show is equally popular among men.

Ganguly said 'Anupamaa' has also helped challenge long-held industry perceptions about lack of roles for women in TV after a certain age. "There was a belief that women after a certain age will get only certain roles, like a mother's role, but 'Anupamaa' came and changed the perception that the industry had towards older actresses. It has shown that strong, meaningful stories with women at the centre work. A lot of them (actors) came and thanked me and said, 'You've changed things'. But it was not me, it was Rajan ji, who had the courage to bring a show like this."

> Ganguly said 'Anupamaa' has also helped challenge long-held industry perceptions about lack of roles for women in TV after a certain age

Reflecting on her long career in the industry, the actress said she faced her share of struggles and had to consistently prove herself despite coming from a film background. Her father, Anil Ganguly, was a national award-winning director, best known for women-centric films like 'Kora Kagaz', 'Tapasya', 'Humkadam' and others. AGENCIES